Software User Manual

Distribution Management System

Desktop application for Windows · Manual version 1.2 · Updated 16 October 2026

This manual explains how to use the Distribution Management System. It is written for the people who use the application every day (owners, operators, store keepers, salespeople and administrators), not for programmers.

Documentation set

Document	Use it for
USER_MANUAL.md (this file)	Introduction, getting started, navigation, roles, messages, FAQ, glossary and quick reference
SCREEN_REFERENCE.md	Every screen, every field and every button in detail, with screenshots
WORKFLOW_GUIDES.md	Step-by-step procedures for complete business tasks
TROUBLESHOOTING.md	Error messages and problems, and how to fix them
DOCUMENTATION_COVERAGE.md	What was documented and verified, and what still needs checking

---

Contents

1. Introduction
2. Purpose and Scope
3. Intended Audience
4. System Access and Getting Started
5. Signing In and Closing the Application
6. Main Interface and Navigation
7. Dashboard
8. Screen-by-Screen Guide (summary)
9. Form Reference (summary)
10. End-to-End Workflow Guides (summary)
11. Search, Filters, Tables and Record Management
12. Reports, Printing and Exports
13. Settings
14. User Roles and Permissions
15. Notifications, Messages and Confirmations
16. Error Handling and Troubleshooting
17. Frequently Asked Questions
18. Keyboard Use
19. Glossary of Application Terms
20. Quick Reference Guide
21. Documentation Coverage

1. Introduction

The **Distribution Management System** helps a goods distribution business (a wholesaler or distributor supplying shops) keep track of:

- **Masters:** the companies (brands) you distribute, product categories, products and prices, customers (shops) and suppliers.
- **Stock:** opening stock, deliveries received from suppliers, and damaged or lost goods.
- **Sales:** bills to customers, cash received, and customer balances (credit).
- **Expenses:** business spending, including freight (bilti).
- **Reports:** daily closing stock, daily sales, profit and loss, damage and expenses.

The application runs on a Windows computer and stores its data in a central database that your system administrator sets up. Several computers can use the same database.

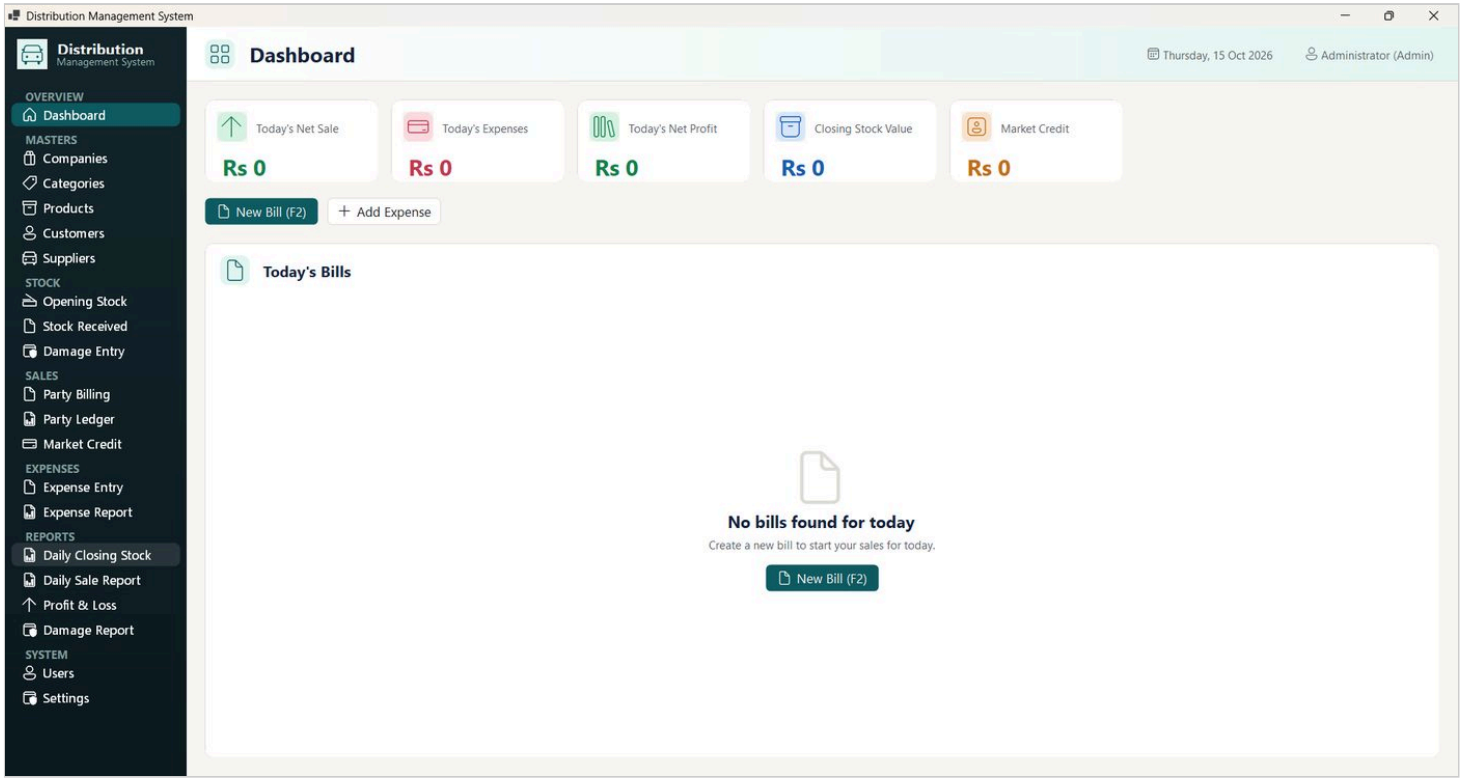


Figure 3: Main window after signing in

2. Purpose and Scope

This manual covers every screen and feature available in the current version of the application:

- Sign-in window
- Dashboard
- Masters: Companies, Categories, Products (including Import from Excel), Customers, Suppliers
- Stock: Opening Stock, Stock Received, Damage Entry

- Sales: Party Billing, Party Ledger, Market Credit
- Expenses: Expense Entry, Expense Report
- Reports: Daily Closing Stock, Daily Sale Report, Profit & Loss, Damage Report
- System: Users, Settings (including Backup and Restore and Software Update)
- Notifications from your supplier
- Automatic software updates

This manual does not cover installation, database setup, server configuration or programming. These are tasks for your system administrator.

Features not available in this version. Users often expect the following, but they are **not** in the current version:

Not available	What to do instead
Printing or exporting an individual **bill**	Reports can be printed and exported (see Section 12), but a single bill cannot. Note the bill number and use the Daily Sale Report or Party Ledger.
Editing, cancelling or deleting saved bills, purchases, stock entries, damage entries, expenses or receipts	Check carefully before saving. See TROUBLESHOOTING.md, Section 13.
Sale returns and purchase returns	Not available. Contact your administrator.
Supplier payments and supplier balance tracking	Keep supplier accounts separately.
Sign out button	Close the window and start the application again.
Replying to a notification	Notifications are one-way. Phone your supplier to reply.
Changing your own password	Ask an Admin to use **Reset Password**.
Working dashboard figures	Use the report screens.

---

3. Intended Audience

Reader	Typical tasks	Most useful sections
Business owner / manager	Reviewing sales, profit, stock, credit and damage	Sections 7, 12; Workflows W17, W20–W22
Operator / data entry staff	Entering bills, deliveries, expenses and master records	Sections 5, 6, 11, 15; Workflows W3–W14, W18
Store keeper	Receiving stock, recording damage, checking stock	Workflows W11–W13, W20
Administrator	First-time setup, users, settings, backups	Sections 4, 13, 14; Workflows W1, W23–W28

You need basic computer skills: using a mouse, typing, and opening programs. No accounting or technical knowledge is required. Business terms are explained in the Glossary.

---

4. System Access and Getting Started

What you need

- A Windows computer with the application installed by your system administrator.
- A screen resolution of at least **1366 × 768** pixels (the main window cannot be smaller).
- A **username** and **password** created by an administrator.
- A working connection to the application's database (usually the office network).

Starting the application

1. Double-click the application's icon (or the program file `Distribution.WinForms.exe`) provided by your administrator.
2. The **Sign in — Distribution Management System** window appears. See Section 5.

First use on a new installation (administrator only)

When the application is started for the very first time on an empty database, it creates **one administrator account automatically**:

- **Username:** `admin`
- **Full Name:** Administrator
- **Role:** Admin
- **Initial password:** written by the application into its log file on that first start (the `logs` folder next to the program file, in a line beginning "No users existed. Created default admin account..."). Your installer or system administrator can give it to you. It is not printed in this manual for security reasons.

> **Security — do this immediately after the first sign-in:** 1. Open **Users**, click the **admin** row, click **Reset Password**, and set a strong new password (W24). 2. Create a separate account for each person (W23). Do not share accounts.

Then follow the complete setup order in W1: First-time setup:

Settings → Companies → Categories → Products → Customers (with areas) → Suppliers → Opening Stock → Backup.

---

5. Signing In and Closing the Application

Signing in

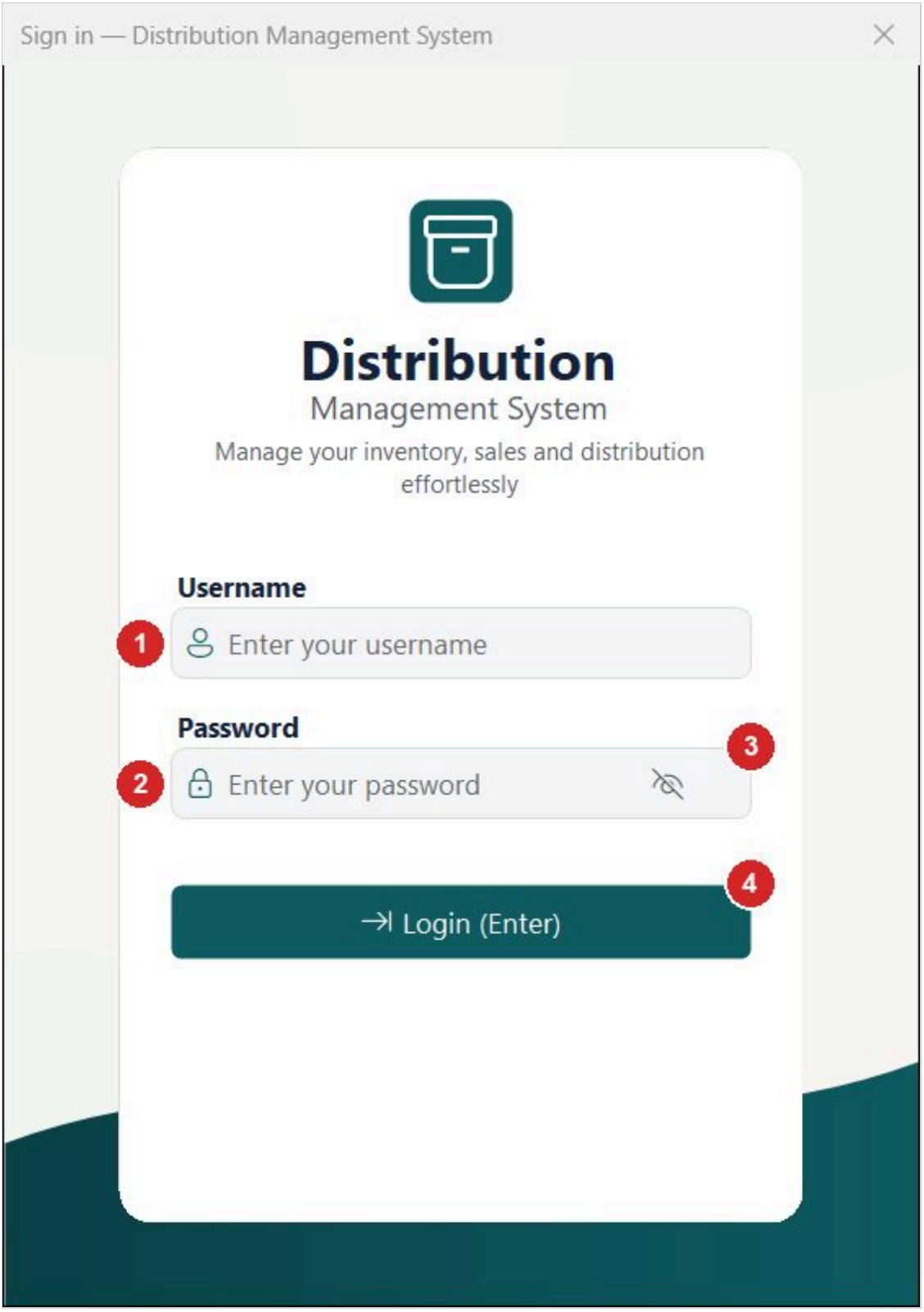


Figure 1a: Sign-in window

1. Type your **Username** (1). Capital and small letters must match.
2. Type your **Password** (2). Click the eye icon (3) to show or hide it.
3. Press **Enter** (while in the Password box) or click **Login (Enter)** (4).
4. The main window opens on the Dashboard. Your name and role appear at the top-right.

If you see **"Invalid username or password."** (Figure 2), check your typing and Caps Lock. A deactivated account shows the same message. See TROUBLESHOOTING.md, Section 1.

Closing the application (signing out)

There is no Sign out button.

1. Save any work in progress. **Unsaved forms are lost.**
2. Click the **X** at the top-right of the main window.
3. To sign in as someone else, start the application again.

> **Tip:** Closing the application and signing in again is also the way to make every screen show fresh data. See Section 6.

---

6. Main Interface and Navigation

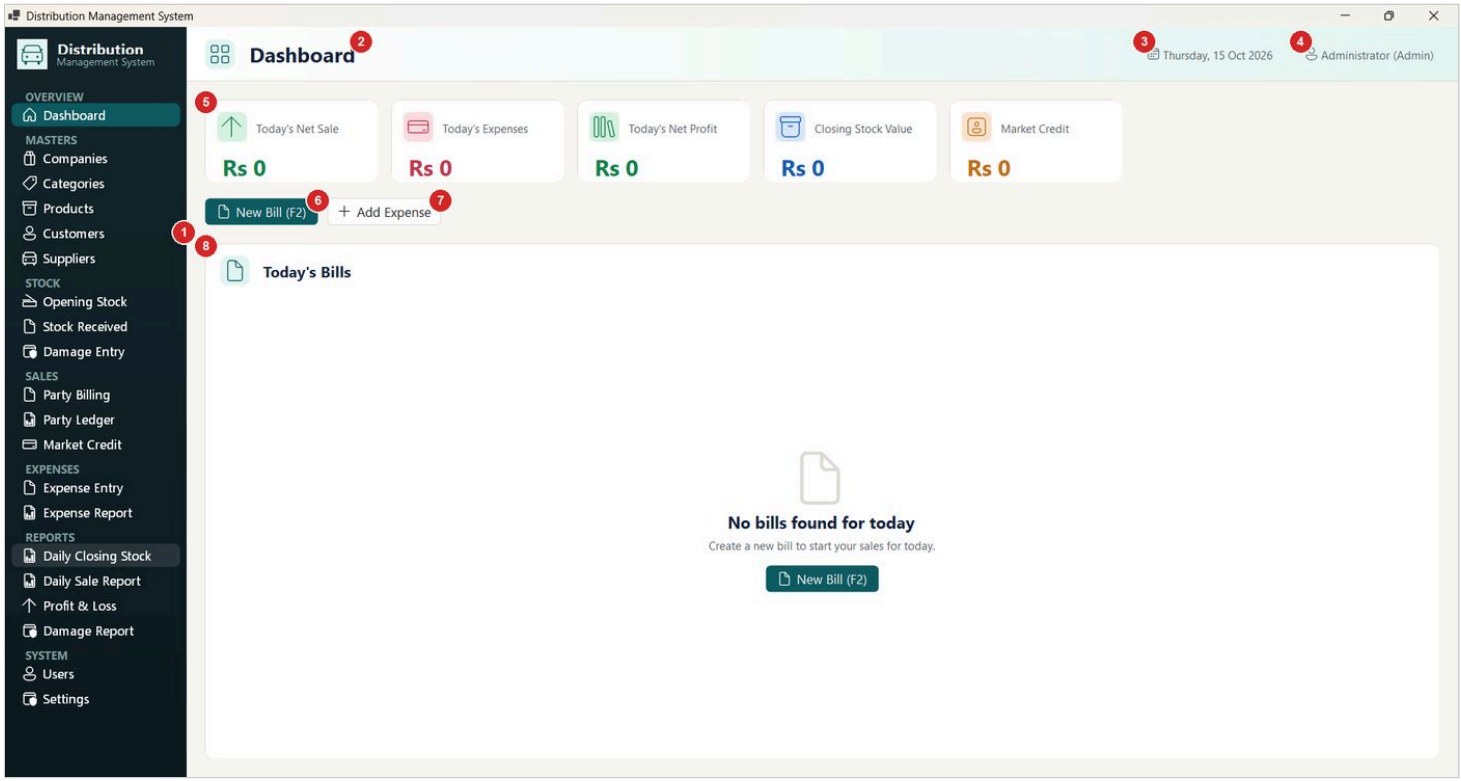


Figure 3a: Main window: (1) side menu, (2) screen title, (3) today's date, (4) signed-in user, (5) summary cards, (6) New Bill, (7) Add Expense, (8) Today's Bills

Parts of the window

Part	Description
Side menu (left, dark green)	Click any item to open that screen. The current screen is highlighted. Items are grouped: **OVERVIEW, MASTERS, STOCK, SALES, EXPENSES, REPORTS, SYSTEM**.

Part	Description
Top bar	Shows the open screen's name and description, the notification bell (when you have messages), today's date, and your name with your role in brackets.
Work area	The open screen. Most screens have a form at the top (cards with fields and buttons) and a list below.

Menu structure

```
OVERVIEW   Dashboard
MASTERS    Companies · Categories · Products · Customers · Suppliers
STOCK      Opening Stock · Stock Received · Damage Entry
SALES      Party Billing · Receive Payment · Party Ledger · Market Credit
EXPENSES   Expense Entry · Expense Report
REPORTS    Daily Closing Stock · Daily Sale Report · Profit & Loss · Damage Report
SYSTEM     Users (Admin only) · Settings
```

How screens behave when you move between them

- A screen keeps whatever you typed when you switch to another screen and back.
- **Every screen reloads its lists and drop-downs each time you open it.** A customer, supplier or product added on one screen is available on the others straight away, without restarting the application.
- Your current selection is kept where it still exists. For example, if you were part-way through a bill, the customer you had chosen stays chosen.
- The only lists that do **not** reload on their own are report results, because they depend on the dates and filters you choose. Click **View Report**, **View Ledger** or **Apply Filter** to recalculate them.

Full details: SCREEN_REFERENCE.md, Section 2.

Typical screen layout

Most data-entry screens follow the same pattern (Figure 9a):

1. **Form card** with fields at the top.
2. **Buttons**: **Save** (changes to **Update** when editing), **Clear**, **Delete**.
3. **List card** with a search box and a table. Clicking a row loads it into the form.

---

7. Dashboard

The Dashboard is the first screen after signing in (Figure 3).

Element	Use
New Bill (F2)	Opens Party Billing.
Add Expense	Opens Expense Entry.
Summary cards (Today's Net Sale, Today's Expenses, Today's Net Profit, Closing Stock Value, Market Credit)	**In this version these always show Rs 0.**

Element	Use
Today's Bills	**In this version this always shows "No bills found for today".**

For real figures, use the report screens. See SCREEN_REFERENCE.md, Section 3 for a table showing which report replaces each card.

---

8. Screen-by-Screen Guide (summary)

Each screen is documented in full, with screenshots, in SCREEN_REFERENCE.md.

Screen	Menu	What it is for	Details
Sign-in window	—	Enter username and password	§1
Main window	—	Menu, top bar, work area	§2
Dashboard	OVERVIEW	Shortcuts to new bill and new expense	§3
Companies	MASTERS	Brands / manufacturers	§4
Categories	MASTERS	Product groups	§5
Products	MASTERS	Items, prices, discount limits, stock; Excel import	§6
Customers	MASTERS	Shops / parties, areas, opening balances	§7
Suppliers	MASTERS	Parties you buy from	§8
Opening Stock	STOCK	Starting stock quantities and costs	§9
Stock Received	STOCK	Deliveries from suppliers, freight	§10
Damage Entry	STOCK	Damaged, expired or lost goods	§11
Party Billing	SALES	Sale bills and cash received	§12
Receive Payment	SALES	Payments received against a customer's balance	§12a
Party Ledger	SALES	One customer's account history	§13
Market Credit	SALES	All customers who owe money	§14
Expense Entry	EXPENSES	Record spending	§15
Expense Report	EXPENSES	Spending by period and category	§16
Daily Closing Stock	REPORTS	Stock movement and closing value for a day	§17
Daily Sale Report	REPORTS	Bill-, product- and company-wise sales for a day	§18
Profit & Loss	REPORTS	Profit for a period	§19
Damage Report	REPORTS	Damage grouped by product, company, reason or month	§20
Users	SYSTEM	Logins, roles, passwords (Admin only)	§21
Settings	SYSTEM	Business details, backup and restore, software update	§22
Notifications window	Bell in the top bar	Messages from your supplier	§22a

Screen	Menu	What it is for	Details
Software Update window	Appears by itself, or from Settings	Installing a new version	§22b

---

9. Form Reference (summary)

Every form has a field-by-field table (purpose, required/optional, how to enter, validation) in SCREEN_REFERENCE.md. Required fields at a glance:

Form	Required fields	Unique fields
Add Company	Short Code, Name	Short Code
Add Category	Name	—
Products	Code, Name, Company, Category, Unit	Code
Customer	Code, Shop Name, Area / Route	Code
Supplier	Code, Name, Company	Code
Opening Stock	Product, Qty (> 0)	—
Stock Received	Supplier, Invoice No, at least one line (Product, Qty > 0, Rate > 0)	—
Damage Entry	Product, Qty (> 0, ≤ stock), Reason, Found At	—
Party Billing	Customer, at least one line (Product, Qty > 0, Rate > 0)	—
Receive Payment	Customer, Amount Received (> 0)	—
Expense Entry	Category, Amount (> 0)	—
Add User	Username, Full Name, Role, password	Username
Settings	none	—

> **Codes of deleted records stay reserved.** You cannot reuse the code of a deleted company, product, customer or supplier.

---

10. End-to-End Workflow Guides (summary)

Full step-by-step instructions, with expected results and recovery steps, are in WORKFLOW_GUIDES.md.

The daily cycle:

```
Morning     Stock Received (deliveries)  →  Party Billing (sales all day)
During day  Expense Entry (as money is spent) · Damage Entry (when found)
Evening     Sign in again → Daily Sale Report → Daily Closing Stock
            → Profit & Loss → Market Credit → Backup
```

Task	Guide
Set up a new installation	W1
Add companies, categories, products, customers, suppliers	W3–W8
Edit or delete master records	W9, W10
Enter opening stock	W11
Receive a delivery	W12
Record damage	W13
Make a bill	W14
Check a customer's account / who owes money	W16, W17
Record and review expenses	W18, W19
Close the day	W20
Profit for a period	W21
Manage users	W23–W25
Settings, backup, restore	W26–W28

---

11. Search, Filters, Tables and Record Management

Search boxes

Screen	Search box hint	Actually searches
Companies	Search companies by code, name, contact person or phone...	**Code and name only**
Categories	Search categories...	Name
Products	Search by code, name or barcode...	Code, name, barcode
Customers	Search customers...	Shop name, code
Suppliers	Search suppliers...	Name, code
Users	Search users by username or full name...	Username, full name

How to search:

1. Click in the search box above the list.
2. Type part of the name or code, for example `sun`. Capital letters do not matter.
3. The list filters itself about a third of a second after you stop typing. There is no Search button.
4. To show everything again, delete the text.

Example: on Companies, typing `sun` shows only *Sunrise Foods* (Figure 15). Typing a contact person's name, such as `Bilal`, shows nothing (Figure 14).

When nothing matches: Customers and Suppliers show "No customers found" / "No suppliers found" (Figure 42). Other screens show an empty list.

Filters

Screen	Filters	How to reset
Products	**All companies**, **All categories** (apply immediately)	Choose **All companies** / **All categories** again
Daily Closing Stock	Date, Company, Category	Choose "All..." and click **View Report**
Expense Report	From, To, Category	Change and click **Apply Filter**
Party Ledger	Customer, From, To	Click **View Ledger**
Daily Sale Report	Date	**View Report**
Profit & Loss	From, To, With Expenses, Include Self Expense	**View Report**
Damage Report	From, To, Group By	**View Report**

Example (Products, Figures 27–28): open the **All companies** list, choose **Sunrise Foods**, and only its two products are shown. Choose **All companies** to see all products again.

Tables (lists)

- **Read-only:** you cannot type into lists.
- **Open a record:** on master screens (Companies, Categories, Products, Customers, Suppliers, Users), click a row to load it into the form.
- **Sorting:** clicking a column heading sorts the list, but on master screens this can make the **wrong record load** when you click a row (Figures 107–108). **Do not sort master lists.** If you did, reset as described in TROUBLESHOOTING.md, Section 3.
- **Paging:** there are no pages. All matching rows are shown; scroll if needed. Some lists show only recent rows: Opening Stock (last 50), Damage Register (last 100), and the "Today's..." lists (today only).
- **Number format:** amounts and quantities are shown as whole numbers with thousands separators.

Record management at a glance

Operation	Masters (Companies, Categories, Products, Customers, Suppliers)	Transactions (Opening Stock, Purchases, Damage, Bills, Expenses)	Users
Create	Yes (**Save**)	Yes (**Save**)	Yes (Admin)
View	List + click row	Recent/today lists, reports	List
Edit	Yes (**Update**)	**No**	Yes (Admin)
Delete	Yes, with restrictions (hidden permanently)	**No**	No (deactivate instead)
Restore deleted	**No**	—	Activate

---

12. Reports, Printing and Exports

Available reports

Report	Menu	Answers the question
Daily Closing Stock	REPORTS	How much of each product did we have, receive, sell and lose on a given day, and what is it worth?
Daily Sale Report	REPORTS	What did we sell on a given day, by bill, by product and by company?
Profit & Loss	REPORTS	How much profit did we make in a period?
Damage Report	REPORTS	Where are we losing stock, and why?
Expense Report	EXPENSES	What did we spend, and on what?
Party Ledger	SALES	What is the account history of one customer?
Market Credit	SALES	Who owes us money, and how much?

How each report is calculated is explained in SCREEN_REFERENCE.md, Sections 13–20.

Printing and exporting reports

Every report screen listed above has three buttons next to **View Report** (or **View Ledger** / **Apply Filter**):

Button	What it does
Export Excel	Saves the report as an Excel workbook (.xlsx). Amounts are saved as real numbers, so you can sort and total them in Excel.
Export PDF	Saves the report as a PDF, with your business name, the date range and page numbers.
Print	Opens a print preview. Use the printer button in the preview to choose a printer and print.

How to export or print a report:

1. Open the report, choose your date range and filters, and click **View Report** so that the screen shows what you want.
2. Click **Export Excel**, **Export PDF** or **Print**.
3. For an export, choose a folder and file name, then click **Save** (Figure 114). A suggested name with today's date is filled in for you.
4. When it is saved, the application asks **"Open it now?"** (Figure 115). Click **Yes** to open the file, or **No** to keep working.
5. For **Print**, check the preview (Figure 116), then click the printer icon at the top-left, choose your printer and click **Print**.

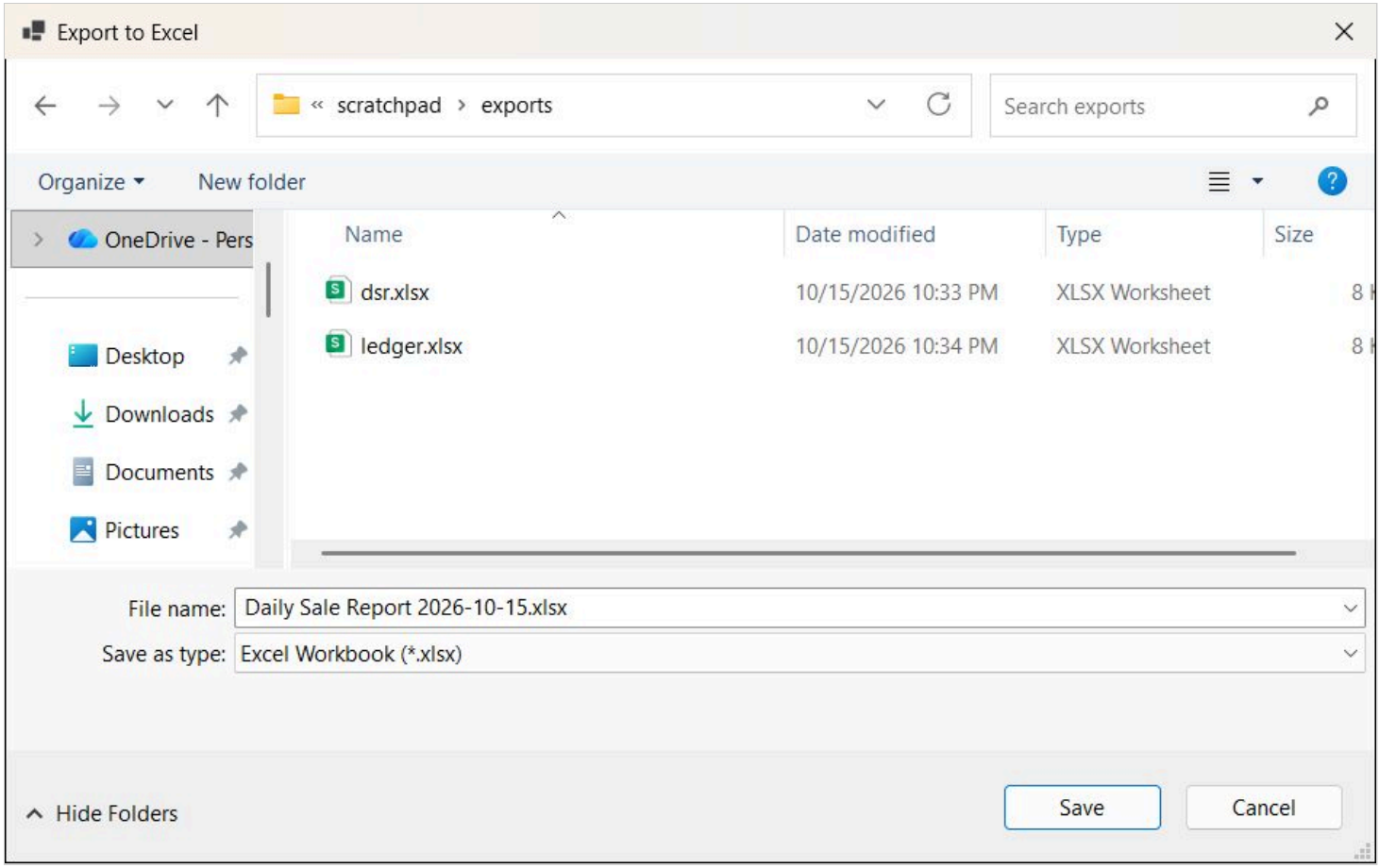


Figure 114: Choosing where to save the exported file

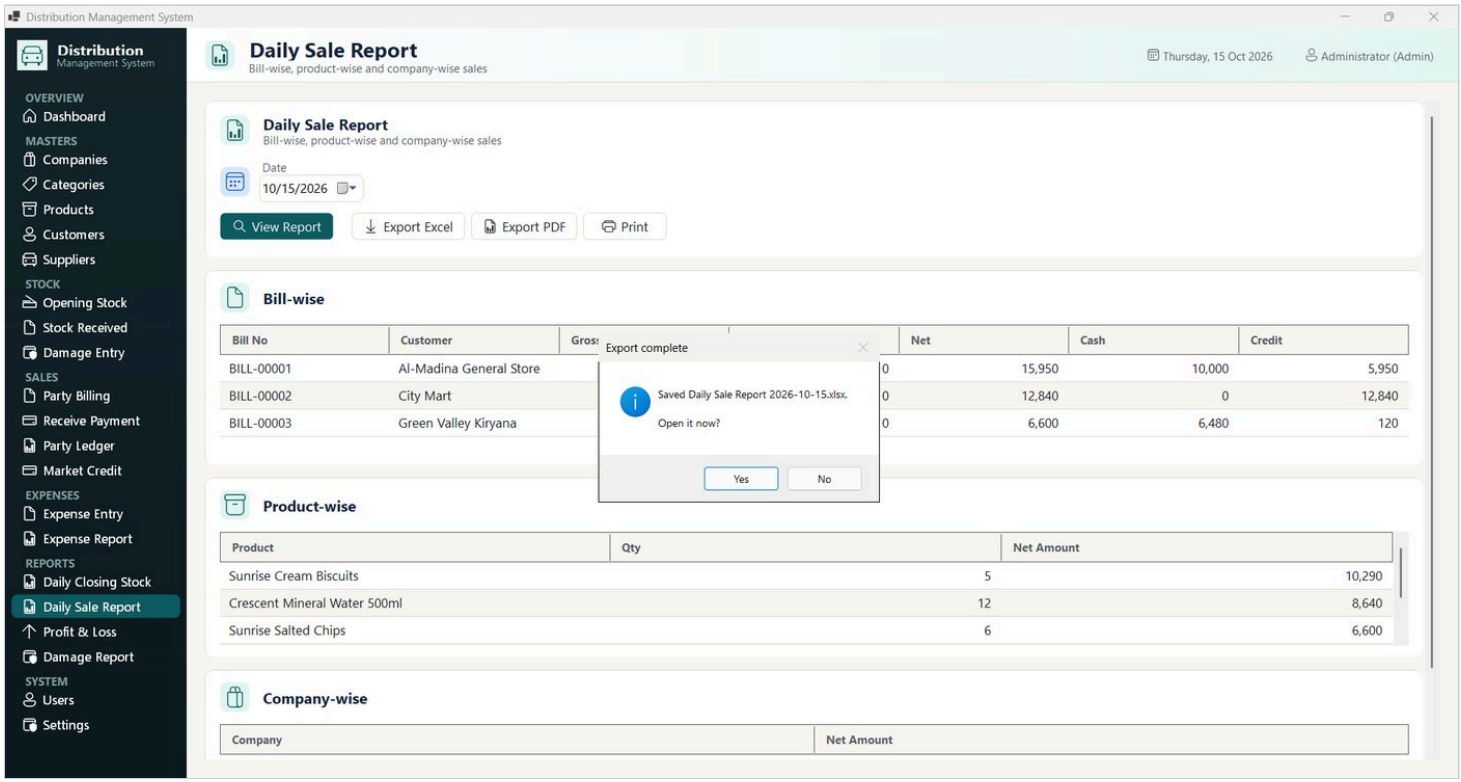


Figure 115: After a successful export

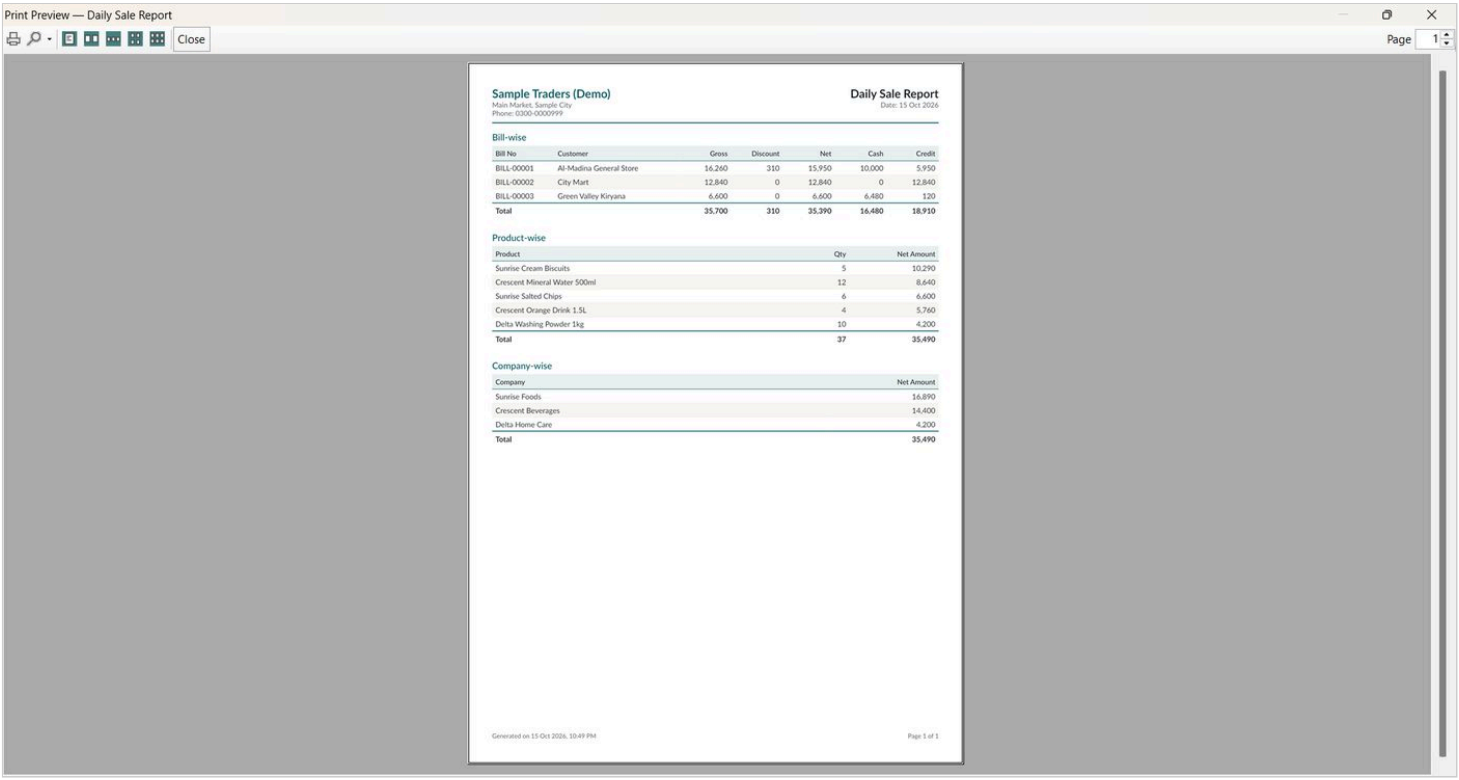


Figure 116: Print preview of the Daily Sale Report

Notes

- The export always matches what is on screen, including the dates and filters you chose.
- If there is nothing to show, the message **"There is nothing to export for the selected options."** appears. Widen the dates or change the filters.
- If no printer is installed, **Print** explains this and suggests Export PDF instead.
- **Individual bills still cannot be printed.** Only reports can.

Other file features

- **Import from Excel** on Products (import only).
- **Backup Database** and **Restore Database** in Settings.

> **Tip:** the Settings screen says details are "Shown on printed bills". Bill printing is not available, but the business name, address and phone you enter there **do** appear at the top of every exported and printed report.

---

13. Settings

Open **Settings** under **SYSTEM** (Figure 104). Full details: SCREEN_REFERENCE.md, Section 22.

Setting	Effect in this version
Company Name, Phone, Address	Stored only.
Invoice Prefix	Stored only. Bills are always numbered **BILL-00001**, **BILL-00002**, ...

Setting	Effect in this version
Allow negative stock	Stored only. Selling or writing off more than the stock held is **always** refused.
Backup Database	Creates a backup file (requires PostgreSQL client tools).
Restore Database	**Replaces all data** with a backup file.

There are no personal preferences (such as language, theme or font size) in this version.

---

14. User Roles and Permissions

Each user has one role, chosen by an Admin on the **Users** screen.

Capability	Admin	Operator	Viewer
Sign in	✓	✓	✓
See and use the **Users** screen	✓	✗ (menu item hidden)	✗ (menu item hidden)
All other screens (masters, stock, sales, expenses, reports, settings, backup and restore)	✓	✓	✓
Give a line discount above a product's **Max Discount %**	✓	✗ ("Discount …% exceeds max allowed …%")	✗

Verified during testing: an Operator does not see **Users** (Figure 105), and is stopped from exceeding Max Discount % (Figure 106).

> **Important — the Viewer role is not read-only.** In this version, Viewers have the same access as Operators: they can create bills, change masters and even restore the database. This was determined by examining the application and was **not tested** with a Viewer sign-in. Give the Viewer role only to people you trust to enter data.
>
> **Role changes** take effect the next time the user signs in.

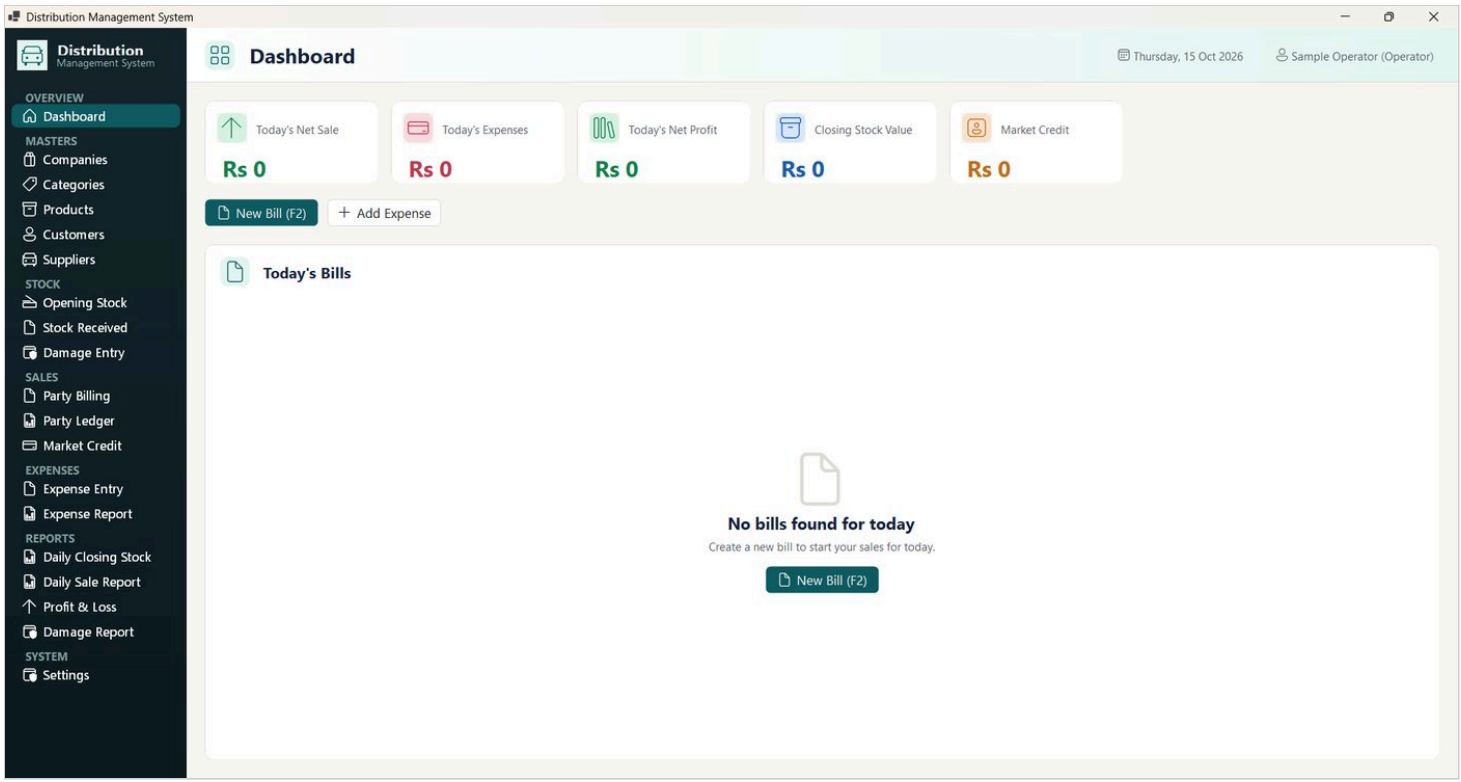


Figure 105: Signed in as an Operator. The SYSTEM group shows only Settings.

---

15. Notifications, Messages and Confirmations

Pop-up messages ("toasts")

A small coloured box appears at the bottom-right of the window for about two seconds.

Colour	Meaning	Examples
Green	Success	"Company saved.", "Product updated.", "Bill BILL-00001 saved.", "Purchase saved and stock updated.", "Opening stock saved.", "Damage entry saved.", "Expense saved.", "Area added.", "Reason added.", "Category added.", "User created.", "Password reset.", "User deactivated.", "Settings saved.", "Backup created successfully."
Red	Refused or failed. The message tells you why.	"Code and Name are required.", "Insufficient stock for '…'. Available: …, requested: ….", "Username already exists.", "Backup failed: …"

The application also writes a few messages in **red text inside the window**, for example "Invalid username or password." on the Sign-in window.

Empty-list messages

Shown in the middle of a list when it has nothing to show, for example "No customers found", "No purchases received today", "No opening stock recorded yet", "No damage entries recorded", "No bills yet today", "No expenses today", "No outstanding credit", "No expenses in this range", "No damage in this range", "No products to show", "Select a customer and date range".

Confirmation windows

Window title	Question	Buttons
Confirm delete	"Delete this company?" / "Delete this category?" / "Delete this product?" / "Delete this customer?" / "Delete this supplier?"	**Yes** deletes, **No** cancels
Confirm restore	"Restoring will overwrite existing data. Continue?"	**Yes** restores, **No** cancels

Deactivate / **Activate** on Users, and all Save buttons, do **not** ask for confirmation.

Input windows

Window title	Label	Opened by
New Area	Area / route name:	**+** next to Area / Route (Customers)
New Damage Reason	Reason name:	**+** next to Reason (Damage Entry)
New Expense Category	Category name:	**+** next to Category (Expense Entry)
Set Password	Enter an initial password for this user:	**Save** for a new user (Users)
Reset Password	Enter a new password for this user:	**Reset Password** (Users)

Each has **OK** (or **Enter**) and **Cancel** (or **Esc**).

Information windows

Window title	When
Imported: X, Updated: Y, Errors: Z	Excel import with errors (lists the row problems)
Error	"Import failed: ...", or "An unexpected error occurred: ..."

---

16. Error Handling and Troubleshooting

See TROUBLESHOOTING.md. The most important points:

1. **Read red messages.** They state exactly what is missing or wrong.
2. **Report figures only update when you ask.** Click **View Report**, **View Ledger** or **Apply Filter**.
3. **Check the form before Update or Delete.** Sorting a list can load the wrong record.
4. **An "Error" window** with "An unexpected error occurred" usually means a duplicate code. Click **OK**, change the code and try again.
5. **Transactions cannot be undone.** Check before saving.

16a. Notifications from Your Supplier

Your supplier can send messages to every shop that uses this software: new offers, price changes, holiday notices. They may include a poster or a video.

How you know a message has arrived

A **bell** appears at the top-right of the window with a red number: how many messages you have not read yet. The application looks for new messages when you start it and about once an hour after that.

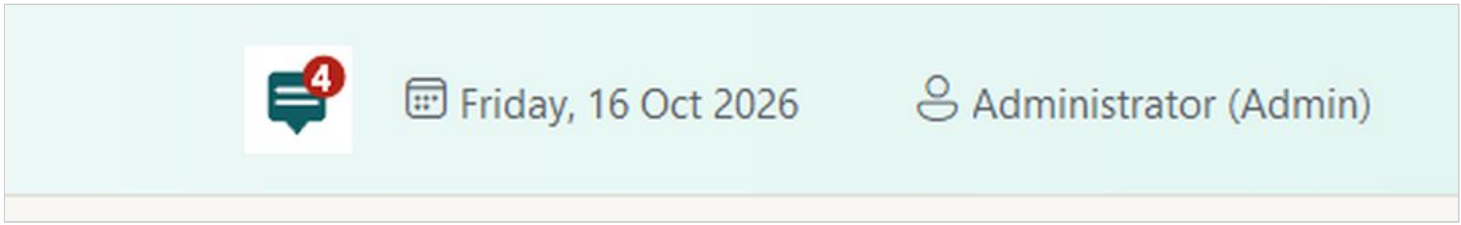


Figure 117: The bell with three unread messages

Reading messages

1. Click the **bell**.
2. The **Notifications** window opens. Messages are listed on the left, newest first. - A **red dot** marks a message you have not read. - The coloured stripe shows the kind: blue for news, green for an offer, red for something that needs your attention.
3. Click a message to read it on the right. It is marked as read straight away.
4. A poster appears above the text. A video has normal play, pause and volume controls.
5. Some messages have a button such as **See the offer**. It opens in your normal web browser.
6. **Mark all as read** clears every red dot at once.
7. Close the window with the **X**.

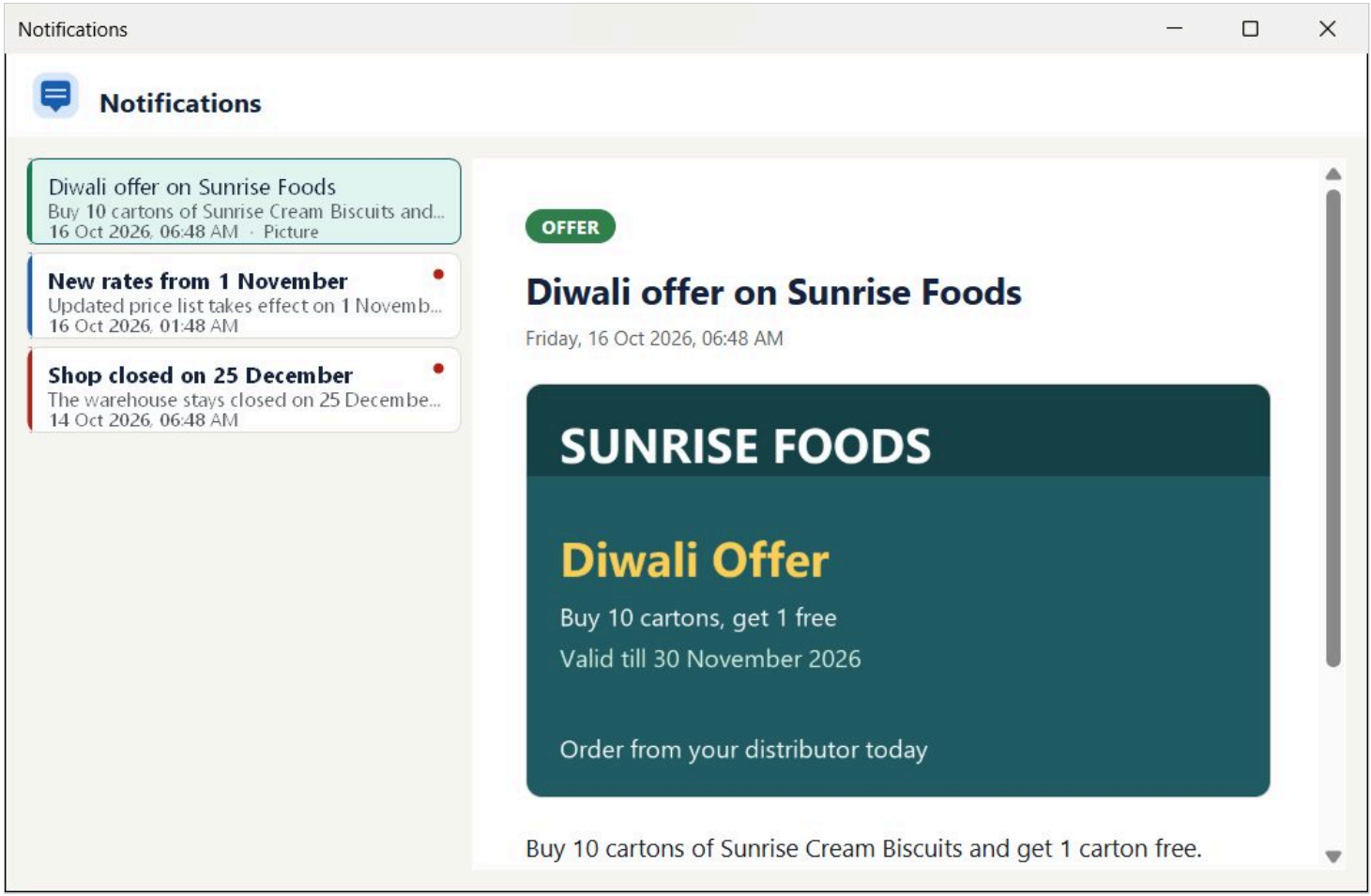


Figure 118: A message with a poster

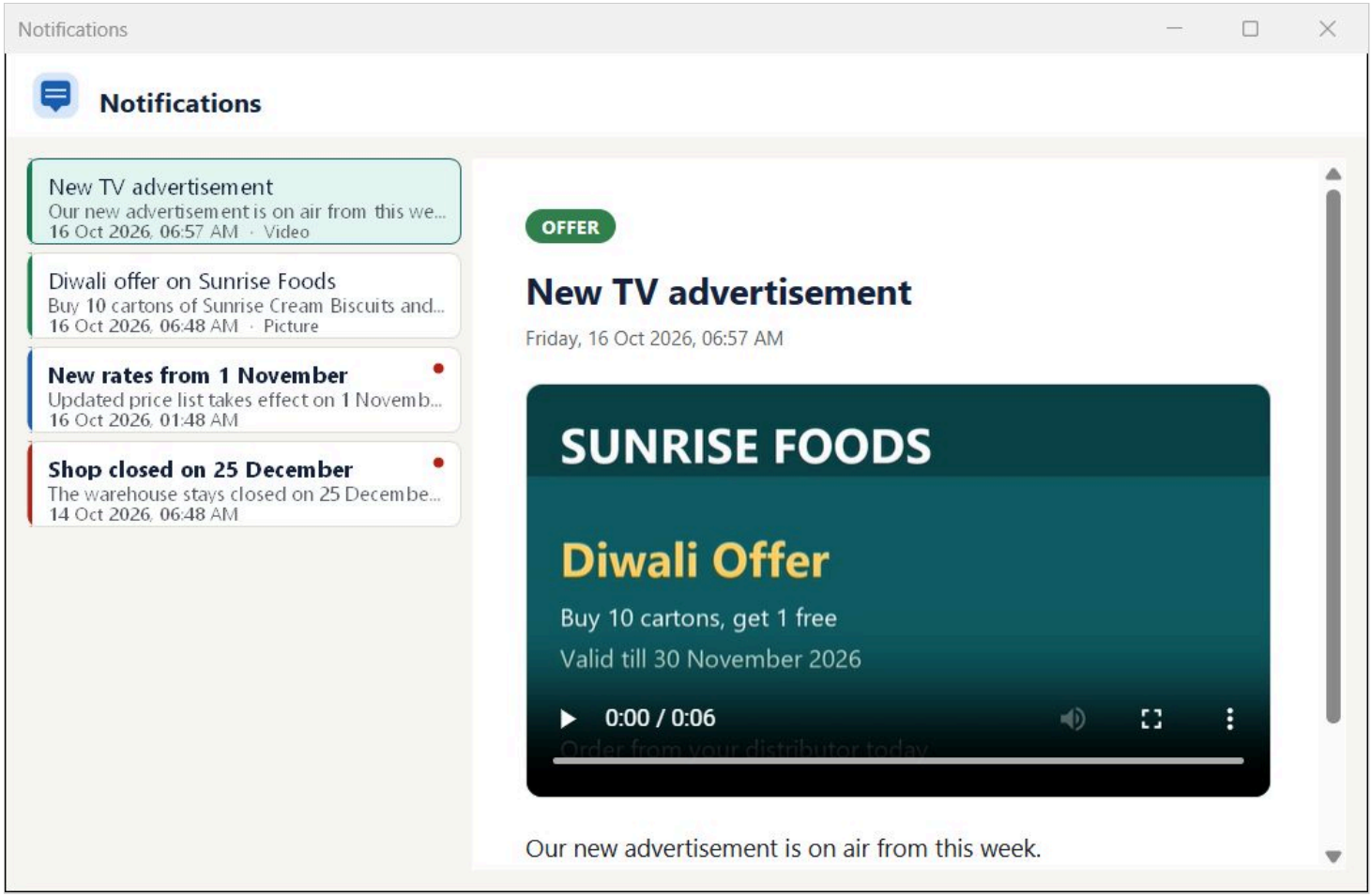


Figure 119: A message with a video

Points to note

- Messages are **read only**. You cannot reply from here.
- Read and unread is remembered on **this computer**. Another PC in the same shop keeps its own.
- Your supplier can set a message to disappear on a date, and can remove one at any time.
- With no internet the bell simply shows nothing new. Your work is not affected.
- If a picture or video does not appear and you see buttons such as **Open picture** instead, the **Microsoft Edge WebView2 Runtime** is missing on that PC. Ask your supplier or IT person to install it. The buttons still open the media in your usual programs.

16b. Software Updates

When your supplier improves the software, your copy offers the update by itself. You do not have to download anything by hand.

When an update is ready

A window appears:

> **A new version is available** — You have 1.0.0. New version: 1.0.1

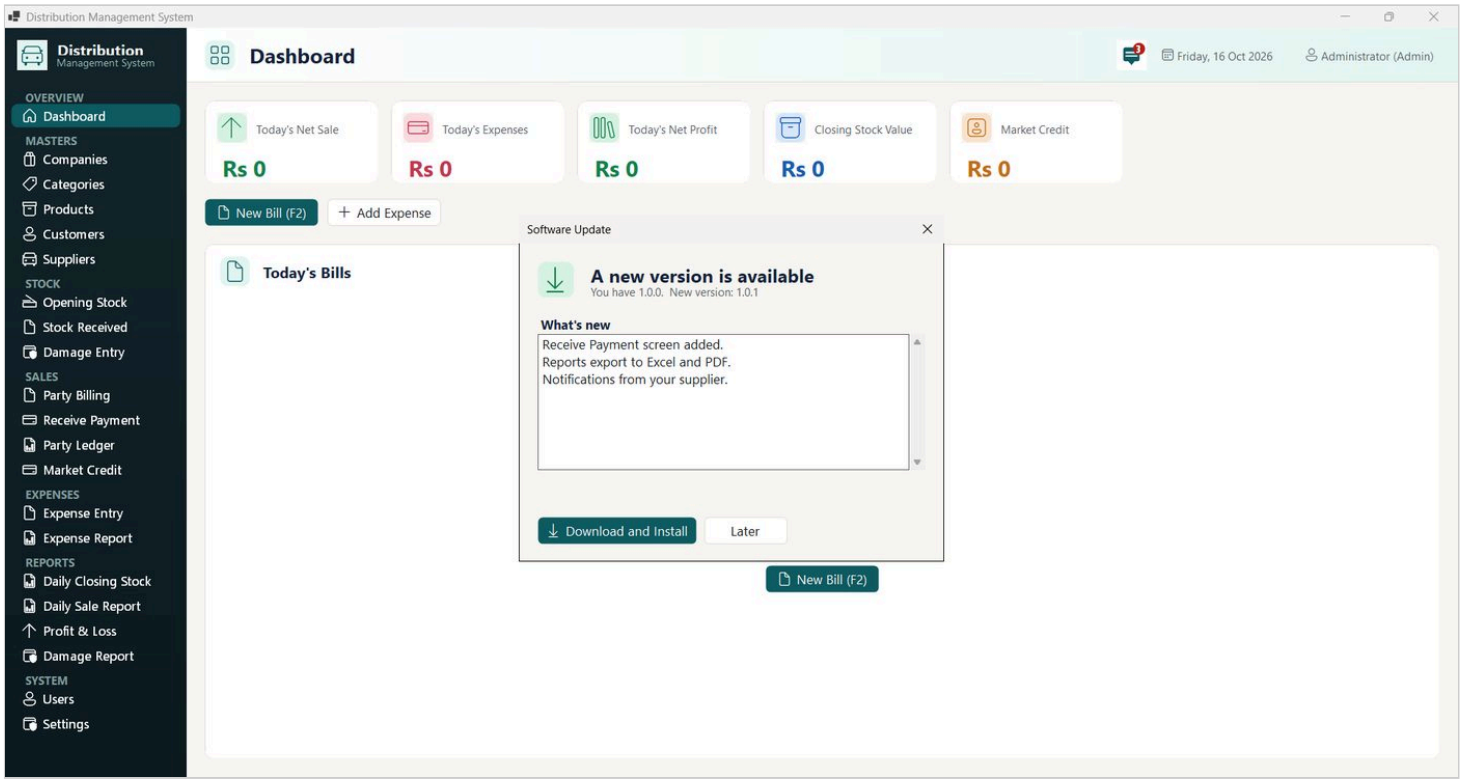


Figure 120: An update being offered

Button	What happens
Download and Install	Downloads the update and shows the progress. Carry on working while it downloads.
Later	Closes the window. You are offered it again at the next check.

After the download finishes the window says **Ready to install**:

Button	What happens
Restart Now	Asks you to confirm, then closes the application, installs, and opens the new version.
Restart Later	The update installs the next time you are offered it and choose to restart.

> **Save your work first.** Restarting closes the application. Anything typed into a form but not saved is lost. Finish or save the bill you are on, then restart.

Your data, your database settings and your customers' balances are **not** affected by an update.

Checking by hand

1. Open **Settings** under **SYSTEM**.
2. The **Software Update** card shows your installed version.
3. Click **Check for Updates**.

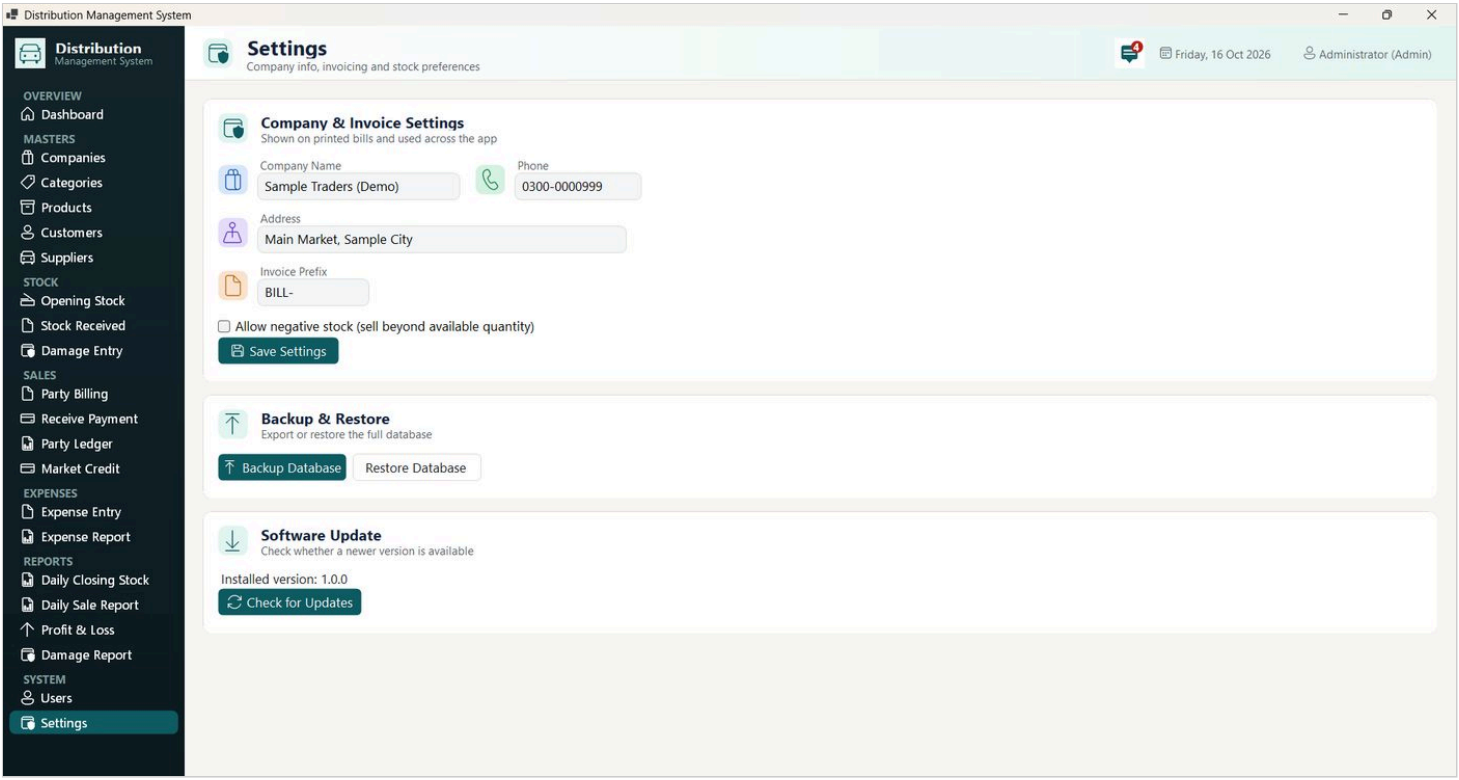


Figure 121: The Software Update card in Settings

You may see:

Message	Meaning
"You already have the latest version (1.0.1)."	Nothing to do.
The update window	A newer version is ready.
"This copy was not installed by the setup program, so it cannot update itself."	The application is being run from a copied folder. Ask your supplier for the installer.
"Updates are switched off for this computer."	Your supplier fixed this PC to one version on purpose.
"The update check did not work: ..."	Usually no internet. Try again later.

---

17. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: How do I print or save a report? A: Open the report, click **View Report**, then use **Export Excel**, **Export PDF** or **Print**. See Section 12.

Q: How do I print a single bill? A: Printing an individual bill is not available in this version. Note the bill number shown in the "Bill BILL-... saved." message. Bill details are in the Daily Sale Report, which can be printed, and in the customer's Party Ledger.

Q: I made a mistake in a saved bill. How do I correct it? A: Saved bills cannot be edited or deleted. Inform your administrator. See TROUBLESHOOTING.md, Section 13.

Q: A customer came to pay old dues without buying anything. Where do I enter it? A: Use **SALES → Receive Payment**. Choose the customer, enter the amount, choose Cash or Bank, and click **Save Receipt**. The balance reduces

straight away. See W15.

Q: Why does my whole bill go on credit? A: A bill only reduces the customer's balance by whatever you type in **Cash Received**. If you leave it at 0, the full amount is added to their account. Enter the cash collected before saving, or record it later with **Receive Payment**. After saving, the message tells you exactly how much went on credit.

Q: Why does the Dashboard show Rs 0? A: The dashboard figures are not connected to data in this version. Use Daily Sale Report, Profit & Loss, Daily Closing Stock and Market Credit.

Q: I added a new customer but cannot find them in Party Billing. A: Open Party Billing again (click another screen, then Party Billing). Screens reload their lists each time you open them. If it still does not appear, check that the customer was saved on the Customers screen.

Q: Why does Products show 0 in stock after I received goods? A: Open the screen again, or type a letter in the search box and delete it. Screens reload when you open them.

Q: What is the difference between Purchase Rate and Avg Cost? A: **Purchase Rate** is a reference price you type. **Avg Cost** is calculated automatically from your actual opening stock and purchases, and is used for profit, damage loss and stock value.

Q: The supplier's Payable Balance never changes. Why? A: It shows only the opening balance. Purchases and supplier payments are not tracked in this version.

Q: Can I give a bigger discount than allowed? A: Only an **Admin** can exceed a product's **Max Discount %**. Others see "Discount ...% exceeds max allowed ...%".

Q: What does "Bilti Charges" do? A: It is the freight or transport cost of a delivery. When you save the purchase, it is automatically recorded as a business expense in the "Bilti / Freight" category. Do not enter it again on Expense Entry.

Q: I deleted a product (or customer) by mistake. Can I get it back? A: Not from within the application, and its code cannot be reused. Contact your administrator, who may restore from a backup.

Q: How do I change my password? A: Ask an Admin to set a new one with **Reset Password** on the Users screen.

Q: How do I sign out? A: Close the application with the **X** button.

Q: A bell with a red number appeared at the top. What is it? A: Your supplier has sent you a message. Click the bell to read it. See Section 16a.

Q: The application says a new version is available. Is it safe to install? A: Yes. It comes from your supplier. Save whatever you are typing, then click **Download and Install** and **Restart Now**. Your data is not touched.

Q: I clicked Later on the update. Did I lose it? A: No. You are offered it again at the next check, or you can use **Settings → Check for Updates**.

Q: Can I reply to a notification? A: No. Notifications only come one way. Phone your supplier to reply.

Q: The F2 and Ctrl+S keys do not work. A: The keyboard shortcuts shown on buttons are not active in this version. Click the buttons.

Q: Why are numbers in the lists rounded? A: Lists display whole numbers. The exact values (including decimals) are stored and used in calculations.

Q: The Invoice Prefix in Settings does not change my bill numbers. A: In this version bill numbers always start with BILL-.

---

18. Keyboard Use

Where	Key	Effect	Status
Sign-in window, Password box	**Enter**	Signs in	Works
Number boxes (− value +)	**Enter**, **Tab**	Confirms the typed number	Works
Input windows (New Area, Set Password, etc.)	**Enter** / **Esc**	OK / Cancel	Works
Any form	**Tab** / **Shift+Tab**	Next / previous field	Works (standard Windows)
Drop-down lists	**Up/Down arrows**, first letters	Change the selection	Standard Windows behaviour
Date boxes	**Up/Down arrows**	Change the selected day, month or year	Works
Buttons labelled **(Ctrl+S)**	**Ctrl+S**	—	**Not active**. Click the button.
Buttons labelled **(Esc)**	**Esc**	—	**Not active**. Click the button.
New Bill (F2)	**F2**	—	**Not active**. Click the button.
Login (Enter) in the Username box	**Enter**	—	Does nothing. Press Tab first.

---

19. Glossary of Application Terms

Term	Meaning
Admin / Operator / Viewer	User roles. See Section 14.
Area / Route	A delivery area or salesman's route that groups customers.
Avg Cost (average cost)	The weighted average purchase cost of the stock you hold, updated automatically with each opening stock entry and purchase. Used to value stock and calculate profit and damage loss.
Bill / Party Bill	A sale invoice to a customer, numbered BILL-00001, BILL-00002, …
Bill Discount	A discount in rupees on the whole bill, in addition to line discounts.
Bilti	Freight or transport charges paid when goods are delivered (from the name of the transport receipt). Recorded automatically as an expense.
Box / Ctn / Pcs / Bag	Counting units: box, carton, pieces, bag.

Term	Meaning
Category	A product group, for example Beverages.
COGS (Cost of Goods Sold)	The cost value of the goods sold (quantity × average cost at the time of sale).
Company	A manufacturer or brand whose products you distribute.
Credit (on Daily Sale Report)	The part of a bill not paid in cash, added to the customer's account.
Customer / Party	A shop or business you sell to.
Damage	Goods that are broken, expired or lost and removed from stock.
Debit / Credit (ledger)	Debit increases what the customer owes (a bill). Credit reduces it (a payment).
DSR	Daily Sale Report.
Found At	Where damaged goods were found: Godown, In Transit, or Returned by Party.
Godown	Warehouse or store room.
Gross Sale	Total sales before discounts.
In Stock	Current quantity held: all stock in minus all stock out.
Invoice No	The supplier's own invoice number for a delivery.
Kiryana	A general grocery shop (common customer type in the examples).
Ledger	A list of a customer's transactions with a running balance.
Market Credit	The total amount customers owe you.
Max Discount %	The highest line discount a non-Admin user may give on a product.
Net Sale / Net Bill	Sales after all discounts.
Opening Balance	The amount a customer owed you (or you owed a supplier) when you started using the application.
Opening Stock	Stock you already held when you started using the application.
Payable Balance	What you owe a supplier. In this version, the opening balance only.
Pcs per Unit	Pieces in one unit (for example 24 packets per carton).
Previous Balance	What the customer owed before the bill being created.
Receipt (RCPT-...)	A record of cash received from a customer, created from Cash Received on a bill.
Ref No (DMG-...)	Automatic reference number of a damage entry.
Running Balance	The customer's balance after each ledger row.
Sale Rate / Purchase Rate	Normal selling and buying prices per unit.
Self Expense	A personal (owner's) expense, kept separate from business expenses in Profit & Loss.
Short Code / Code	A short unique identifier for a record.
Supplier	A party you buy stock from.
Toast	The small pop-up message at the bottom-right of the window.

Term	Meaning
Voucher No (EXP-... / BILTI-...)	Automatic number of an expense.

---

20. Quick Reference Guide

Where do I...?

I want to...	Go to	Then
Make a bill	SALES → **Party Billing**	Customer → add lines → Cash Received → **Save Bill**
Receive a delivery	STOCK → **Stock Received**	Supplier, Invoice No → add lines → **Save Purchase**
Record broken or expired goods	STOCK → **Damage Entry**	Product, Qty, Reason, Found At → **Save**
Record an expense	EXPENSES → **Expense Entry**	Category, Amount, Paid From → **Save**
Add a product	MASTERS → **Products**	Code, Name, Company, Category, Unit, rates → **Save**
Add a customer	MASTERS → **Customers**	Code, Shop Name, Area (+) → **Save**
Record a payment from a customer	SALES → **Receive Payment**	Customer, Amount, Cash/Bank → **Save Receipt**
See a customer's account	SALES → **Party Ledger**	Customer, dates → **View Ledger**
See who owes money	SALES → **Market Credit**	Open it, or click **Refresh**
See today's sales	REPORTS → **Daily Sale Report**	**View Report**
See stock	REPORTS → **Daily Closing Stock** or MASTERS → **Products** (In Stock)	**View Report** / refresh search
See profit	REPORTS → **Profit & Loss**	From, To → **View Report**
Add a staff login	SYSTEM → **Users** (Admin)	Username, Full Name, **Role** → **Save** → password
Back up data	SYSTEM → **Settings**	**Backup Database**
Print or save a report	Any report screen	**View Report** → **Export Excel** / **Export PDF** / **Print**
Refresh a report	Any report screen	**View Report**, **View Ledger** or **Apply Filter**
Read a message from my supplier	Top bar	Click the 🔔 **bell**
Check for a new version	SYSTEM → **Settings**	**Check for Updates**
Sign out	—	Close the window (**X**)

Automatic numbers

Number	Created by	Example
Bill No	Party Billing	BILL-00001
Receipt No	Cash Received on a bill, or Receive Payment	RCPT-00001
Voucher No	Expense Entry	EXP-00001
Bilti voucher	Stock Received with Bilti Charges	BILTI-1
Damage Ref No	Damage Entry	DMG-00001

Ten golden rules

1. Set up masters in order: Companies → Categories → Products; Areas → Customers; Companies → Suppliers.
2. Watch for the green or red message after every Save.
3. Check every bill and purchase before saving. They cannot be edited.
4. Never sort master lists by clicking column headings.
5. Check the code and name in the form before Update or Delete.
6. On report screens, click **View Report** after changing a date or filter.
7. Do not enter bilti again as an expense.
8. Choose the user **Role** carefully. The default is Admin.
9. Back up every day and keep copies on two devices.
10. Never use **Restore Database** without your administrator.
11. Save your work before restarting for an update.

---

21. Documentation Coverage

See DOCUMENTATION_COVERAGE.md for the full list of screens, forms, workflows and screenshots covered, and the items that still need verification.

Screen and Form Reference

Distribution Management System — Desktop Application for Windows

This reference describes every screen of the application, one screen at a time. For each screen you will find:

- what the screen is for and how to open it,
- a screenshot of the real application,
- what every button, box and list column does,
- a field-by-field table for every form,
- what happens after you save, and which other screens are affected.

For step-by-step business procedures (for example "receive a delivery and sell it"), see WORKFLOW_GUIDES.md. For error messages, see TROUBLESHOOTING.md.

> **About the screenshots.** All screenshots were captured from the real running application using **made-up example data** (for example "Sunrise Foods", "Al-Madina General Store"). Any resemblance to real businesses is accidental. Figure numbers match the image file numbers, for example *Figure 25* is `25-products-list.png`. Figures ending in "a" (for example *Figure 25a*) are copies of the same screenshot with red numbered markers added.

Contents

1. Sign-in Window
2. Main Window and Navigation
3. Dashboard
4. Companies
5. Categories
6. Products
7. Customers
8. Suppliers
9. Opening Stock
10. Stock Received
11. Damage Entry
12. Party Billing 12a. Receive Payment
13. Party Ledger
14. Market Credit
15. Expense Entry
16. Expense Report
17. Daily Closing Stock
18. Daily Sale Report
19. Profit & Loss
20. Damage Report
21. Users
22. Settings 22a. Notifications Window 22b. Software Update Window

23. Common Controls Used on Many Screens

---

1. Sign-in Window

Overview

Window title	Sign in — Distribution Management System
Purpose	Confirms who you are before the application opens.
Who uses it	Everyone.
What you can do	Enter your username and password, show or hide the password, and sign in.

How to open it

1. Double-click the **Distribution Management System** icon (or the program file `Distribution.WinForms.exe`) supplied by your administrator.
2. The Sign-in window appears in the middle of the screen.

Screenshot

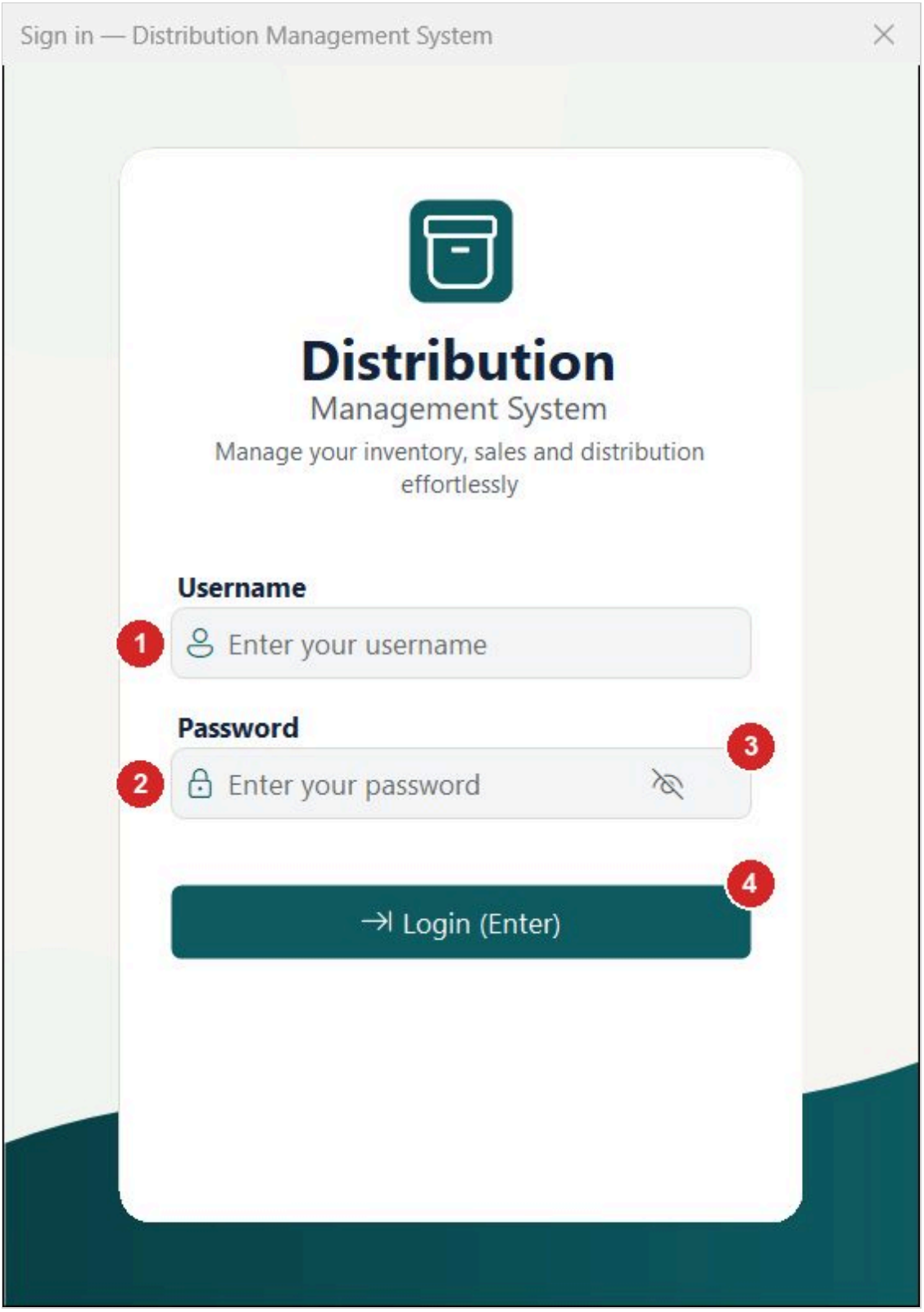


Figure 1a: Sign-in window (numbered). Unmarked original: Figure 1.

No.	Control	What it does
1	**Username** box	Type your username exactly as the administrator created it. Usernames are case-sensitive: `Operator1` and `operator1` are different.
2	**Password** box	Type your password. The characters are hidden as dots.
3	Eye icon	Click to show the password as normal text. Click again to hide it. Use this to check for typing mistakes.

No.	Control	What it does
4	**Login (Enter)** button	Checks your username and password. If they are correct, the main window opens. You can also press **Enter** while the cursor is in the Password box.

What happens next

- **Correct username and password:** the Sign-in window closes and the main window opens on the **Dashboard** (see Section 2).
- **Wrong username or password:** the red message **"Invalid username or password."** appears under the Password box (Figure 2). Nothing else happens; correct your entry and try again.
- **Deactivated account:** shows the same message, "Invalid username or password." Ask your administrator to activate your account (see Users).
- **Closing the window** with the **X** button closes the application without signing in.

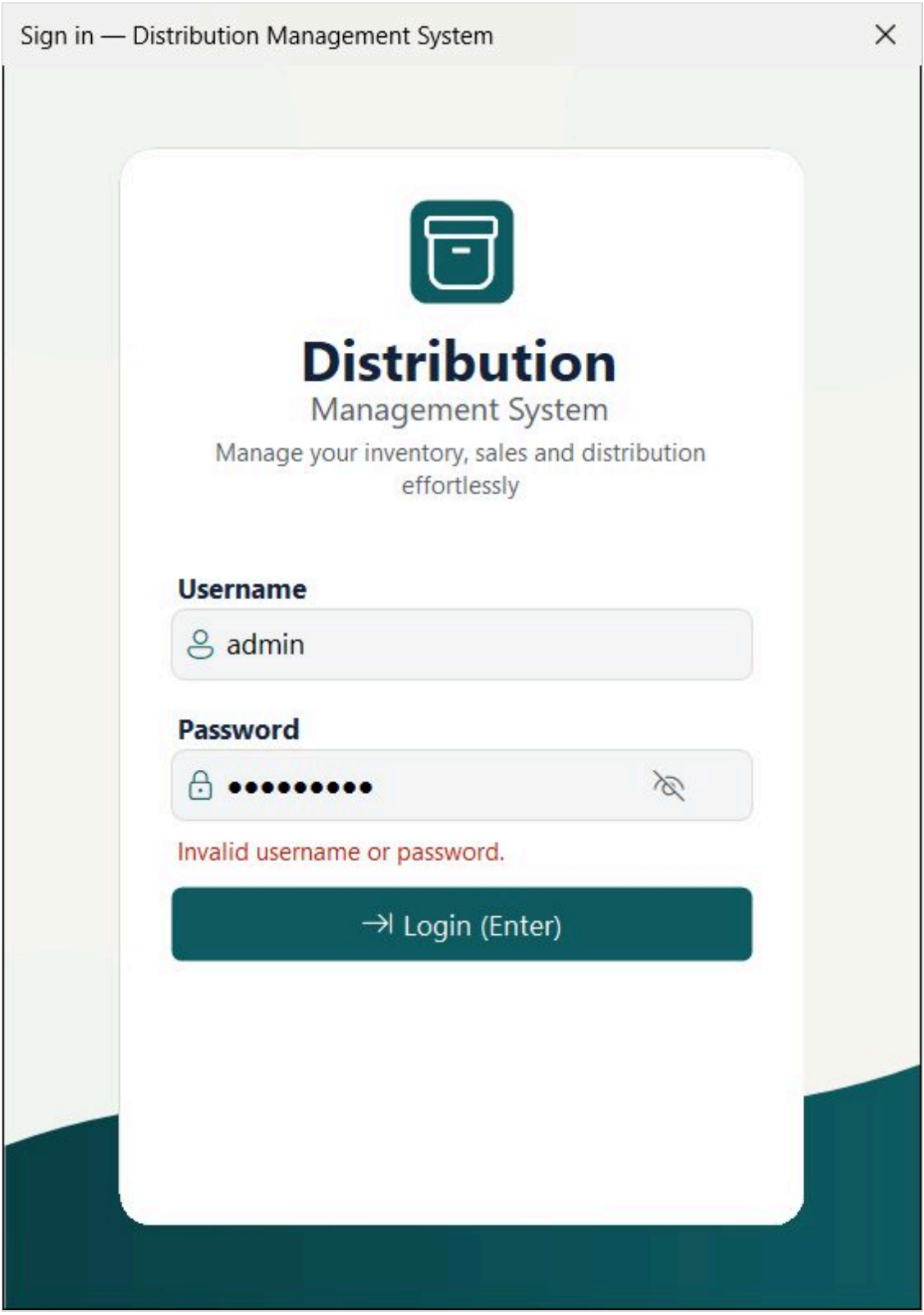


Figure 2: Message shown when the username or password is wrong

> **Note:** Pressing **Enter** while the cursor is in the **Username** box does not sign you in. Press **Tab** to move to the Password box, then press **Enter**.
>
> **First-time use:** When the application is started on a brand-new, empty database, it automatically creates one administrator account. See Getting Started in USER_MANUAL.md for the first sign-in and the mandatory

> password change.

---

2. Main Window and Navigation

Overview

After you sign in, the main window opens maximised (it fills the screen). It has three areas: the **side menu** on the left, the **top bar**, and the **work area** where screens appear.

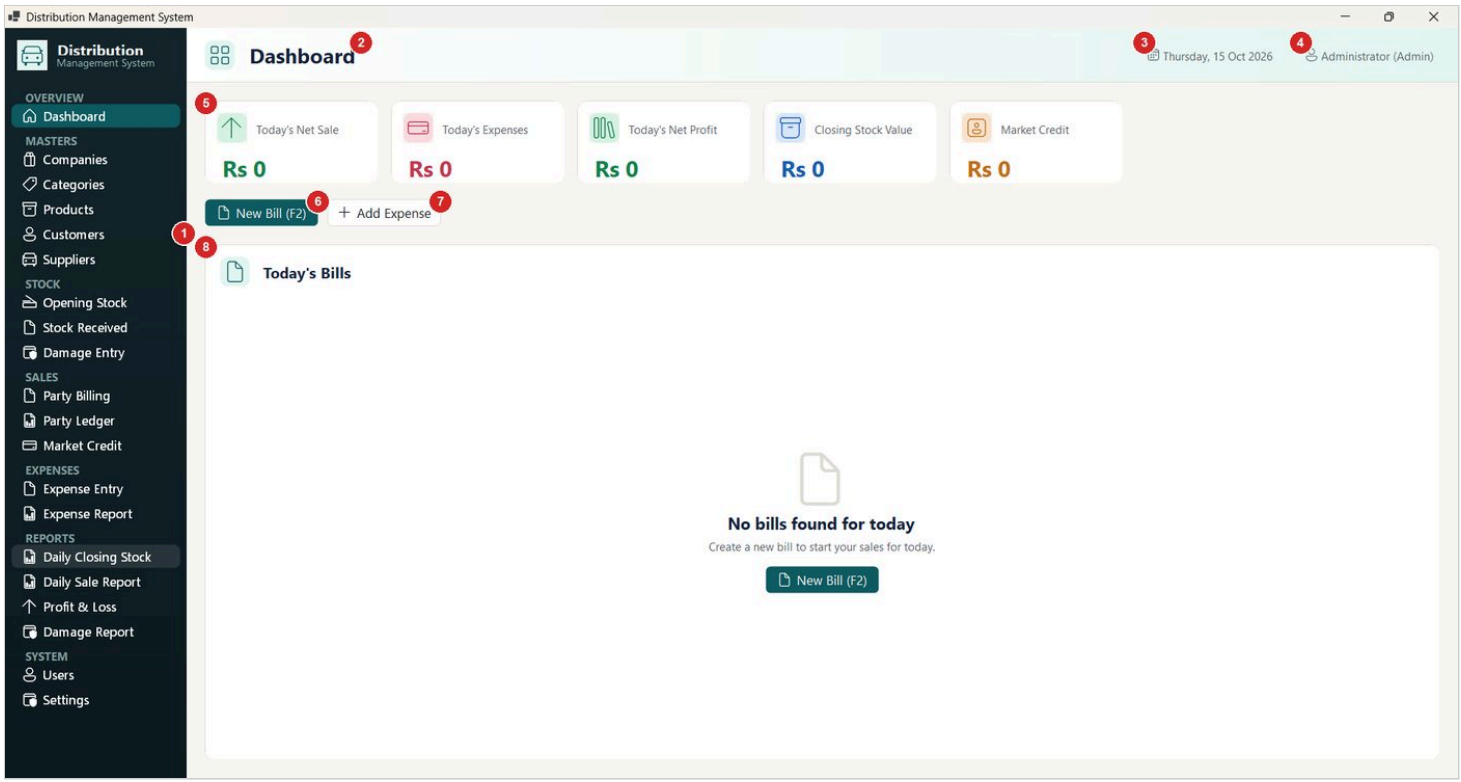


Figure 3a: Main window layout (numbered)

No.	Area	Description
1	**Side menu**	Lists every screen, grouped under headings: OVERVIEW, MASTERS, STOCK, SALES, EXPENSES, REPORTS and SYSTEM. Click a name to open that screen. The screen you are on is highlighted in green.
2	**Screen title**	Shows the name of the open screen and a short description under it.
3	**Today's date**	The current date as set on your computer, for example *Thursday, 15 Oct 2026*. A **bell** appears to its left once your supplier has sent a message; see Notifications Window.
4	**Signed-in user**	Your full name and role, for example *Administrator (Admin)*.
5–8	Dashboard contents	See Dashboard.

Side menu items

Group	Menu item	Opens
OVERVIEW	Dashboard	Dashboard
MASTERS	Companies	Companies
	Categories	Categories
	Products	Products
	Customers	Customers
	Suppliers	Suppliers
STOCK	Opening Stock	Opening Stock
	Stock Received	Stock Received
	Damage Entry	Damage Entry
SALES	Party Billing	Party Billing
	Receive Payment	Receive Payment
	Party Ledger	Party Ledger
	Market Credit	Market Credit
EXPENSES	Expense Entry	Expense Entry
	Expense Report	Expense Report
REPORTS	Daily Closing Stock	Daily Closing Stock
	Daily Sale Report	Daily Sale Report
	Profit & Loss	Profit & Loss
	Damage Report	Damage Report
SYSTEM	Users	Users (shown to **Admin** users only)
	Settings	Settings

Important behaviour when moving between screens

> **Screens reload when you open them.** Each time you click a screen in the side menu, it reloads its lists and drop-downs from the database. A company, category, product, customer, supplier or area added on one screen is available on the others straight away — **no restart is needed**.
>
> - Whatever you typed is kept while you switch screens and come back, so a half-finished bill is not lost.
> - Your current selection is kept where it still exists. If the record you had chosen has since been deleted, the first item in the list is selected instead, so **check the selection before saving**.
> - **Report results are not recalculated on their own**, because they depend on the dates and filters you choose. Click **View Report**, **View Ledger** or **Apply Filter**.
>
> Lists also reload after you save on the same screen. See TROUBLESHOOTING.md if something still looks out of date.

Signing out and switching users

There is **no Sign out or Logout button**. To finish your work or switch to another user:

1. Click the **X** (Close) button at the top-right corner of the main window. The application closes.
2. Start the application again. The Sign-in window appears and you can sign in as any user.

Window behaviour

- The window cannot be made smaller than 1366 × 768 pixels.
- Several screens are taller than the window (for example Party Billing and Daily Sale Report). Use the mouse wheel or the scroll bar on the right of the work area to see the lower parts.

---

3. Dashboard

Overview

Screen title	Dashboard
Purpose	The first screen after sign-in, with shortcut buttons to create a bill or an expense.
Who uses it	Everyone.

How to open it

It opens automatically after sign-in. At other times, click **Dashboard** under **OVERVIEW** in the side menu.

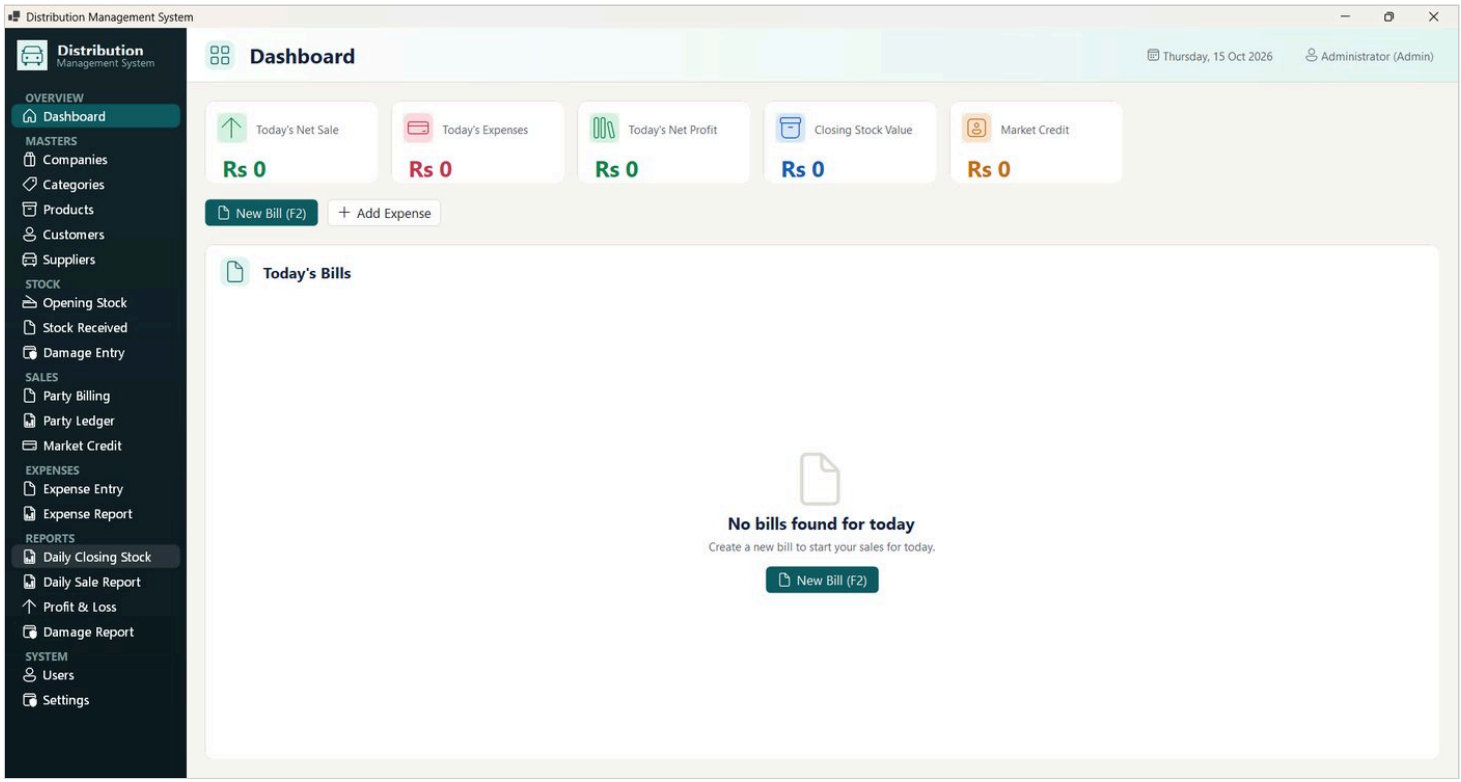


Figure 3: Dashboard

Controls

Control	What it does
Today's Net Sale, **Today's Expenses**, **Today's Net Profit**, **Closing Stock Value**, **Market Credit** cards	Summary cards. **In this version these cards always show "Rs 0"**, even after bills, expenses and stock have been recorded (Figure 91). Use the report screens for real figures (see the table below).
New Bill (F2) button	Opens the Party Billing screen. (The **F2** key itself does not work; click the button.)
Add Expense button	Opens the Expense Entry screen.
Today's Bills panel	Always shows **"No bills found for today"** in this version, even when bills exist (Figure 91). The **New Bill (F2)** button inside it also opens Party Billing.

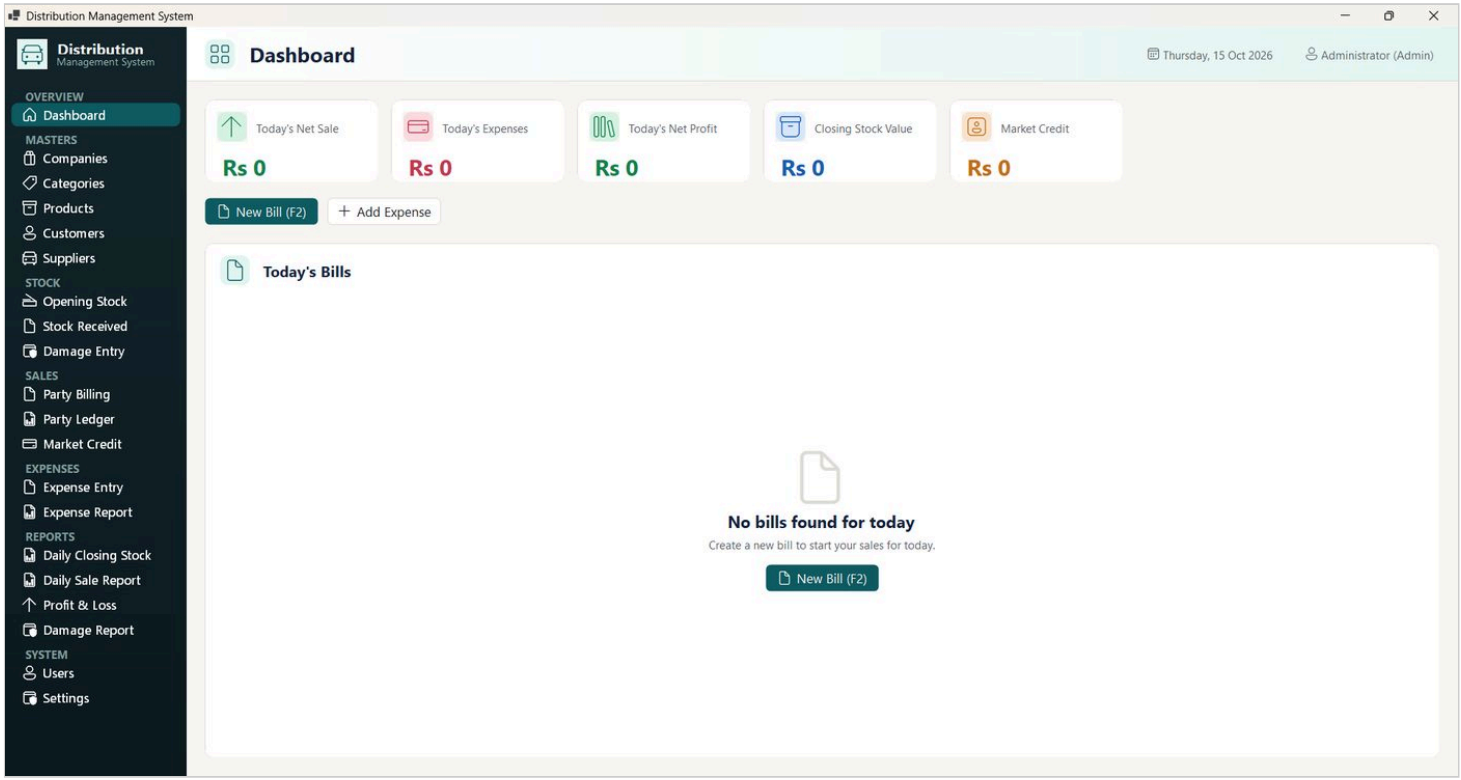


Figure 91: Dashboard after three bills and three expenses were saved on the same day. The figures do not change.

Where to find the real figures:

Dashboard card	Use this screen instead
Today's Net Sale	Daily Sale Report or Profit & Loss (From and To = today)
Today's Expenses	Expense Report or the **Today's Expenses** list on Expense Entry
Today's Net Profit	Profit & Loss
Closing Stock Value	Daily Closing Stock (**Value** column)
Market Credit	Market Credit
Today's Bills	**Today's Bills** list at the bottom of Party Billing

---

4. Companies

Overview

Screen title	Companies — *Manage your company records easily*
Purpose	Keeps the list of manufacturers or brands whose products you distribute (for example "Sunrise Foods").
Why it matters	Every product and every supplier must belong to a company. Create companies **first**.
Who uses it	Admin, Operator, Viewer (see roles).

How to open it

Click **Companies** under **MASTERS** in the side menu.

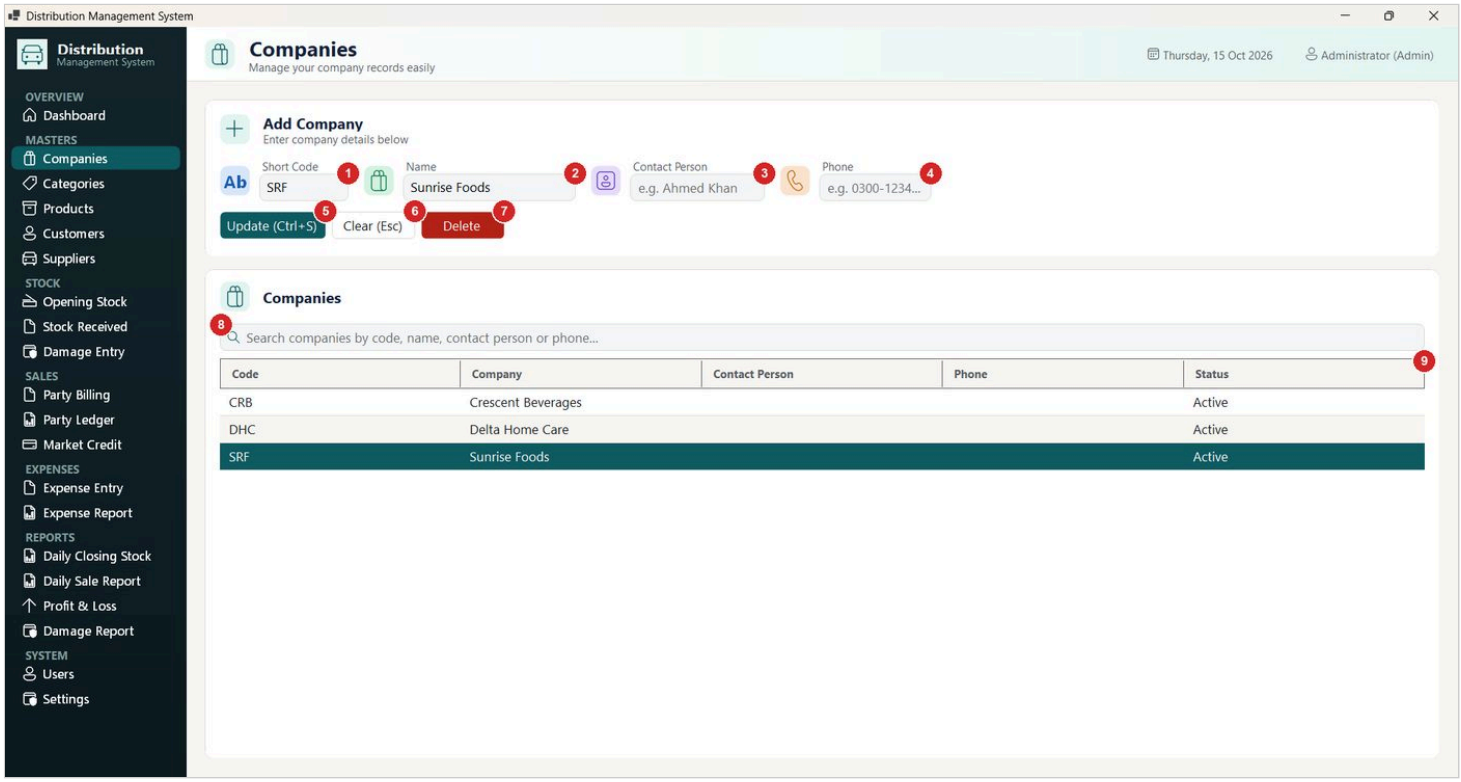


Figure 9a: Companies screen in edit mode (numbered)

No.	Control	Purpose and effect
1	**Short Code**	A short unique code for the company, for example `SRF`.
2	**Name**	Full company name.
3	**Contact Person**	Name of your contact at the company (optional).
4	**Phone**	Contact phone number (optional).
5	**Save (Ctrl+S)** / **Update (Ctrl+S)**	Saves a new company, or saves your changes when you are editing an existing one. The label changes to **Update** when a company is loaded from the list.
6	**Clear (Esc)**	Empties the form and leaves edit mode. Nothing is saved or deleted.
7	**Delete**	Deletes the company that is loaded in the form. It only works in edit mode; otherwise clicking it does nothing (the button looks the same in both cases).

No.	Control	Purpose and effect
8	Search box	Filters the list as you type. **Searches by code and name only**, even though the hint text also mentions contact person and phone (see Figure 14).
9	**Companies** list	All companies. Click a row to load it into the form for editing.

> **Keyboard shortcuts shown on buttons do not work.** Labels such as *(Ctrl+S)* and *(Esc)* appear on the buttons, but pressing those keys does nothing in this version. Click the buttons with the mouse.

Form: Add Company

Field Name	Purpose	Required/Optional	How to Enter the Value	Validation/Restrictions
Short Code	Unique short identifier	**Required**	Type text, for example `SRF`	Maximum 20 characters. Must be unique: it cannot repeat the code of **any** company, including deleted ones. A repeated code produces a technical error message (Figure 13).
Name	Company's full name	**Required**	Type text, for example `Sunrise Foods`	Up to 200 characters.
Contact Person	Your contact at the company	Optional	Type text	Up to 200 characters.
Phone	Contact number	Optional	Type text, for example `0300-0000001`	Any text is accepted. There is no format check. Up to 50 characters.

List columns

Column	Meaning
Code	The Short Code.
Company	The company name. The list is sorted by this name.
Contact Person	Contact person, if entered.
Phone	Phone, if entered.
Status	Always **Active** for companies shown in this list. There is no way to deactivate a company in this version.

Screen states

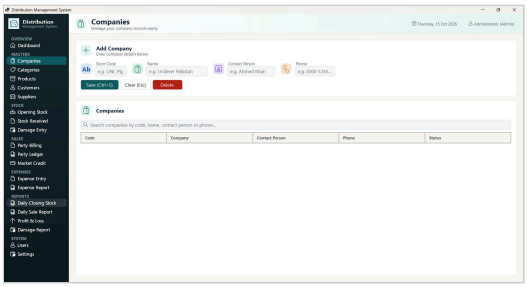
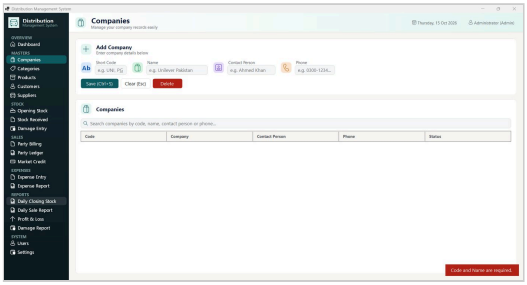
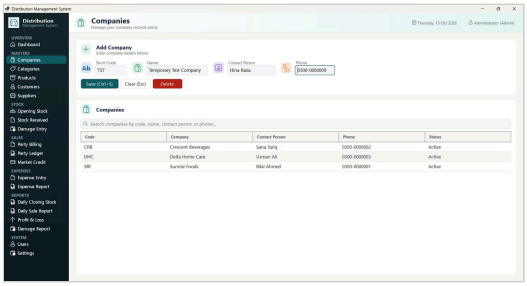
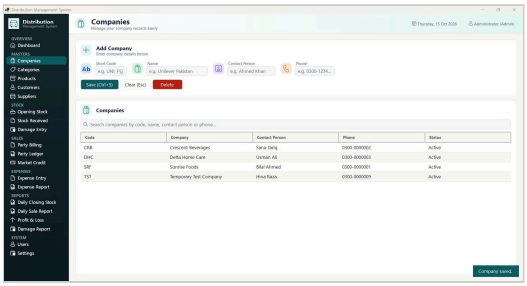
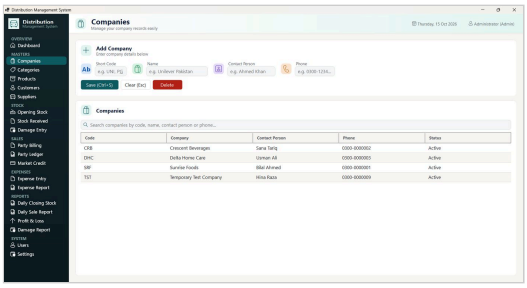
Figure	State
 **Figure 4**	Screen when no companies exist yet.
 **Figure 5**	Clicking **Save** with an empty Code or Name shows the red message **"Code and Name are required."** at the bottom-right.
 **Figure 6**	Form filled with example data before saving.
 **Figure 7**	After saving: green message **"Company saved."**, the form is cleared, and the new company appears in the list.
 **Figure 8**	The list with four companies after saving.

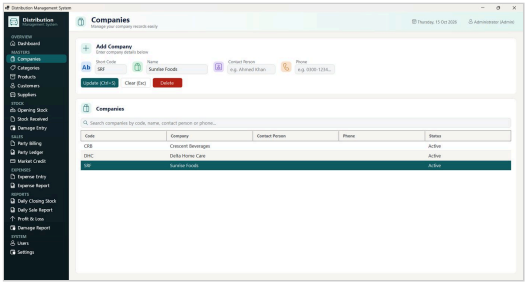
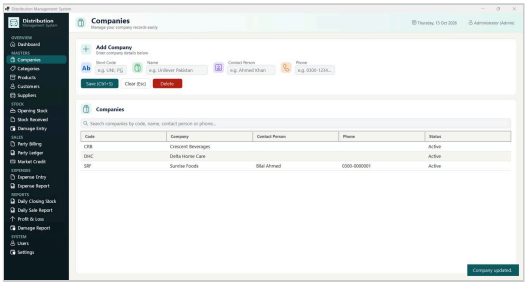
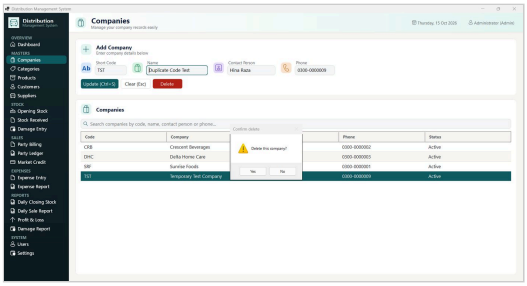
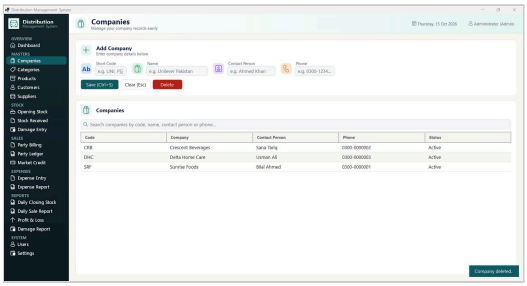
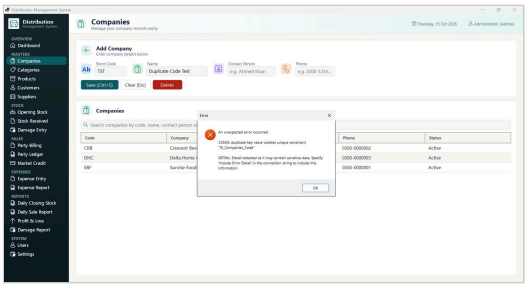
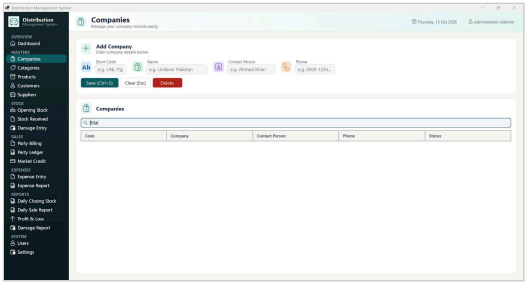
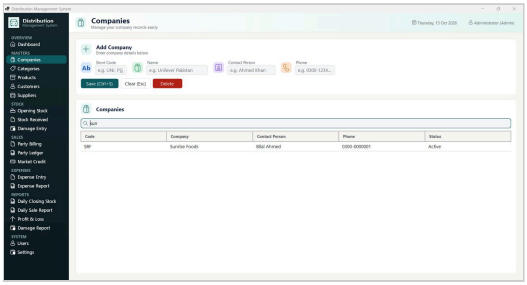
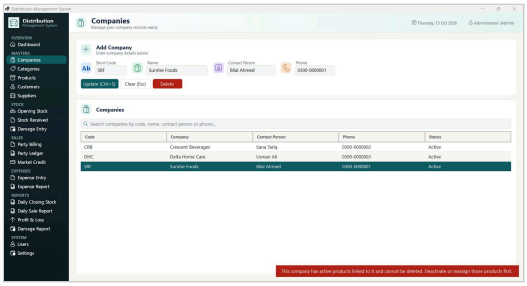
Figure	State
 **Figure 9**	After clicking a row: the details load into the form and the button changes to **Update (Ctrl+S)**.
 **Figure 10**	After **Update**: green message **"Company updated."**
 **Figure 11**	Clicking **Delete** asks **"Delete this company?"** with **Yes** and **No**.
 **Figure 12**	After **Yes**: green message **"Company deleted."** and the company disappears from the list.
 **Figure 13**	Saving a code that already exists (even for a deleted company) shows an **Error** window starting "An unexpected error occurred: 23505: duplicate key value...". Click **OK** and use a different code.

Figure	State
 **Figure 14**	Searching by a contact person's name finds nothing.
 **Figure 15**	Searching "sun" finds *Sunrise Foods*.
 **Figure 33**	A company that still has products cannot be deleted. Red message: **"This company has active products linked to it and cannot be deleted. Deactivate or reassign those products first."**

Effects of actions

Action	Immediate result	Where it appears	Further effects
Save a new company	"Company saved." and the form clears	Companies list	Available straight away in the **Company** drop-downs on Products and Suppliers, and in the company filters on Products and Daily Closing Stock, the next time you open those screens.
Update a company	"Company updated."	Companies list	The new name appears on Products, Suppliers and reports the next time they load.
Delete a company	Confirmation, then "Company deleted."	Disappears from the list	Blocked if any product or supplier still belongs to the company. The code stays reserved and cannot be reused. A deleted company cannot be restored from the application.

> **Warning — sorting the list.** Clicking a column heading sorts the list. After sorting, clicking a row can load a **different** company into the form (Figures 107 and 108). Always check the **Short Code** and **Name** in the form before clicking **Update** or **Delete**. See TROUBLESHOOTING.md. This applies to every list on the Companies, Categories, Products, Customers, Suppliers and Users screens.

---

5. Categories

Overview

Screen title	Categories — *Manage product categories for your inventory*
Purpose	Keeps the product groups (for example Beverages, Snacks, Household).
Why it matters	Every product must have a category. Create categories before products.

How to open it

Click **Categories** under **MASTERS**.

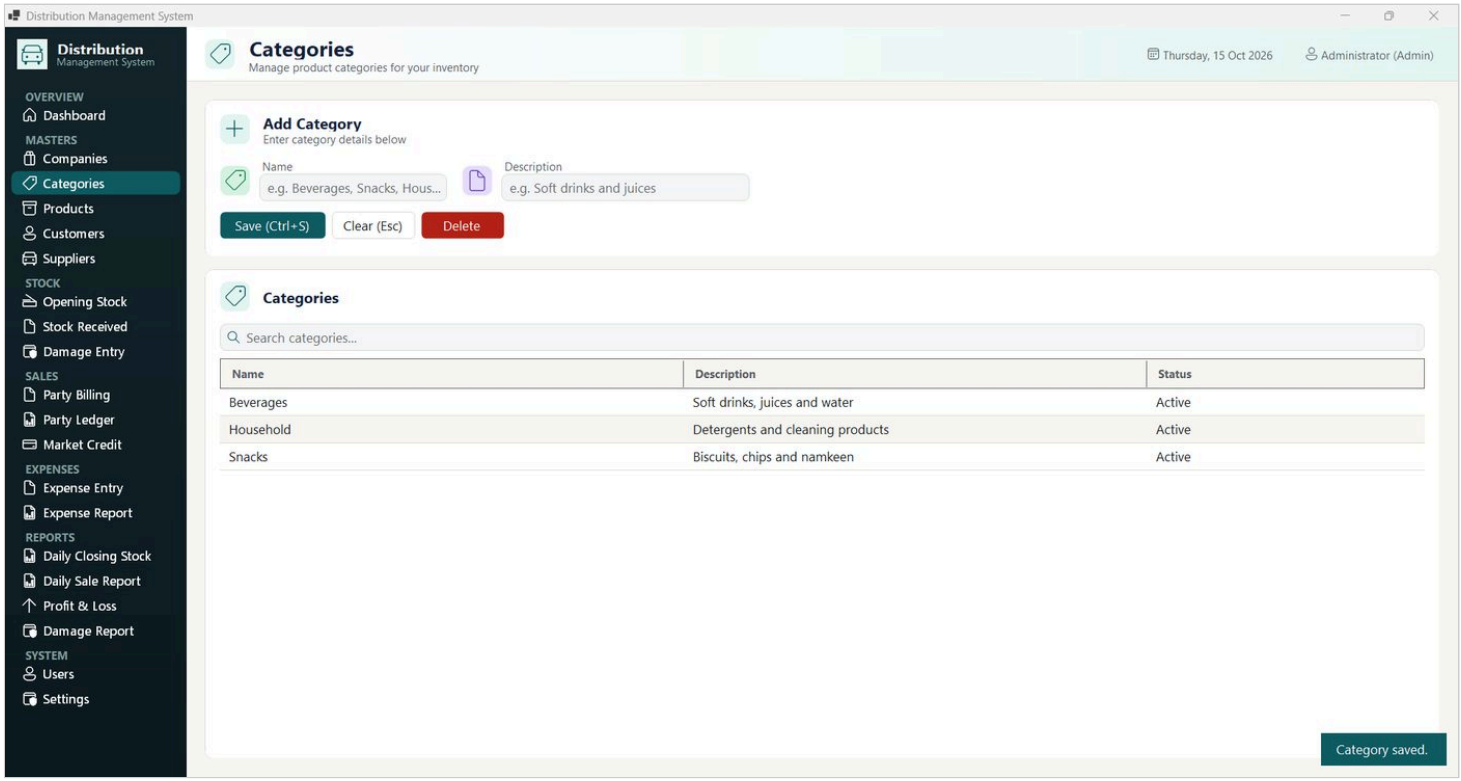


Figure 19: Categories screen with three categories, just after saving

Controls

Control	Purpose and effect
Name	The category name.
Description	Optional notes about what belongs in the category.
Save (Ctrl+S) / **Update (Ctrl+S)**	Saves a new category or your changes to the loaded one.
Clear (Esc)	Empties the form and leaves edit mode.
Delete	Deletes the category loaded in the form (edit mode only).
Search box (**Search categories...**)	Filters by category **name**.
Categories list	Columns **Name**, **Description**, **Status** (always *Active*). Click a row to edit it.

Form: Add Category

Field Name	Purpose	Required/Optional	How to Enter the Value	Validation/Restrictions
Name	Category name	**Required**	Type text, for example `Beverages`	Up to 200 characters. Duplicate names are **not** prevented, so check the list first.
Description	Explanation	Optional	Type text, for example `Soft drinks, juices and water`	Up to 500 characters.

Screen states

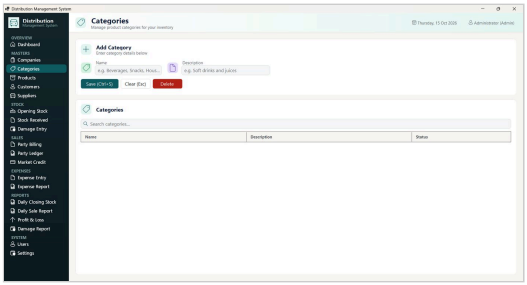
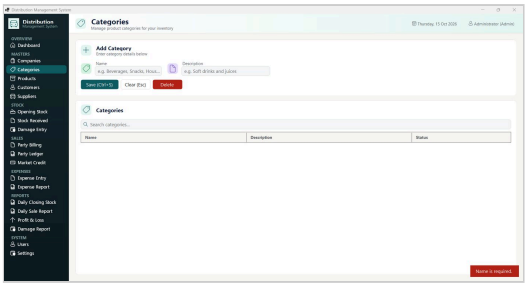
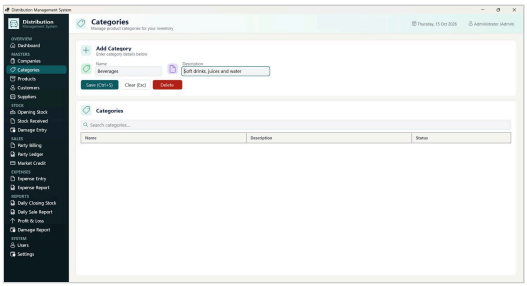
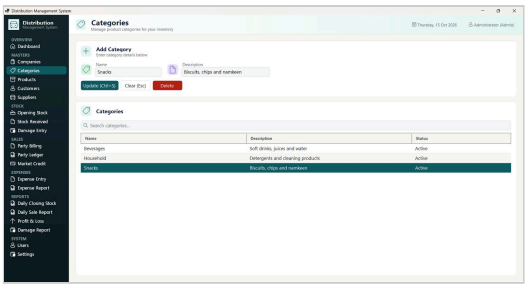
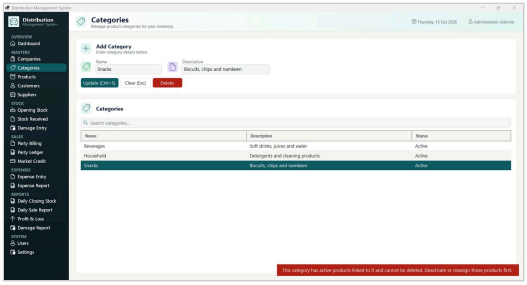
Figure	State
 **Figure 16**	No categories yet.
 **Figure 17**	**"Name is required."** when Save is clicked with an empty Name.
 **Figure 18**	Form filled before saving.
 **Figure 20**	Row clicked: the form is in edit mode with **Update (Ctrl+S)**.

Figure	State
 **Figure 32**	Deleting a category that has products: **"This category has active products linked to it and cannot be deleted. Deactivate or reassign those products first."**

Messages

"Category saved.", "Category updated.", "Delete this category?" (**Yes**/**No**), "Category deleted."

Effects of actions

- A new category appears in the **Category** drop-down on Products and in the category filters on Products and Daily Closing Stock the next time you open those screens.
- A category can only be deleted when no product uses it. To delete one that is in use, first move each product to another category (edit the product and change its **Category**) or delete those products.

---

6. Products

Overview

Screen title	Products — *Add, update and manage your products*
Purpose	Keeps the list of items you buy and sell, with prices, discount limits and current stock.
Before you start	At least one company and one category must exist.

How to open it

Click **Products** under **MASTERS**.

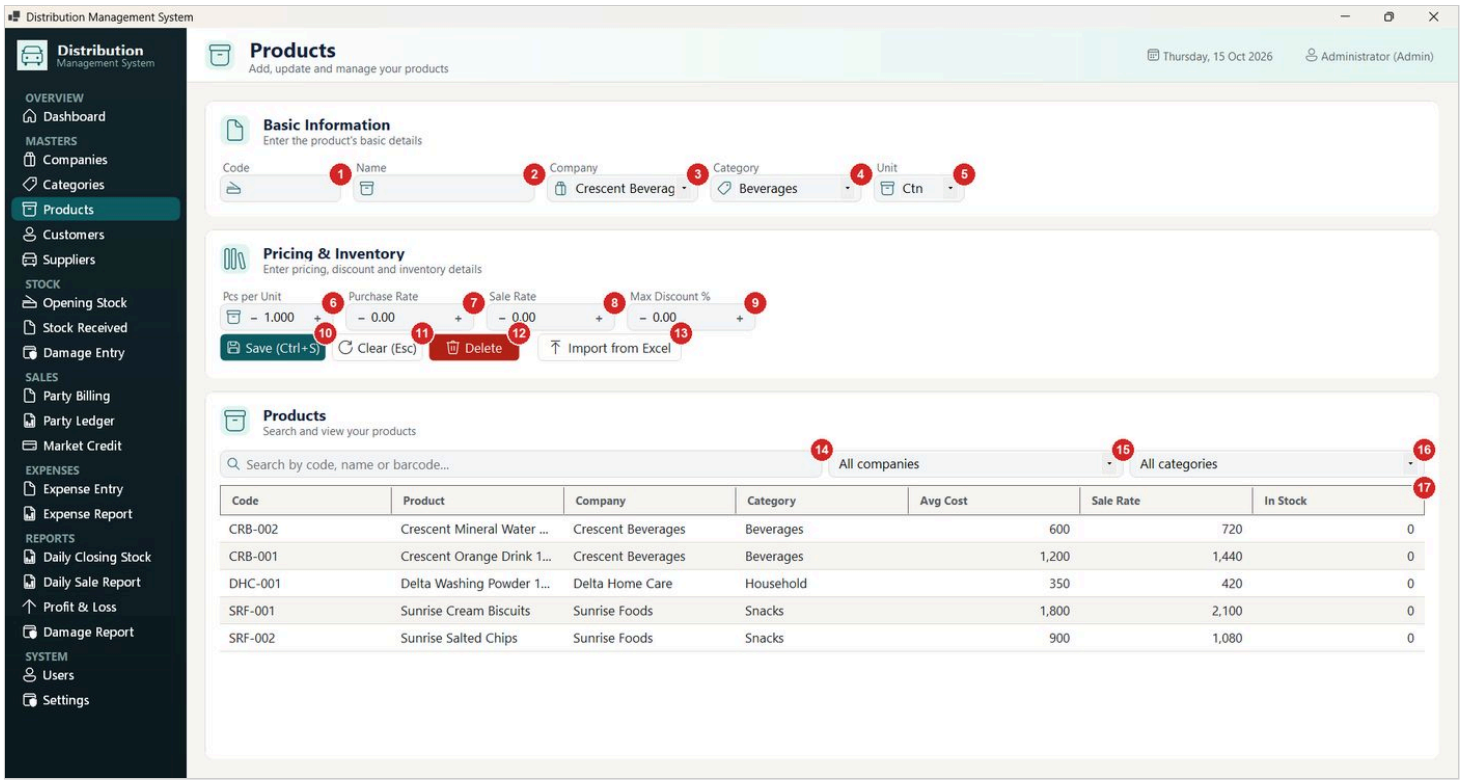


Figure 25a: Products screen (numbered). Unmarked original: Figure 25.

No.	Control	Purpose and effect
1	**Code**	Unique product code, for example `SRF-001`.
2	**Name**	Product name as you want it to appear on bills and reports.
3	**Company**	Drop-down list of companies. Choose the manufacturer or brand.
4	**Category**	Drop-down list of categories.
5	**Unit**	How the product is counted: **Ctn** (carton), **Box**, **Pcs** (pieces) or **Bag**.
6	**Pcs per Unit**	How many pieces are in one unit, for example 24 biscuit packets in one carton. Kept for information only.
7	**Purchase Rate**	The usual price you pay per unit.
8	**Sale Rate**	The usual price you sell at per unit. This is filled in automatically on Party Billing.
9	**Max Discount %**	The highest line discount an Operator or Viewer may give on this product.
10	**Save (Ctrl+S)** / **Update (Ctrl+S)**	Saves a new product or your changes.
11	**Clear (Esc)**	Empties the form (Pcs per Unit goes back to 1) and leaves edit mode.
12	**Delete**	Deletes the product loaded in the form.
13	**Import from Excel**	Adds or updates many products from an Excel file. See Import from Excel.
14	Search box	Filters by code, name or barcode.
15	**All companies** filter	Shows only products of the chosen company.
16	**All categories** filter	Shows only products of the chosen category.
17	**Products** list	Click a row to edit the product.

Form: Basic Information and Pricing & Inventory

Field Name	Purpose	Required/Optional	How to Enter the Value	Validation/Restrictions
Code	Unique product code	**Required**	Type, for example `SRF-001`	Up to 30 characters. Must not repeat any existing or deleted product code; a repeat shows a technical error like Figure 13.
Name	Product name	**Required**	Type, for example `Sunrise Cream Biscuits`	Up to 200 characters.
Company	Manufacturer or brand	**Required**	Choose from the list	Lists companies that existed when the screen was first opened in this session. The first company is selected automatically.
Category	Product group	**Required**	Choose from the list	Same as Company.
Unit	Counting unit	**Required**	Choose **Ctn**, **Box**, **Pcs** or **Bag**	Default **Ctn**.
Pcs per Unit	Pieces in one unit	Optional	Type a number or use `−/+`	0 to 99,999, up to 3 decimals. Shows 0.00 the first time the screen opens and 1.000 after **Clear**.
Purchase Rate	Normal buying price (Rs)	Optional	Number	0 to 9,999,999, 2 decimals. Used as the starting **Avg Cost** when a new product is saved.
Sale Rate	Normal selling price (Rs)	Optional	Number	0 to 9,999,999, 2 decimals. A bill line needs a rate above 0, so set a real sale rate.
Max Discount %	Discount limit for non-Admin users	Optional	Number	0 to 100. With 0, Operators and Viewers cannot give any line discount on this product.

> **Barcode:** the Products search can find products by barcode, but barcodes can only be added through **Import from Excel**. The form has no barcode field, and saving the form does not change an existing barcode.

List columns

Column	Meaning
Code, Product, Company, Category	As entered.
Avg Cost	The weighted average cost of the stock you hold. It starts at the Purchase Rate and is recalculated automatically each time you record Opening Stock or Stock Received. Changing **Purchase Rate** later does **not** change Avg Cost.
Sale Rate	Current sale rate.
In Stock	Current quantity = all stock in (opening stock and purchases) minus all stock out (sales and damage). Shown as a whole number. **May be out of date** until you refresh (Figures 54 and 55).

Screen states

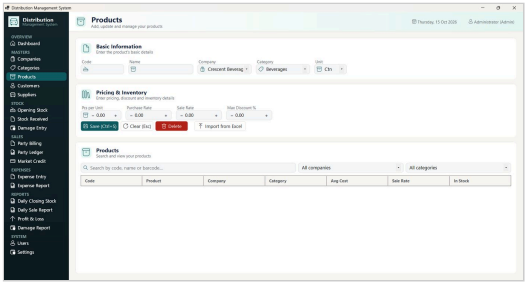
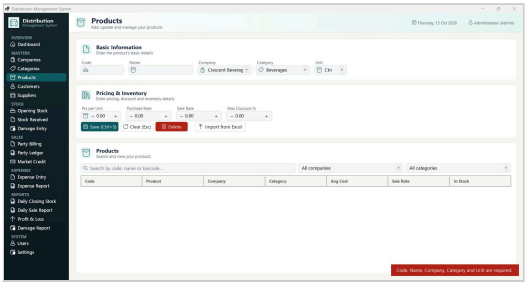
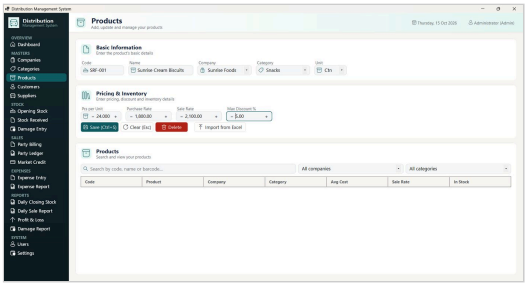
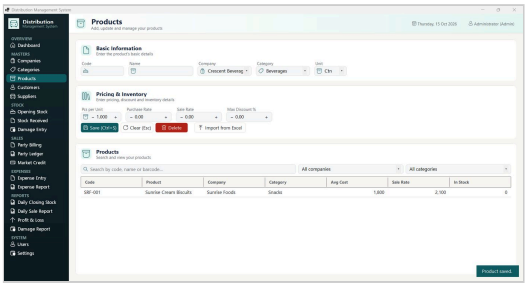
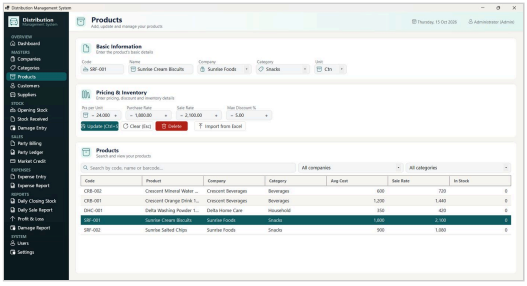
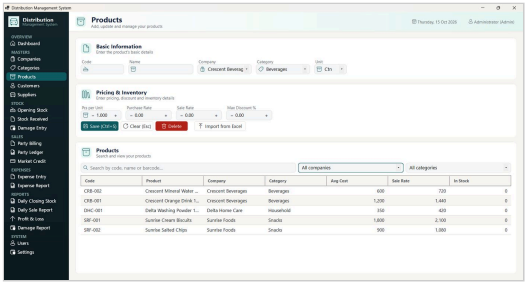
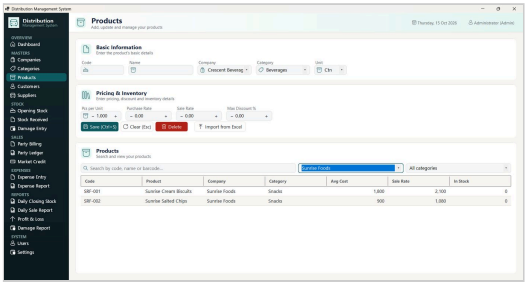
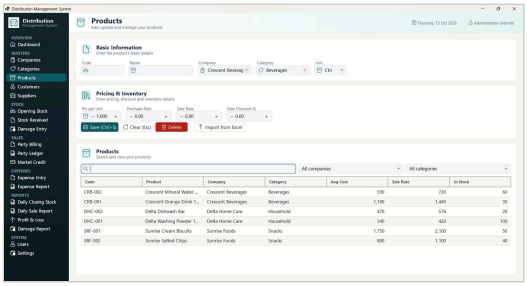
Figure	State
 **Figure 21**	No products yet.
 **Figure 22**	**"Code, Name, Company, Category and Unit are required."**
 **Figure 23**	Form filled with example data.
 **Figure 24**	**"Product saved."** and the product appears in the list.
 **Figure 26**	A product loaded for editing.

Figure	State
 **Figure 27**	The company filter opened.
 **Figure 28**	Only *Sunrise Foods* products shown. To remove the filter, choose **All companies** again.
 **Figure 55**	**In Stock** and **Avg Cost** after stock was recorded. The screen reloads these figures each time you open it.

Messages

"Product saved.", "Product updated.", "Delete this product?" (**Yes**/**No**), "Product deleted."

Effects of actions

Action	Effect
Save product	Appears in the Products list and in the product drop-downs on Opening Stock, Stock Received, Damage Entry and Party Billing the next time you open those screens. Appears in Daily Closing Stock.
Change Sale Rate	Party Billing fills in the new rate the next time you open it. Bills already saved keep their original rates.
Change Max Discount %	Takes effect on the next bill saved.
Delete product	Removed from the Products list, from the product drop-downs and from Daily Closing Stock. **The application allows this even if the product still has stock.** Past bills, purchases and damage entries keep their records. A deleted product cannot be restored from the application.

> **Caution:** Deleting a product that still has stock makes that stock disappear from the stock reports. Check **In**

> **Stock** first.

Import from Excel

Use this to create many products at once, or to update prices of existing products.

Prepare the Excel file (.xlsx):

- The application reads the **first worksheet** only.
- **Row 1** must contain column headings. Upper or lower case does not matter, but the spelling must be exact.
- Each following row is one product. Empty rows are skipped.

Heading	Required	What to put	Rule
Code	Yes	Product code	If a product with this code already exists, it is **updated**. Otherwise a new product is created.
Name	Yes	Product name	Must not be blank.
Company	Yes	Company **name** (not code)	Must exactly match an existing company name (upper/lower case ignored).
Category	Yes	Category name	Must match an existing category.
Unit	Yes	Ctn, Box, Pcs or Bag	Any other value is rejected.
PcsPerUnit	Yes	Number	Must be numeric.
PurchaseRate	Yes	Number	Must be numeric.
SaleRate	Yes	Number	Must be numeric.
MaxDiscountPct	No	Number	If the column is missing or the cell is not a number, 0 is used.
Barcode	No	Text	If the column is missing or the cell is blank, the product's barcode is **removed**.

Run the import:

1. Close the Excel file (an open file may not be readable).
2. On the Products screen, click **Import from Excel**.
3. In the **Import Products** window (Figure 29), find and select your file, then click **Open**.
4. Read the result: - If every row was accepted, a green message such as **"Imported: 3, Updated: 1, Errors: 0"** appears. - If some rows were rejected, a window titled **"Imported: X, Updated: Y, Errors: Z"** lists up to 20 problems with their row numbers (Figure 30). Click **OK**. Rows without errors **were still saved**.
5. The Products list reloads automatically (Figure 31).

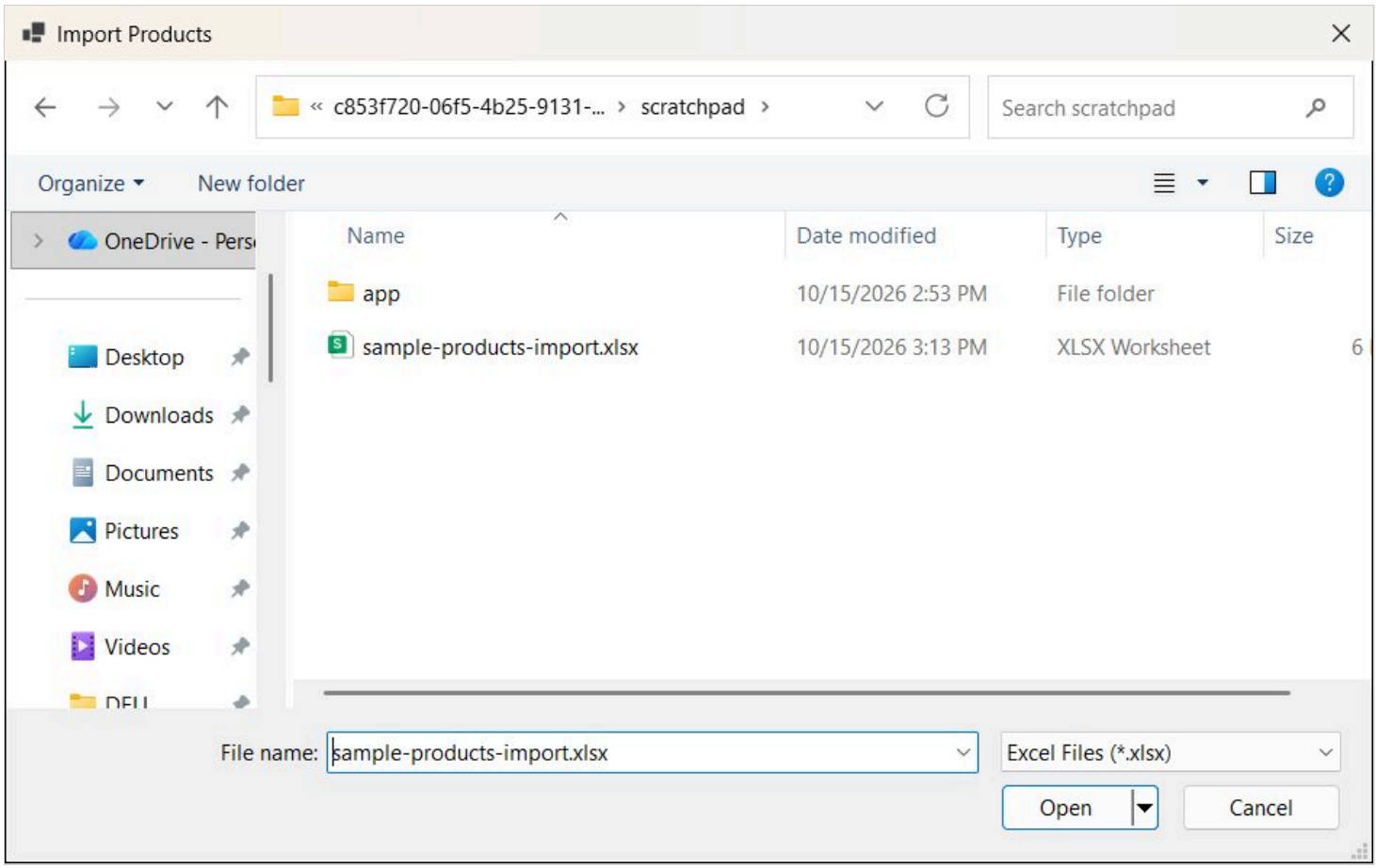


Figure 29: Choosing the Excel file

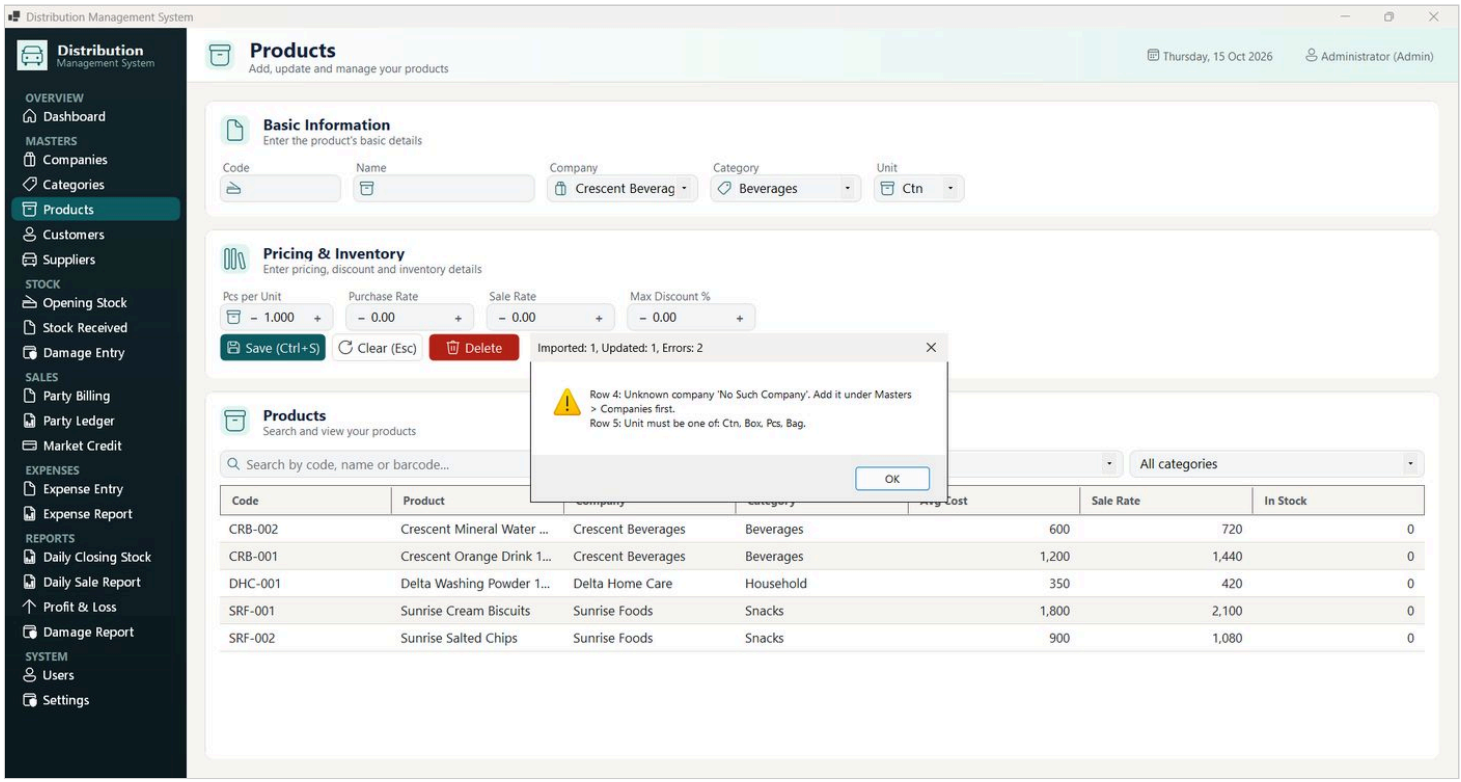


Figure 30: Import result. One product was imported, one was updated and two rows had errors: "Row 4: Unknown company 'No Such Company'. Add it under Masters > Companies first." and "Row 5: Unit must be one of: Ctn, Box, Pcs, Bag."

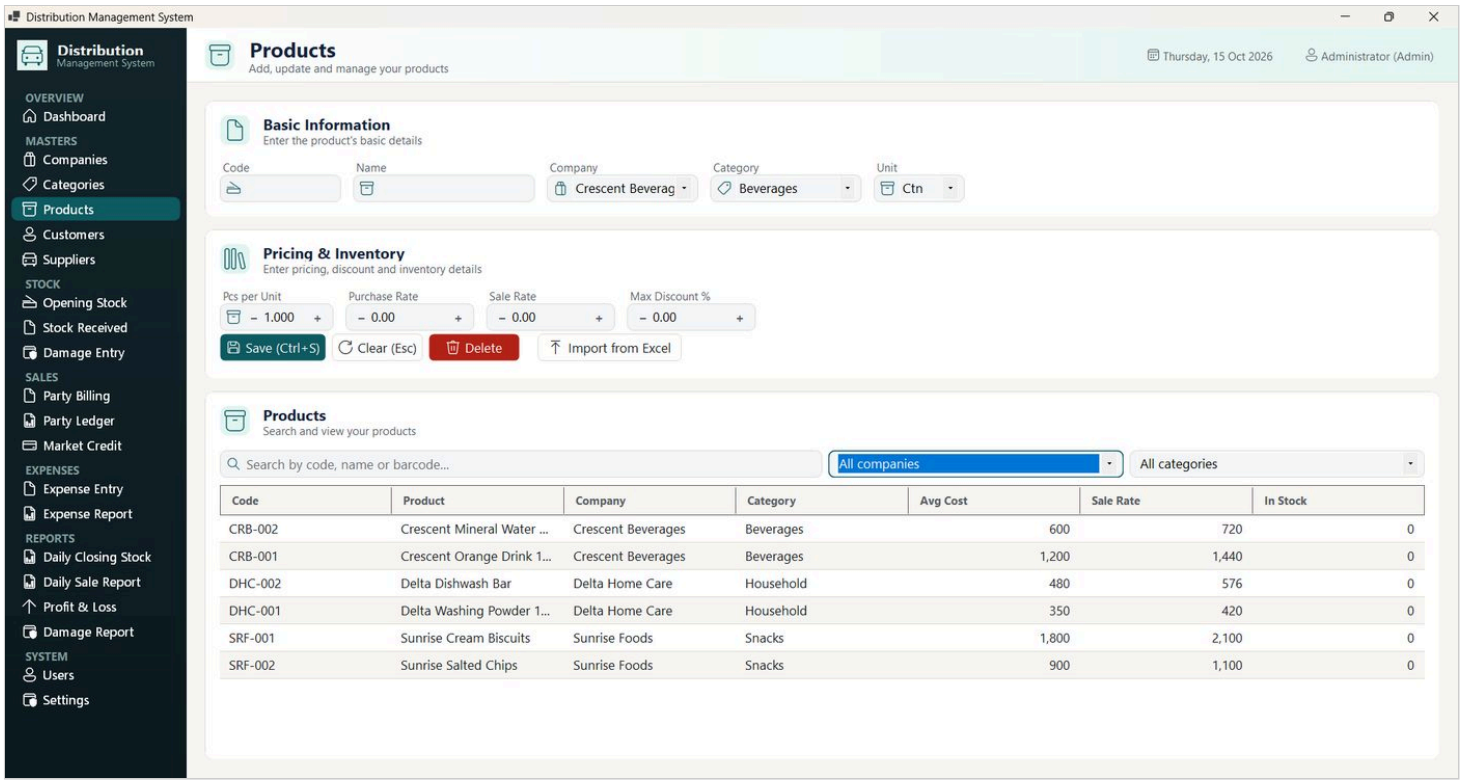


Figure 31: Products list after the import. DHC-002 was added and SRF-002's sale rate was updated.

Import messages:

Message	Meaning
Row 1: Missing required column(s): …	A required heading is missing or misspelled in row 1. Nothing was imported.
Row N: Code and Name are required.	Code or Name is blank in that row.
Row N: Unknown company '…'. Add it under Masters > Companies first.	Company name not found.
Row N: Unknown category '…'. Add it under Masters > Categories first.	Category name not found.
Row N: Unit must be one of: Ctn, Box, Pcs, Bag.	Invalid unit.
Row N: PcsPerUnit, PurchaseRate and SaleRate must be numeric.	One of these cells is not a number.
Import failed: …	The whole file could not be read, for example because it is open in Excel, is not a real .xlsx file, or is damaged.

> **Caution:** Updating an existing product through import overwrites **all** of its listed values, including Max Discount % (set to 0 if the column is missing) and Barcode (removed if the column is missing or blank).

---

7. Customers

Overview

Screen title	Customers — *Manage your customer accounts*
Purpose	Keeps the shops and parties you sell to, their area or route, and their starting balance.
Before you start	At least one Area / Route is needed. You can add one directly from this screen.

How to open it

Click **Customers** under **MASTERS**.

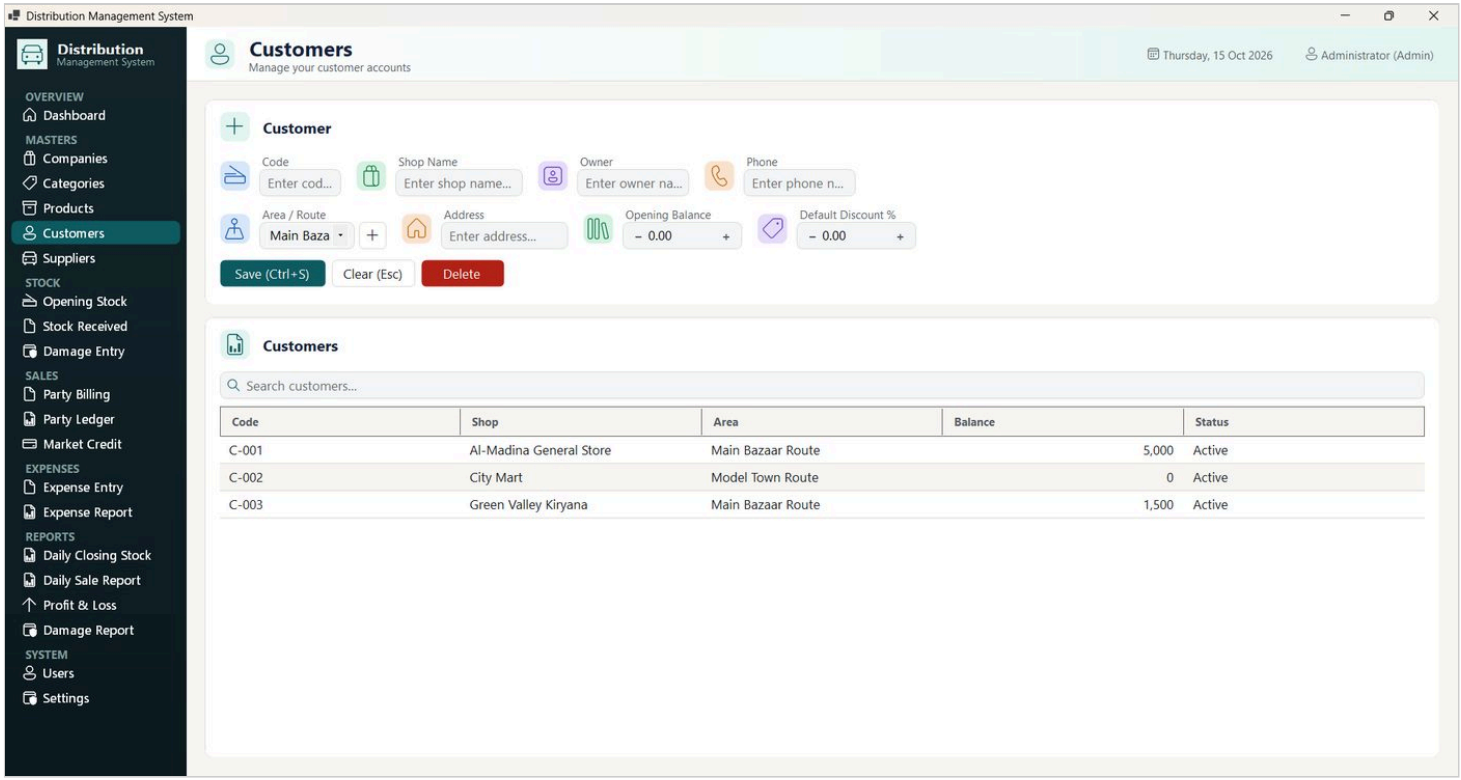


Figure 40: Customers screen with three customers

Controls

Control	Purpose and effect
Code	Unique customer code, for example `C-001`.
Shop Name	The shop or party name. Appears on bills and reports.
Owner	Owner's name (optional).
Phone	Phone number (optional).
Area / Route	Drop-down of delivery areas or routes.
+ button (next to Area / Route)	Opens the **New Area** window to add an area or route (Figure 35).
Address	Shop address (optional).
Opening Balance	The amount the customer already owed you when you started using the application.

Control	Purpose and effect
Default Discount %	A discount percentage stored with the customer for your reference. **It is not applied automatically on bills**; enter discounts on each bill line.
Save (Ctrl+S) / **Update (Ctrl+S)**, **Clear (Esc)**, **Delete**	Same as on Companies.
Search box (**Search customers...**)	Filters by shop name or code.
Customers list	Columns **Code**, **Shop**, **Area**, **Balance**, **Status**.

Form: Customer

Field Name	Purpose	Required/Optional	How to Enter the Value	Validation/Restrictions
Code	Unique code	**Required**	Type, for example `C-001`	Up to 30 characters. Must be unique, including deleted customers.
Shop Name	Customer name	**Required**	Type	Up to 200 characters.
Owner	Owner's name	Optional	Type	Up to 200 characters.
Phone	Phone	Optional	Type	Up to 50 characters. No format check.
Area / Route	Delivery area	**Required**	Choose from the list, or click **+** to add a new one	The list is empty until at least one area is added.
Address	Address	Optional	Type	Up to 500 characters.
Opening Balance	Amount owed at start (Rs)	Optional	Number	0 to 999,999,999. Cannot be negative, so an advance paid by a customer cannot be entered here.
Default Discount %	Reference discount	Optional	Number	0 to 100. Stored only.

Adding an Area / Route

1. Click the **+** button next to **Area / Route**.
2. The **New Area** window opens with the label **"Area / route name:"** (Figure 35).
3. Type the name, for example `Main Bazaar Route`.
4. Click **OK** or press **Enter**. Click **Cancel** (or press **Esc**) to close without adding.
5. The green message **"Area added."** appears (Figure 36), and the new area is available in the drop-down.

> Areas cannot be renamed or deleted in this version, and the same name can be added twice. Check the drop-down before adding.

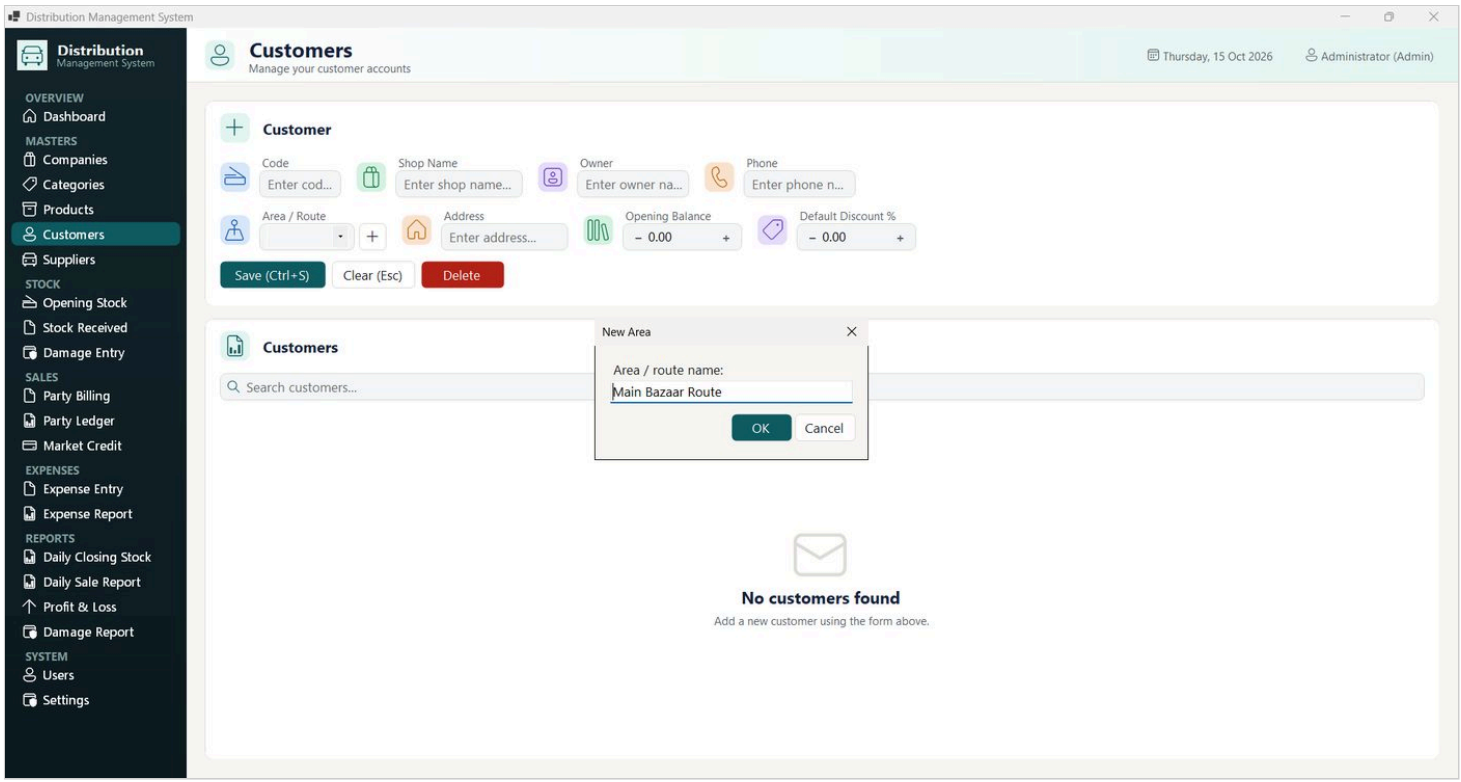


Figure 35: New Area window

List columns

Column	Meaning
Code, Shop, Area	As entered.
Balance	What the customer owes now = Opening Balance + all bills − all cash received on bills.
Status	Always **Active** in this version.

Screen states

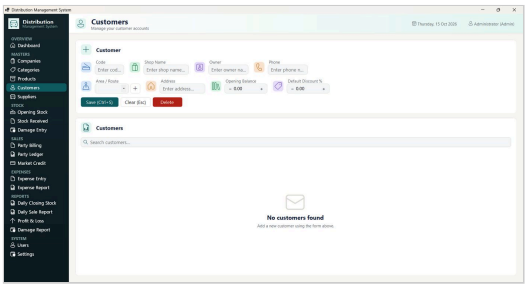
Figure	State
 **Figure 34**	No customers yet: **"No customers found — Add a new customer using the form above."**

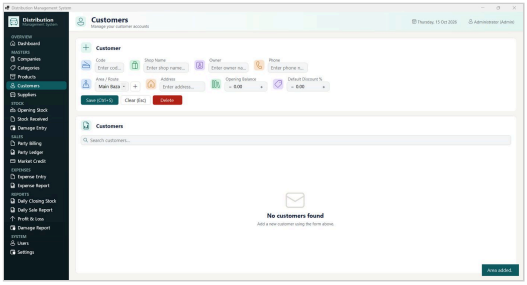
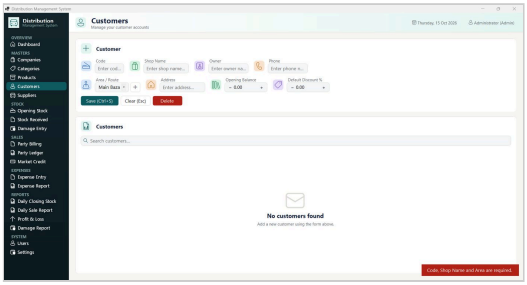
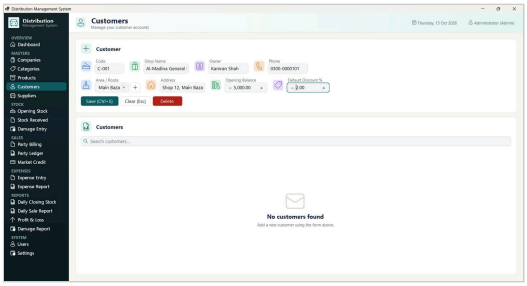
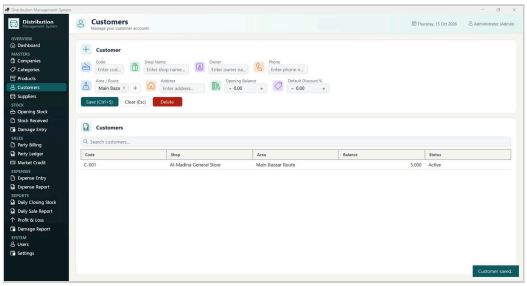
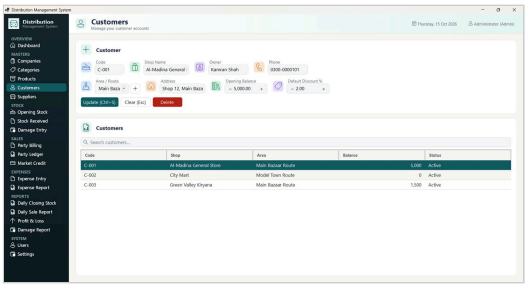
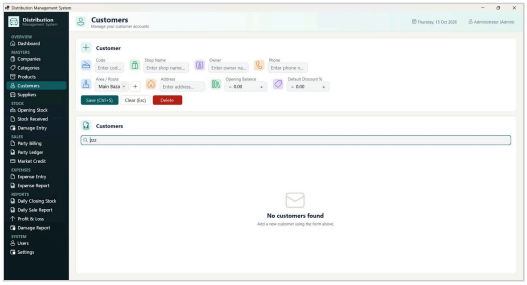
Figure	State
 **Figure 36**	**"Area added."**
 **Figure 37**	**"Code, Shop Name and Area are required."**
 **Figure 38**	Form filled with example data.
 **Figure 39**	**"Customer saved."**
 **Figure 41**	A customer loaded for editing.

Figure	State
 **Figure 42**	A search that matches nothing shows the "No customers found" message. Clear the search box to see all customers again.

Messages

"Customer saved.", "Customer updated.", "Delete this customer?" (**Yes**/**No**), "Customer deleted.", "Area added."

Effects of actions

Action	Effect
Save customer	Available in the **Customer** drop-downs on Party Billing, Receive Payment and Party Ledger the next time you open those screens. Appears on Market Credit when the balance is above zero.
Change Opening Balance	Changes the customer's **Balance**, Party Billing's **Previous Balance**, the Party Ledger opening row and Market Credit.
Delete customer	Removed from all customer lists and from Market Credit, **even if the customer still owes money**. There is no check for an outstanding balance. Past bills remain in the reports.

> **Caution:** Check the **Balance** column before deleting a customer. Once deleted, the customer cannot be restored and their dues no longer appear on Market Credit.

---

8. Suppliers

Overview

Screen title	Suppliers — *Manage your supplier records easily*
Purpose	Keeps the parties you buy stock from.
Before you start	At least one company must exist.

How to open it

Click **Suppliers** under **MASTERS**.

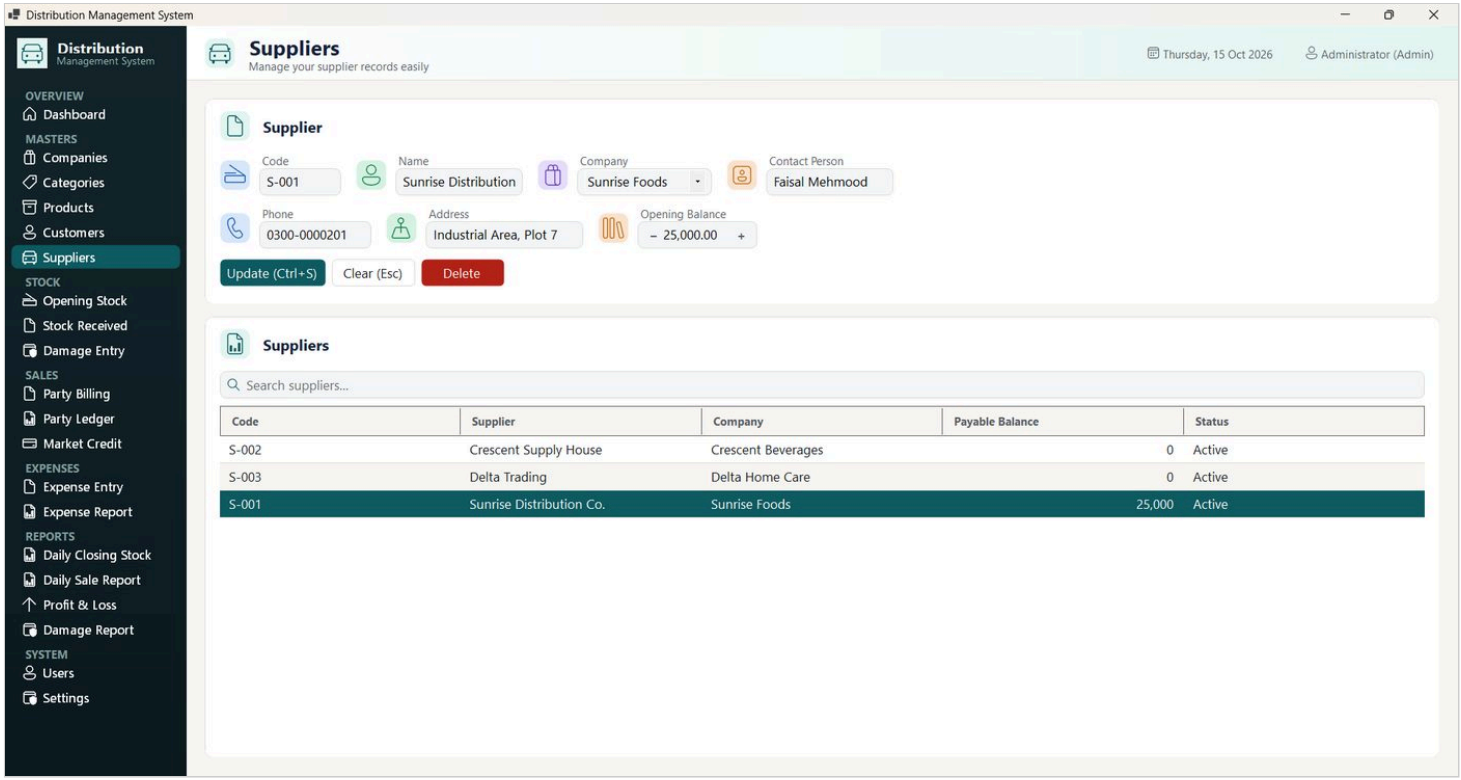


Figure 48: Suppliers screen with a supplier loaded for editing

Form: Supplier

Field Name	Purpose	Required/Optional	How to Enter the Value	Validation/Restrictions
Code	Unique code	**Required**	Type, for example `S-001`	Up to 30 characters. Unique, including deleted suppliers.
Name	Supplier name	**Required**	Type	Up to 200 characters.
Company	Which company's goods this supplier provides	**Required**	Choose from the list	Lists companies that existed when the screen was first opened.
Contact Person	Contact	Optional	Type	Up to 200 characters.
Phone	Phone	Optional	Type	Up to 50 characters.
Address	Address	Optional	Type	Up to 500 characters.
Opening Balance	Amount you owed this supplier when you started	Optional	Number	0 to 999,999,999.

Buttons, search and row selection work exactly as on Companies. The search box (**Search suppliers...**) searches by name or code.

List columns

Column	Meaning
Code, Supplier, Company	As entered.

Column	Meaning
Payable Balance	**Shows only the Opening Balance.** Purchases recorded on Stock Received do **not** change this figure, and there is no supplier payment screen in this version. Keep supplier accounts separately.
Status	Always **Active**.

Screen states

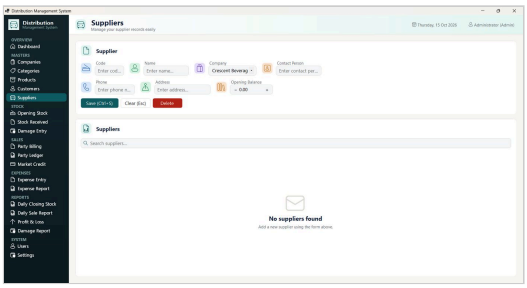
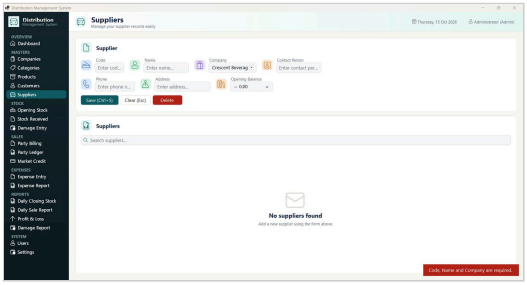
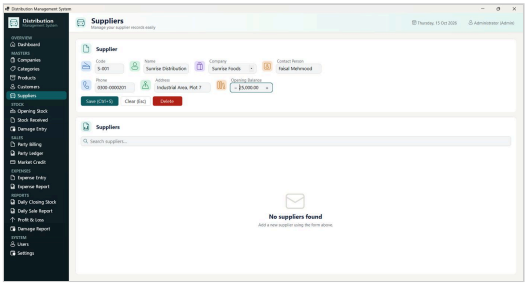
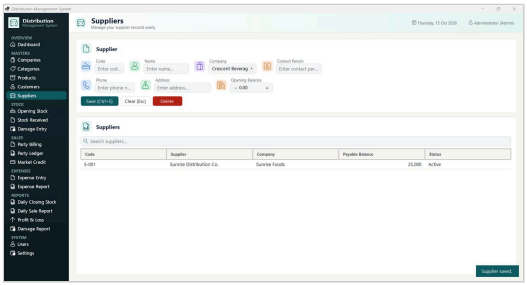
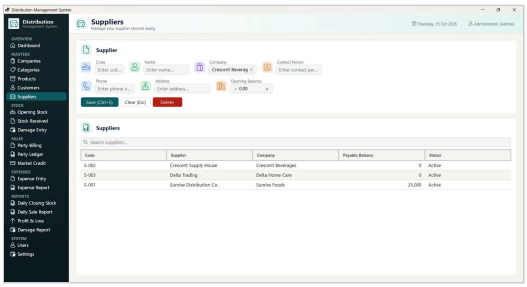
Figure	State
 **Figure 43**	No suppliers: **"No suppliers found — Add a new supplier using the form above."**
 **Figure 44**	**"Code, Name and Company are required."**
 **Figure 45**	Form filled.
 **Figure 46**	**"Supplier saved."**

Figure	State
 **Figure 47**	Three suppliers.

Messages

"Supplier saved.", "Supplier updated.", "Delete this supplier?" (**Yes**/**No**), "Supplier deleted."

Effects

- New suppliers appear in the **Supplier** drop-down the next time you open Stock Received.
- A company cannot be deleted while it has suppliers.
- A deleted supplier disappears from lists. Past purchases keep the supplier's name.

---

9. Opening Stock

Overview

Screen title	Opening Stock — *One-time setup of starting stock*
Purpose	Records the quantity and cost of each product you already hold when you start using the application.
Who uses it	Usually the administrator, once, during setup.

How to open it

Click **Opening Stock** under **STOCK**.

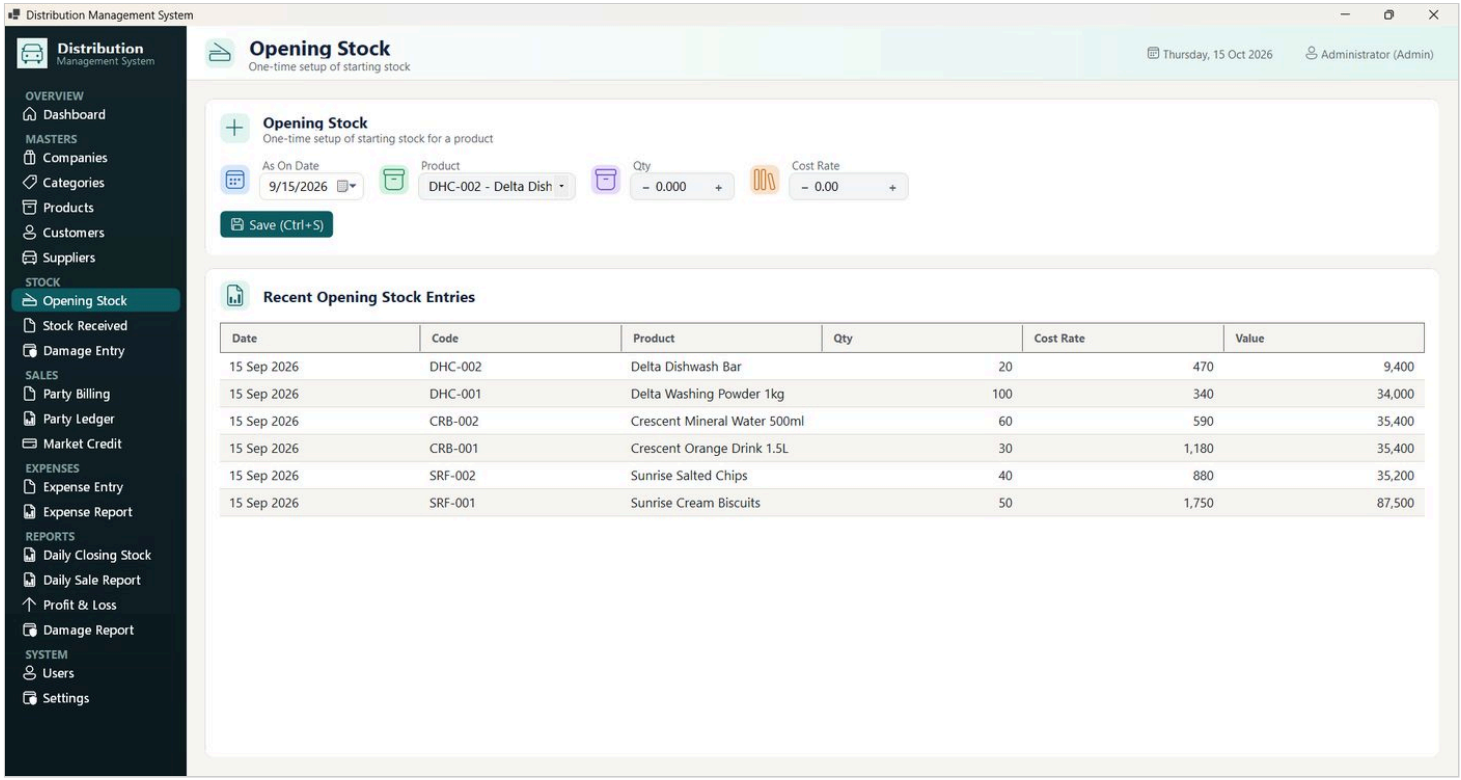


Figure 53: Opening Stock with six entries recorded

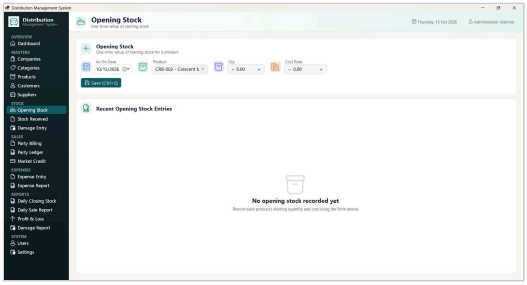
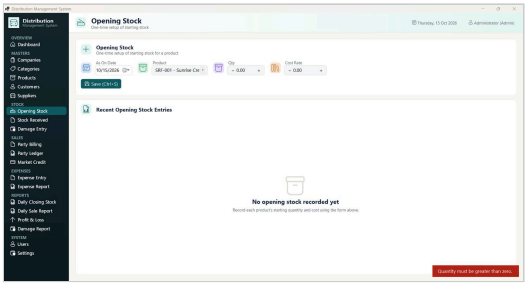
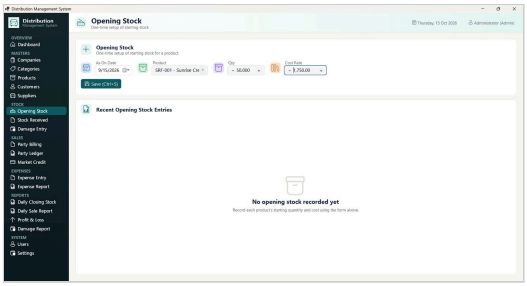
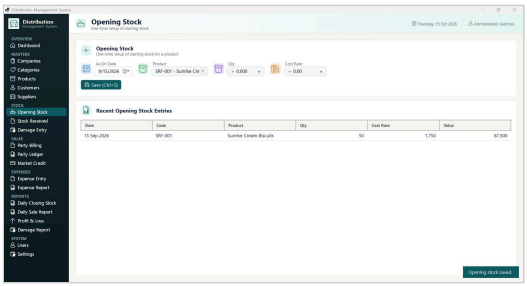
Form: Opening Stock

Field Name	Purpose	Required/Optional	How to Enter the Value	Validation/Restrictions
As On Date	The date the stock was counted	Required (pre-filled with today)	Click the date and use the calendar, or type the date	Stock dated before a report date counts as **Opening** on Daily Closing Stock. Stock dated on the report date counts as **Received**.
Product	The product counted	**Required**	Choose from the list (shown as `CODE - Name`)	The first product is selected automatically.
Qty	Quantity held	**Required**	Number	Must be greater than 0. Up to 3 decimals.
Cost Rate	Cost per unit (Rs)	Optional	Number	2 decimals. If you leave it at 0, the product's average cost is pulled down (see below).

Buttons and list

Control	Effect
Save (Ctrl+S)	Records the stock. Shows **"Opening stock saved."**, then clears **Qty** and **Cost Rate**. **As On Date** and **Product** stay as they were, so you can quickly enter the next product.
Recent Opening Stock Entries	The last 50 opening stock entries, newest first: **Date**, **Code**, **Product**, **Qty**, **Cost Rate**, **Value** (Qty × Cost Rate).

Screen states

Figure	State
 **Figure 49**	Nothing recorded: **"No opening stock recorded yet"**.
 **Figure 50**	**"Quantity must be greater than zero."**
 **Figure 51**	Form filled (As On Date set to an earlier date).
 **Figure 52**	**"Opening stock saved."**

Other message: **"Select a product."** (no product chosen, for example when no products exist).

Effects

Effect	Where to verify
The product's stock increases by Qty.	Products → **In Stock**; Daily Closing Stock.
The product's **Avg Cost** is recalculated. If the product had no stock, Avg Cost becomes the Cost Rate. Otherwise it becomes the weighted average of old and new stock.	Products → **Avg Cost**.

> **Warning — this screen does not stop repeats.** Despite the words "one-time", the application accepts several entries for the same product, and each one **adds** more stock. Entries cannot be edited or deleted from the application. Check the **Recent Opening Stock Entries** list before saving.

10. Stock Received

Overview

Screen title	Stock Received — *Receive stock from your suppliers*
Purpose	Records a delivery (purchase invoice) from a supplier and adds the goods to stock.
Before you start	Suppliers and products must exist.

How to open it

Click **Stock Received** under **STOCK**.

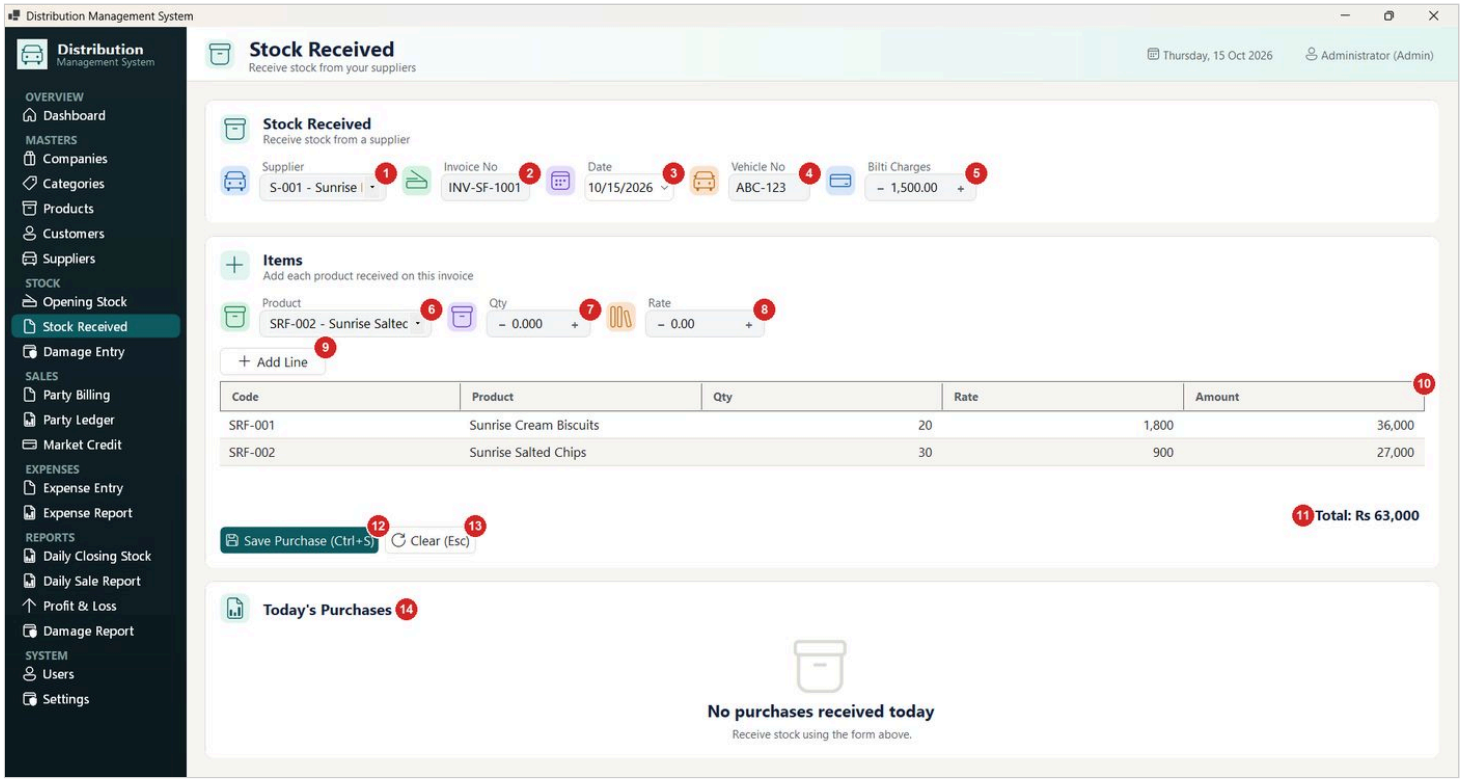


Figure 60a: Stock Received with two item lines ready to save (numbered). Unmarked original: Figure 60.

No.	Control	Purpose and effect
1	**Supplier**	Choose the supplier (shown as `CODE - Name`).
2	**Invoice No**	The supplier's invoice or bill number.
3	**Date**	Date of receipt (pre-filled with today).
4	**Vehicle No**	Vehicle that delivered the goods (optional).
5	**Bilti Charges**	Freight or transport charges paid for this delivery (optional).
6	**Product**	Product for the line you are adding.
7	**Qty**	Quantity received.
8	**Rate**	Purchase price per unit on this invoice.

No.	Control	Purpose and effect
9	**Add Line**	Adds the product, Qty and Rate to the item list below, then clears Qty and Rate.
10	Item list	Lines added so far: **Code**, **Product**, **Qty**, **Rate**, **Amount** (Qty × Rate).
11	**Total: Rs ...**	Sum of all line amounts. Bilti is not included.
12	**Save Purchase (Ctrl+S)**	Saves the whole delivery and updates stock.
13	**Clear (Esc)**	Clears Invoice No, Vehicle No, Bilti Charges and **all item lines**. Supplier and Date stay.
14	**Today's Purchases**	Purchases dated today: **Invoice No**, **Date**, **Supplier**, **Total Amount**, **Bilti**.

Form fields

Field Name	Purpose	Required/Optional	How to Enter the Value	Validation/Restrictions
Supplier	Who delivered	**Required**	Choose from the list	Lists suppliers that existed when the screen was first opened.
Invoice No	Supplier's invoice number	**Required**	Type, for example `INV-SF-1001`	Up to 50 characters. **Repeated invoice numbers are not blocked**, so check Today's Purchases to avoid saving the same delivery twice.
Date	Receipt date	Required (pre-filled)	Calendar or type	—
Vehicle No	Vehicle	Optional	Type	Up to 50 characters.
Bilti Charges	Freight paid (Rs)	Optional	Number	0 or more. If above 0, an expense is created automatically (see Effects).
Product (line)	Item	**Required for each line**	Choose	—
Qty (line)	Quantity	**Required**	Number	Must be greater than 0. Up to 3 decimals.
Rate (line)	Price per unit	**Required**	Number	Must be greater than 0.

Screen states

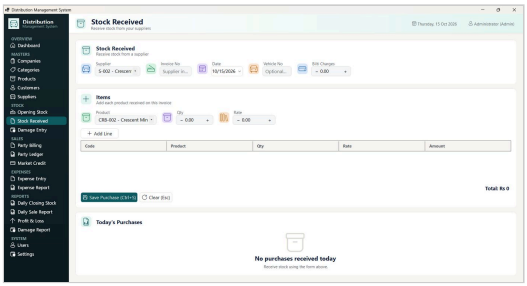
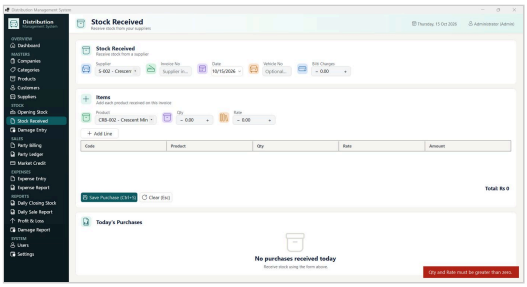
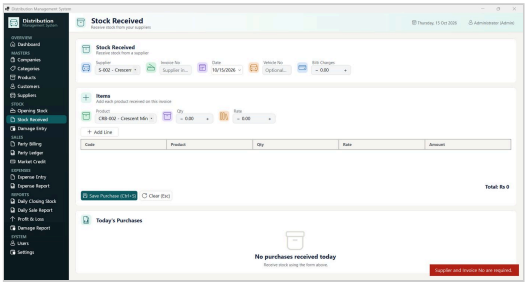
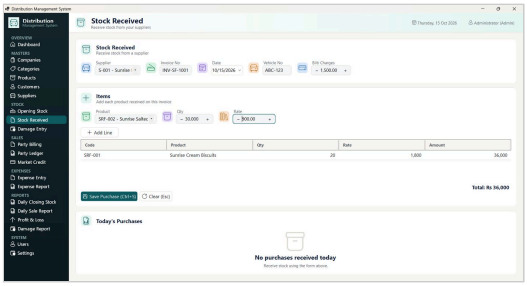
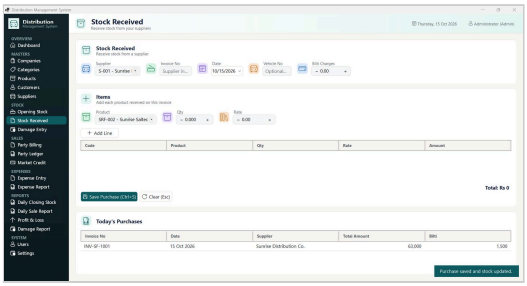
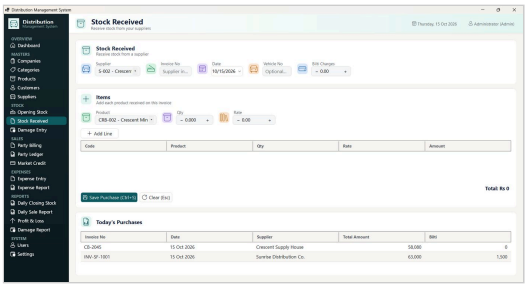
Figure	State
 **Figure 56**	Empty screen: **"No purchases received today"**.

Figure	State
 **Figure 57**	**Add Line** with Qty or Rate at 0: **"Qty and Rate must be greater than zero."**
 **Figure 58**	**Save Purchase** without an invoice number: **"Supplier and Invoice No are required."**
 **Figure 59**	Second line being entered.
 **Figure 61**	**"Purchase saved and stock updated."** The form clears and the purchase appears in **Today's Purchases**.
 **Figure 62**	Two purchases listed for today.

Other messages: **"Select a product."**, **"Add at least one item line."**

Effects of saving a purchase

Effect	Where to verify
Each product's stock increases by the line Qty.	Products → **In Stock**, Daily Closing Stock → **Received**.
Each product's **Avg Cost** is recalculated as a weighted average of old stock and new stock at the line Rate.	Products **Avg Cost**, Daily Closing Stock **Avg Cost**.
If **Bilti Charges** is above 0, a business expense is created automatically: voucher **BILTI-n**, category **Bilti / Freight**, paid from **Cash**, description "Bilti/freight for purchase *invoice no*".	Expense Entry → Today's Expenses (Figure 84); Expense Report; Profit & Loss → Business Expenses.
The supplier's **Payable Balance** is **not** changed.	—

> **No corrections after saving.** A saved purchase cannot be edited or deleted from the application. **Before saving**, there is no way to remove a single line: click **Clear (Esc)** and add the lines again (the invoice number and bilti are cleared too).

---

11. Damage Entry

Overview

Screen title	Damage Entry — *Record damaged or lost stock*
Purpose	Removes broken, expired or lost goods from stock and records the loss.

How to open it

Click **Damage Entry** under **STOCK**.

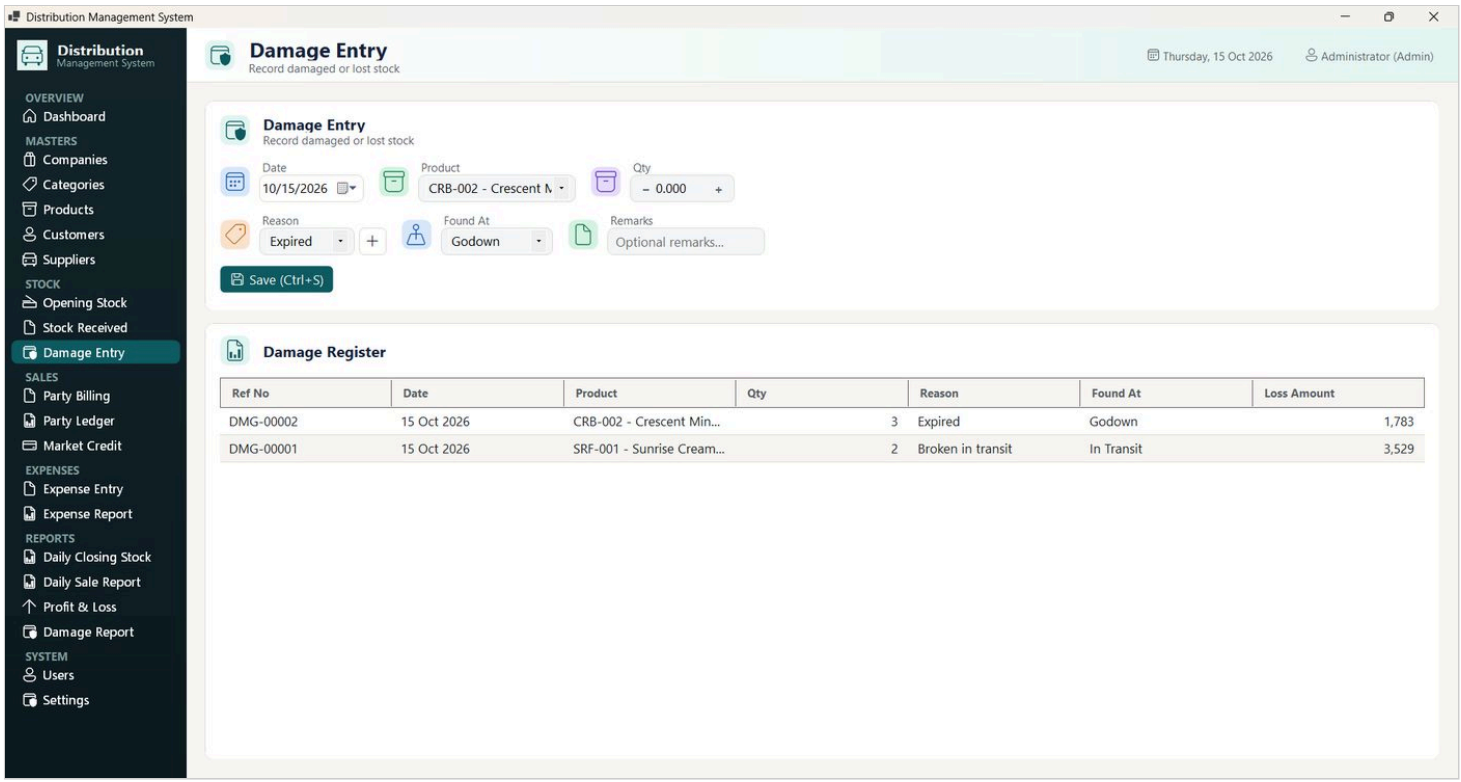


Figure 68: Damage Entry with two entries in the Damage Register

Form fields

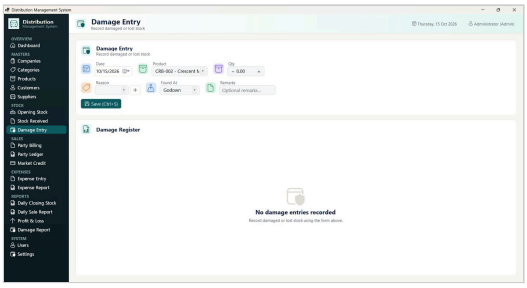
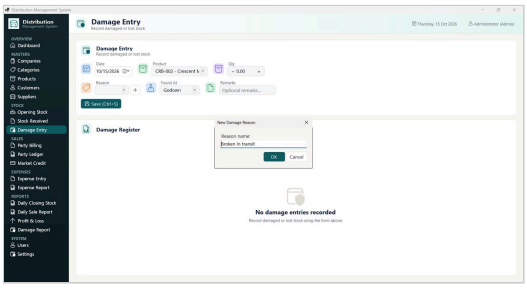
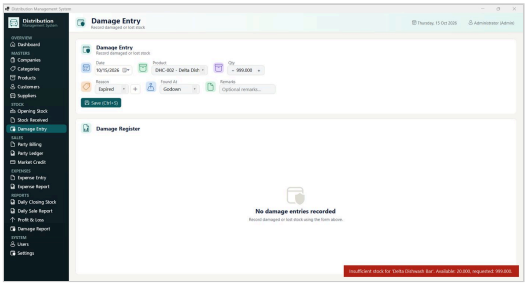
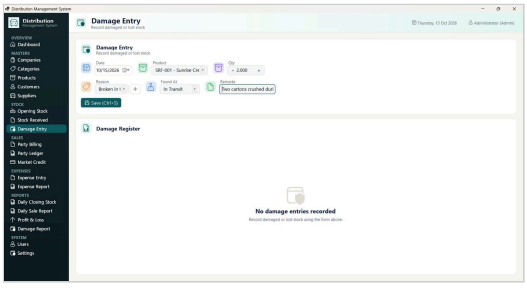
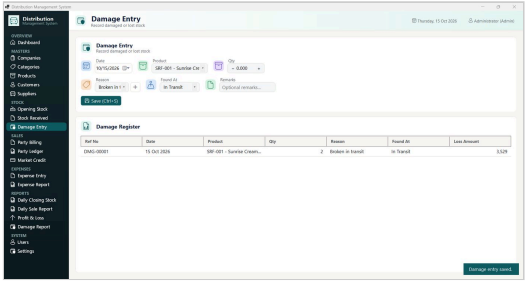
Field Name	Purpose	Required/Optional	How to Enter the Value	Validation/Restrictions
Date	When the damage was found	Required (pre-filled with today)	Calendar or type	—
Product	Damaged product	**Required**	Choose	—
Qty	Quantity damaged	**Required**	Number	Greater than 0 and **not more than the current stock** of the product.
Reason	Cause	**Required**	Choose, or click **+** to add a reason	The list is empty until you add the first reason.
Found At	Where the damage was found	**Required**	Choose **Godown**, **In Transit** or **Returned by Party**	—
Remarks	Notes	Optional	Type	Up to 500 characters.

+ (next to Reason): opens the **New Damage Reason** window, with the label **"Reason name:"** (Figure 64). Type a reason, for example `Expired`, and click **OK**. The message **"Reason added."** appears.

Save (Ctrl+S): records the damage. On success: **"Damage entry saved."**, then Qty and Remarks are cleared.

Damage Register: the last 100 damage entries, newest first. Columns: **Ref No** (automatic, for example DMG-00001), **Date**, **Product**, **Qty**, **Reason**, **Found At**, **Loss Amount**.

Screen states

Figure	State
 **Figure 63**	**"No damage entries recorded"**.
 **Figure 64**	New Damage Reason window.
 **Figure 65**	Qty larger than stock: **"Insufficient stock for 'Delta Dishwash Bar'. Available: 20.000, requested: 999.000."**
 **Figure 66**	Form filled.
 **Figure 67**	**"Damage entry saved."**

Other messages: **"Product, Reason and Found At are required."**, **"Quantity must be greater than zero."**

Effects

Effect	Where to verify
Stock of the product decreases by Qty.	Products **In Stock**, Daily Closing Stock **Damage** column.
Loss Amount = Qty × the product's current Avg Cost. Example: 2 cartons × Rs 1,764.29 = Rs 3,529.	Damage Register; Damage Report; Profit & Loss → **Damage Loss**.
A reference number DMG-nnnnn is assigned.	Damage Register.

> Damage entries cannot be edited or deleted. The stock check uses today's total stock, whatever date you choose.

---

12. Party Billing

Overview

Screen title	Party Billing — *Create a new sale bill*
Purpose	Creates a sale bill for a customer, records any cash received, and reduces stock.
Before you start	Customers and products with stock must exist.

How to open it

Click **Party Billing** under **SALES**, or click **New Bill (F2)** on the Dashboard.

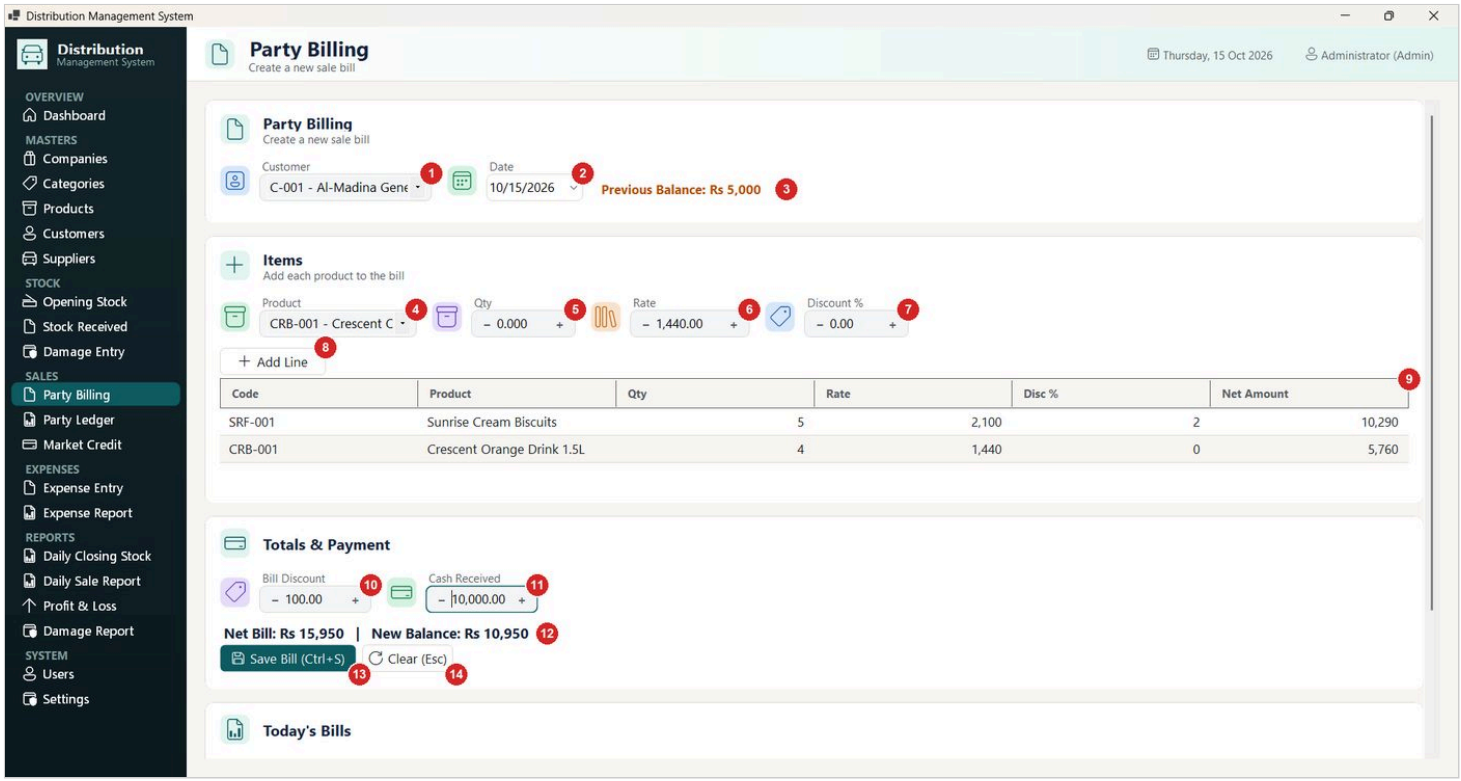


Figure 72a: Party Billing with a bill ready to save (numbered). Unmarked original: Figure 72.

No.	Control	Purpose and effect
1	**Customer**	Choose the customer (shown as `CODE - Shop Name`).
2	**Date**	Bill date (pre-filled with today).
3	**Previous Balance: Rs ...**	What the selected customer owes **before** this bill. It updates when you change the customer.
4	**Product**	Choose a product. Its **Sale Rate** is filled into **Rate** automatically.
5	**Qty**	Quantity sold.
6	**Rate**	Price per unit. You can change it for this bill.
7	**Discount %**	Line discount as a percentage of the line amount.
8	**Add Line**	Adds the line to the bill, then clears Qty and Discount %.
9	Item list	**Code**, **Product**, **Qty**, **Rate**, **Disc %**, **Net Amount** (amount after line discount).
10	**Bill Discount**	An extra discount for the whole bill, **in rupees** (not percent).
11	**Cash Received**	Money collected from the customer now, in rupees. Whatever you do **not** enter here is added to the customer's balance as credit.
11a	**Received In**	Whether that money came as **Cash** or **Bank**. Shown on the receipt in the ledger and on Receive Payment.
12	**Net Bill / New Balance**	Live totals. **Net Bill** = sum of line net amounts − Bill Discount. **New Balance** = Previous Balance + Net Bill − Cash Received.
13	**Save Bill (Ctrl+S)**	Saves the bill.
14	**Clear (Esc)**	Removes all lines and resets Bill Discount and Cash Received to 0. Customer and Date stay.

Below these is **Today's Bills** (scroll down): **Bill No**, **Customer**, **Net Amount**, **Cash Received** for bills dated today (Figure 75).

Form fields

Field Name	Purpose	Required/Optional	How to Enter the Value	Validation/Restrictions
Customer	Buyer	**Required**	Choose	The first customer is selected automatically. The list is refreshed after each saved bill.
Date	Bill date	Required (pre-filled)	Calendar or type	—
Product (line)	Item sold	**Required**	Choose	Lists products as they were when the screen was first opened in this session.
Qty (line)	Quantity	**Required**	Number	Greater than 0. Up to 3 decimals. Cannot be more than the stock available (checked on save).
Rate (line)	Price	**Required**	Auto-filled; may be edited	Greater than 0.

Field Name	Purpose	Required/Optional	How to Enter the Value	Validation/Restrictions
Discount % (line)	Line discount	Optional	Number	0 to 100. Operators and Viewers cannot exceed the product's **Max Discount %** (checked on save). Admins can.
Bill Discount	Whole-bill discount (Rs)	Optional	Number	0 or more.
Cash Received	Payment now (Rs)	Optional	Number	0 or more. May be more or less than the bill. Anything not paid now stays on the customer's account as credit.
Received In	Cash or bank	Required (pre-selected)	Choose **Cash** or **Bank**	Default **Cash**. Only matters when Cash Received is above 0.

How amounts are calculated

For each line:

- **Amount** = Qty × Rate, rounded to the nearest rupee.
- **Line discount** = Amount × Discount % ÷ 100, rounded to the nearest rupee.
- **Net Amount** = Amount − line discount.

For the bill:

- **Net Bill** = total of line Net Amounts − Bill Discount.
- **New Balance** = Previous Balance + Net Bill − Cash Received.

Worked example (Figure 72): Customer *Al-Madina General Store* has a Previous Balance of Rs 10,950.

Line	Qty × Rate	Amount	Discount	Net
Sunrise Cream Biscuits	5 × 2,100	10,500	2% = 210	10,290
Crescent Orange Drink 1.5L	4 × 1,440	5,760	0	5,760
			Lines total	**16,050**

Net Bill = 16,050 − Bill Discount 100 = **Rs 15,950**. New Balance = 10,950 + 15,950 − Cash Received 10,000 = **Rs 16,900**.

Of this bill, Rs 10,000 was paid now and **Rs 5,950 went on credit**. The message after saving states this amount.

Screen states

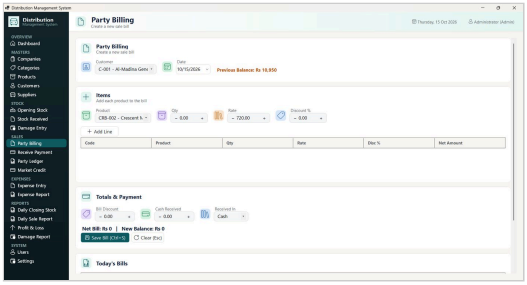
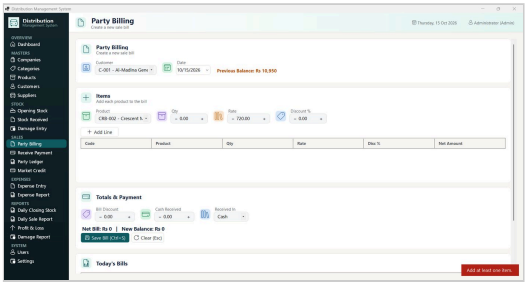
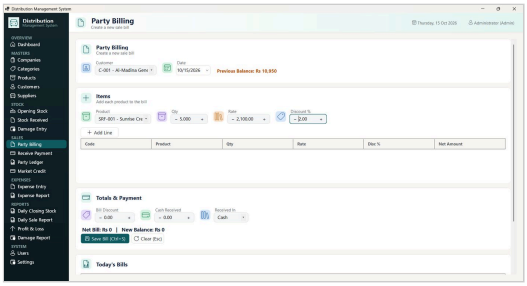
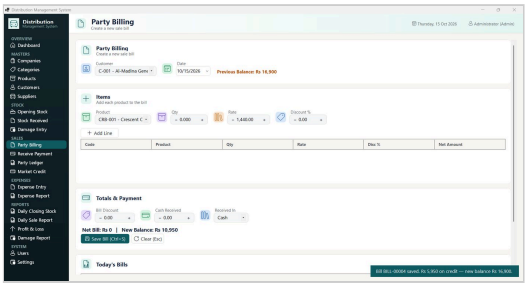
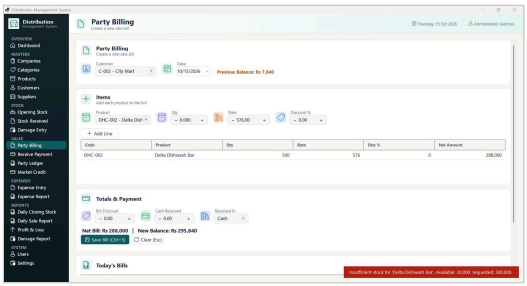
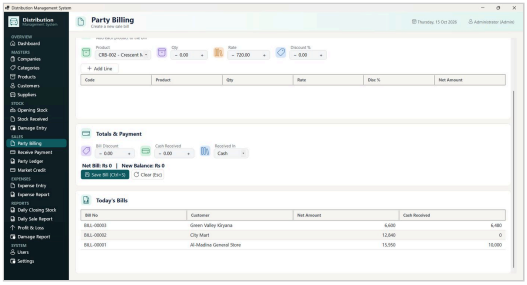
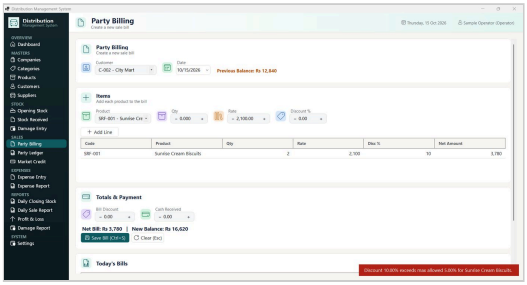
Figure	State
 **Figure 69**	New bill screen. Previous Balance of the first customer is shown.
 **Figure 70**	**Save Bill** with no lines: **"Add at least one item."**
 **Figure 71**	Product chosen: Rate filled with the Sale Rate (2,100).
 **Figure 73**	After saving, the message states the bill number and how much went on credit, for example **"Bill BILL-00004 saved. Rs 5,950 on credit — new balance Rs 16,900."** A fully paid bill shows **"... saved. Fully paid."** instead. The lines clear.
 **Figure 74**	Qty larger than stock: **"Insufficient stock for 'Delta Dishwash Bar'. Available: 20.000, requested: 500.000."** The bill is **not** saved and the lines stay so you can correct them.

Figure	State
 **Figure 75**	Today's Bills after three bills.
 **Figure 106**	Signed in as an **Operator**, a 10% discount on a product with Max Discount 5%: **"Discount 10.00% exceeds max allowed 5.00% for Sunrise Cream Biscuits."**

Other messages: **"Select a customer."**, **"Select a product."**, **"Qty and Rate must be greater than zero."**

Effects of saving a bill

Effect	Where to verify
A bill number is assigned automatically: BILL-00001, BILL-00002, …	Success message; Today's Bills; Daily Sale Report; Party Ledger.
Stock of every product on the bill decreases.	Products → **In Stock**; Daily Closing Stock → **Sold**.
The customer's balance increases by Net Bill.	Customers → **Balance**; Party Ledger (**Sale**, Debit); Market Credit.
If Cash Received is above 0, a receipt RCPT-nnnnn is recorded and the balance decreases by that amount.	Party Ledger (**Receipt**, Credit); Market Credit **Last Payment**.
The cost of goods sold is recorded at each product's Avg Cost at the moment of sale.	Profit & Loss → COGS.
After saving, the Customer list is reloaded, so **Previous Balance** shows the new balance.	Previous Balance label.

How to avoid everything going on credit: type the money collected into **Cash Received** before saving. If the customer pays later, record it on Receive Payment instead.

Important limitations - **No bill printing.** This version cannot print or export an individual bill. The Daily Sale Report, which lists every bill, can be printed and exported. - **No editing or cancelling.** A saved bill cannot be changed or deleted. - **No removing a single line.** If you add a wrong line, click **Clear (Esc)** and add the lines again. - **Customer Default Discount % is not applied.** Enter discounts on each line. - **Bill numbers always start**

> **with "BILL-"**, whatever is entered as **Invoice Prefix** in Settings. - **Add each product only once per bill.** Stock is checked line by line, so adding the same product on two lines may allow selling more than you hold (not tested).

12a. Receive Payment

Overview

Screen title	Receive Payment — *Record a payment from a customer against their balance*
Purpose	Records money a customer pays towards what they owe, without having to create a bill.
When to use it	A customer settles old dues, pays in part, or the recovery staff collect cash on the route.

How to open it

Click **Receive Payment** under **SALES** in the side menu.

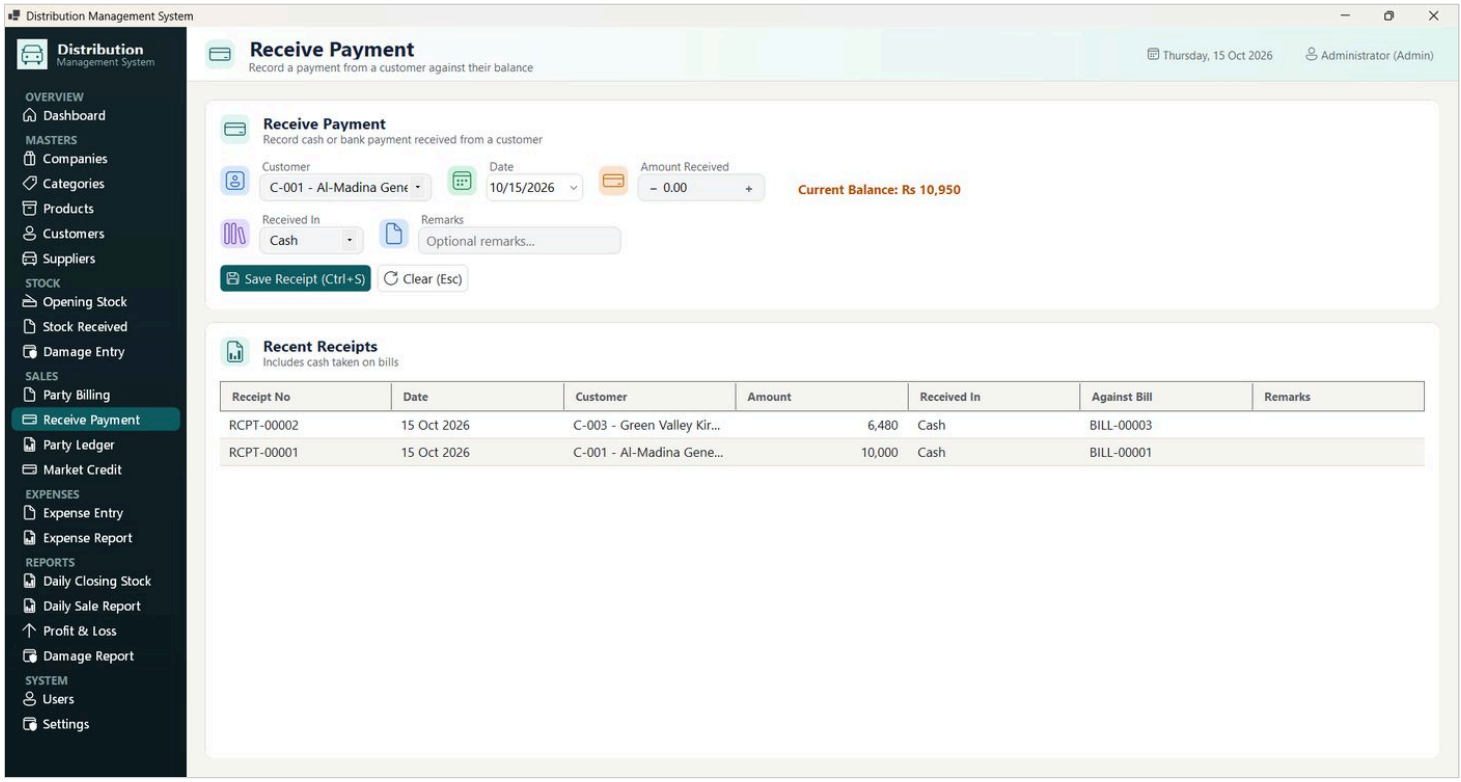


Figure 109: Receive Payment

Controls

Control	Purpose and effect
Customer	Choose the customer paying (shown as `CODE - Shop Name`).
Current Balance: Rs ...	What this customer owes **now**. It updates as soon as you choose a different customer.
Date	The date the money was received (pre-filled with today).

Control	Purpose and effect
Amount Received	How much the customer paid.
Received In	**Cash** or **Bank**.
Remarks	Optional note, for example `Recovery against old balance`.
Save Receipt (Ctrl+S)	Records the payment and reduces the customer's balance.
Clear (Esc)	Clears the Amount and Remarks. The customer and date stay.
Recent Receipts	The last 50 receipts, newest first — **both** stand-alone payments and cash taken on bills.

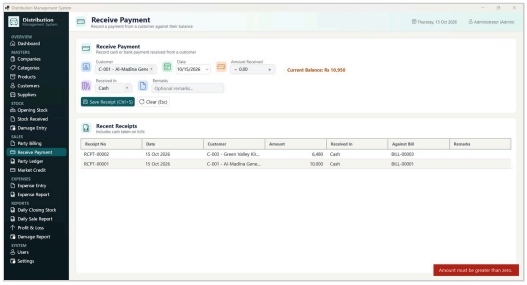
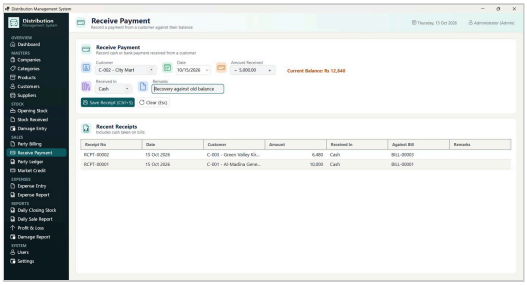
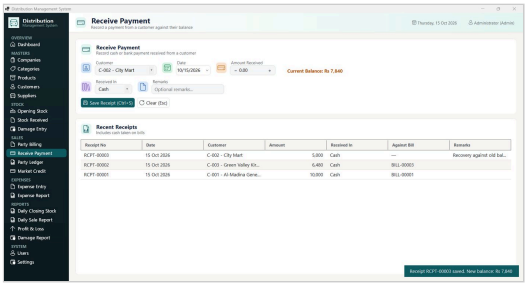
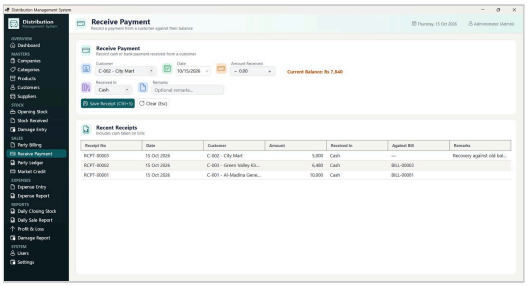
Form: Receive Payment

Field Name	Purpose	Required/Optional	How to Enter the Value	Validation/Restrictions
Customer	Who is paying	**Required**	Choose from the list	The first customer is selected automatically.
Date	Date received	Required (pre-filled)	Calendar or type	—
Amount Received	Amount paid (Rs)	**Required**	Number	Must be greater than zero. Up to 999,999,999 with 2 decimals. More than the balance is allowed: the balance simply goes negative (an advance).
Received In	Cash or bank	Required (pre-selected)	Choose **Cash** or **Bank**	Default **Cash**.
Remarks	Note	Optional	Type	Up to 500 characters.

Recent Receipts columns

Column	Meaning
Receipt No	Automatic number, for example RCPT-00003. Bills and stand-alone payments share one numbering.
Date	Date of the receipt.
Customer	Code and shop name.
Amount	Amount received.
Received In	Cash or Bank.
Against Bill	The bill number when the money was taken as **Cash Received** on a bill, or **—** for a stand-alone payment.
Remarks	Your note, if any.

Screen states

Figure	State
 **Figure 110**	**Save Receipt** with no amount: **"Amount must be greater than zero."**
 **Figure 111**	Form filled with example data.
 **Figure 112**	After saving: **"Receipt RCPT-00003 saved. New balance: Rs 7,840"**. The Amount and Remarks clear, and the receipt appears in the list.
 **Figure 113**	Recent Receipts showing a stand-alone payment (Against Bill = —) alongside cash taken on bills.

Other message: **"Select a customer."**

Effects of saving a receipt

Effect	Where to verify
The customer's balance decreases by the amount.	The **Current Balance** label; Customers → **Balance**; Market Credit.
A receipt RCPT-nnnnn is recorded.	Recent Receipts on this screen.
The payment appears in the customer's ledger as a **Receipt** in the **Credit** column.	Party Ledger.

Effect	Where to verify
Market Credit shows the reduced balance and the new **Last Payment** date.	Market Credit.

> **Receipts cannot be edited or deleted.** Check the customer and amount before saving.
>
> **Note:** a receipt is not linked to a particular bill. It reduces the customer's overall balance, oldest dues first in practice.

---

13. Party Ledger

Overview

Screen title	Party Ledger — *View a customer's transaction history*
Purpose	Shows a customer's bills and payments for a date range, with a running balance.

How to open it

Click **Party Ledger** under **SALES**.

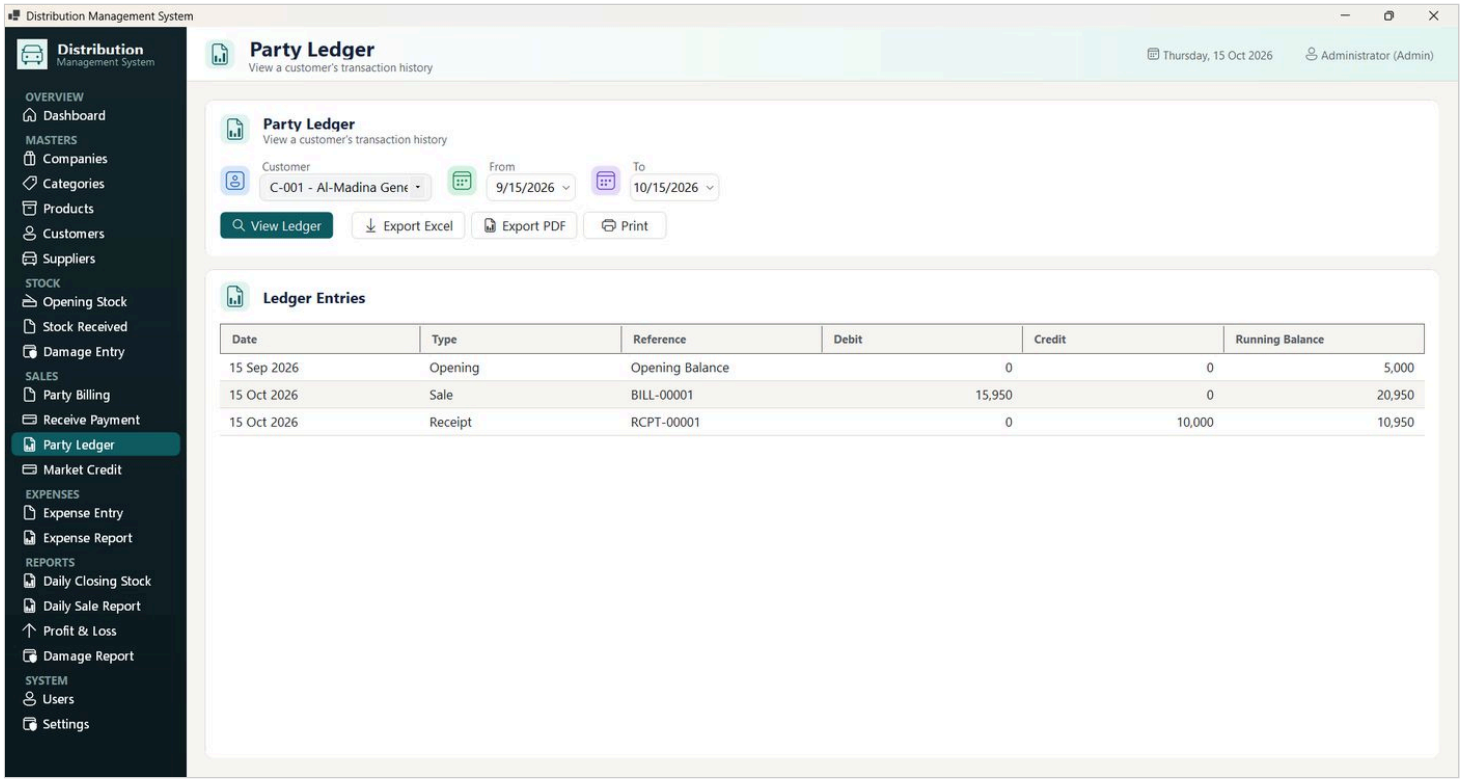


Figure 77: Ledger for Al-Madina General Store from 15 Sep to 15 Oct 2026

Controls

Control	Purpose	How to use
Customer	Customer whose ledger you want	Choose from the list.
From	Start date	Pre-filled with one month before today.
To	End date	Pre-filled with today.
View Ledger	Shows the ledger	Click after choosing the customer and dates. Nothing is shown until you click it (Figure 76).
Export Excel, **Export PDF**, **Print**	Saves or prints the ledger	Click **View Ledger** first; otherwise the message "Click View Ledger first." appears. The export includes a closing-balance total row.

Ledger columns

Column	Meaning
Date	Transaction date. The first row is dated with the **From** date.
Type	**Opening** (balance brought forward), **Sale** (a bill) or **Receipt** (cash received on a bill).
Reference	**Opening Balance**, the bill number (BILL-…) or the receipt number (RCPT-…).
Debit	Amount that increases what the customer owes (bills).
Credit	Amount that reduces what the customer owes (receipts).
Running Balance	Balance after each row. The last row is the balance at the **To** date.

The **Opening** row shows the customer's Opening Balance plus all bills minus all receipts **before** the From date.

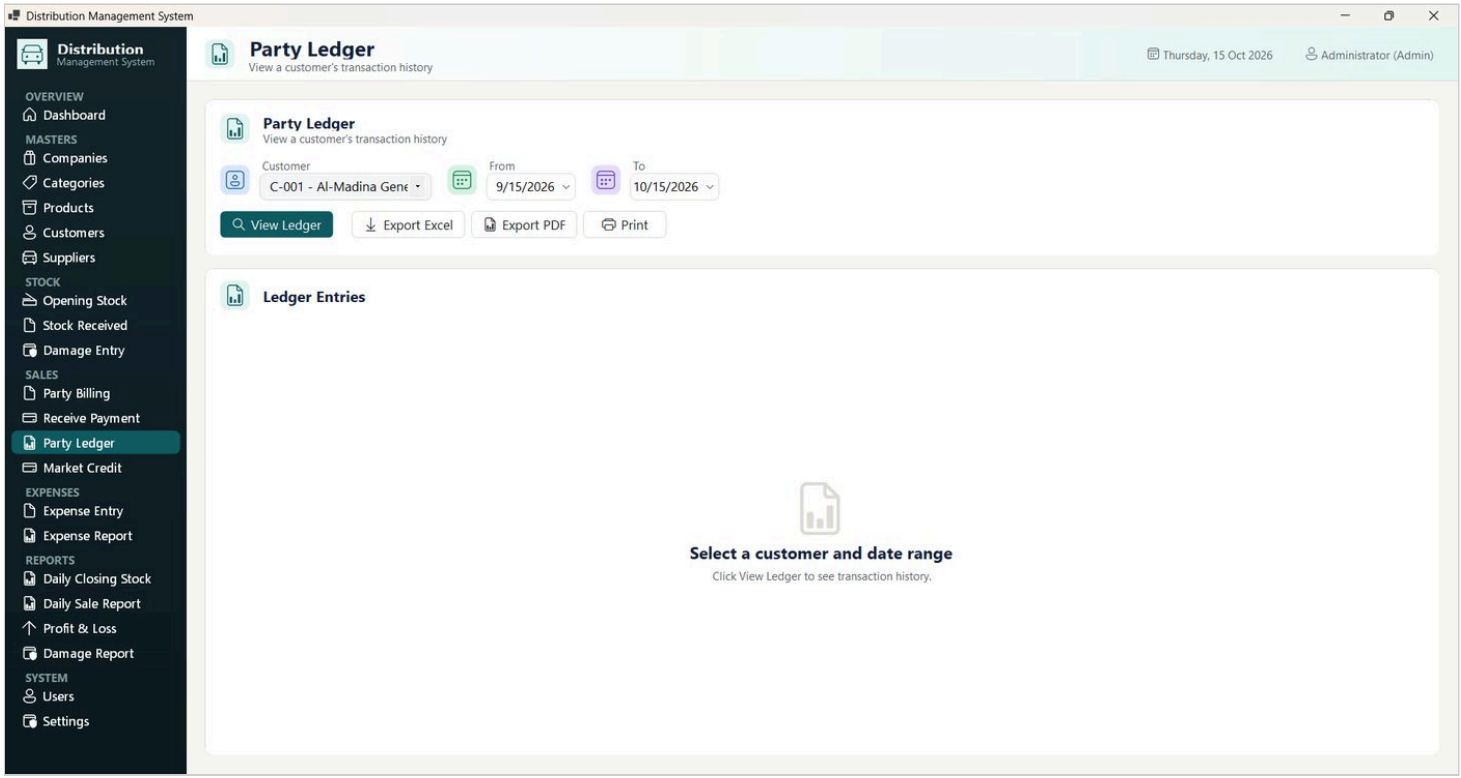


Figure 76: Before clicking View Ledger: "Select a customer and date range — Click View Ledger to see transaction history."

> **Receipt** rows come from two places: **Cash Received** on a bill, and payments recorded on Receive Payment.

---

14. Market Credit

Overview

Screen title	Market Credit — *Customer-wise outstanding balances*
Purpose	Lists every customer who owes you money, with the total amount outstanding.

How to open it

Click **Market Credit** under **SALES**.

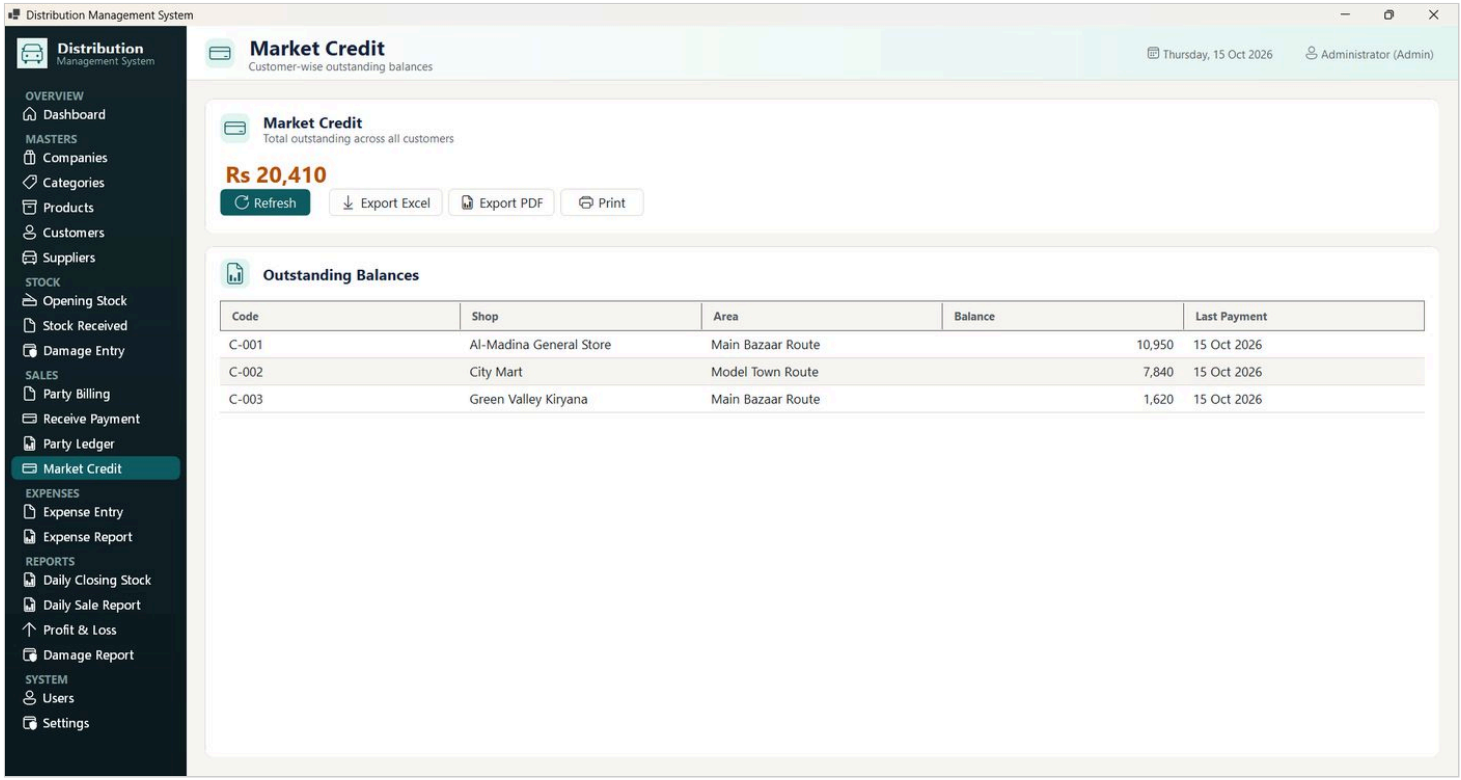


Figure 78: Market Credit showing a total of Rs 25,410 owed by three customers

What it shows

Element	Meaning
Market Credit card	Large orange figure: total amount owed by all customers in the list.
Outstanding Balances list	**Code**, **Shop**, **Area**, **Balance**, **Last Payment** (date of the latest cash receipt, or "—" if none). Only customers whose balance is **above zero** are listed, highest balance first.
Empty message	**"No outstanding credit — All customers are settled."** when nobody owes money.

Element	Meaning
Refresh button	Recalculates the balances without leaving the screen.
Export Excel, **Export PDF**, **Print**	Saves or prints the outstanding list with a total row.

> This screen recalculates its figures every time you open it, and the **Refresh** button does the same without leaving the screen.

---

15. Expense Entry

Overview

Screen title	Expense Entry — *Record a business or personal expense*
Purpose	Records money spent, for example fuel, salaries or rent.

How to open it

Click **Expense Entry** under **EXPENSES**, or click **Add Expense** on the Dashboard.

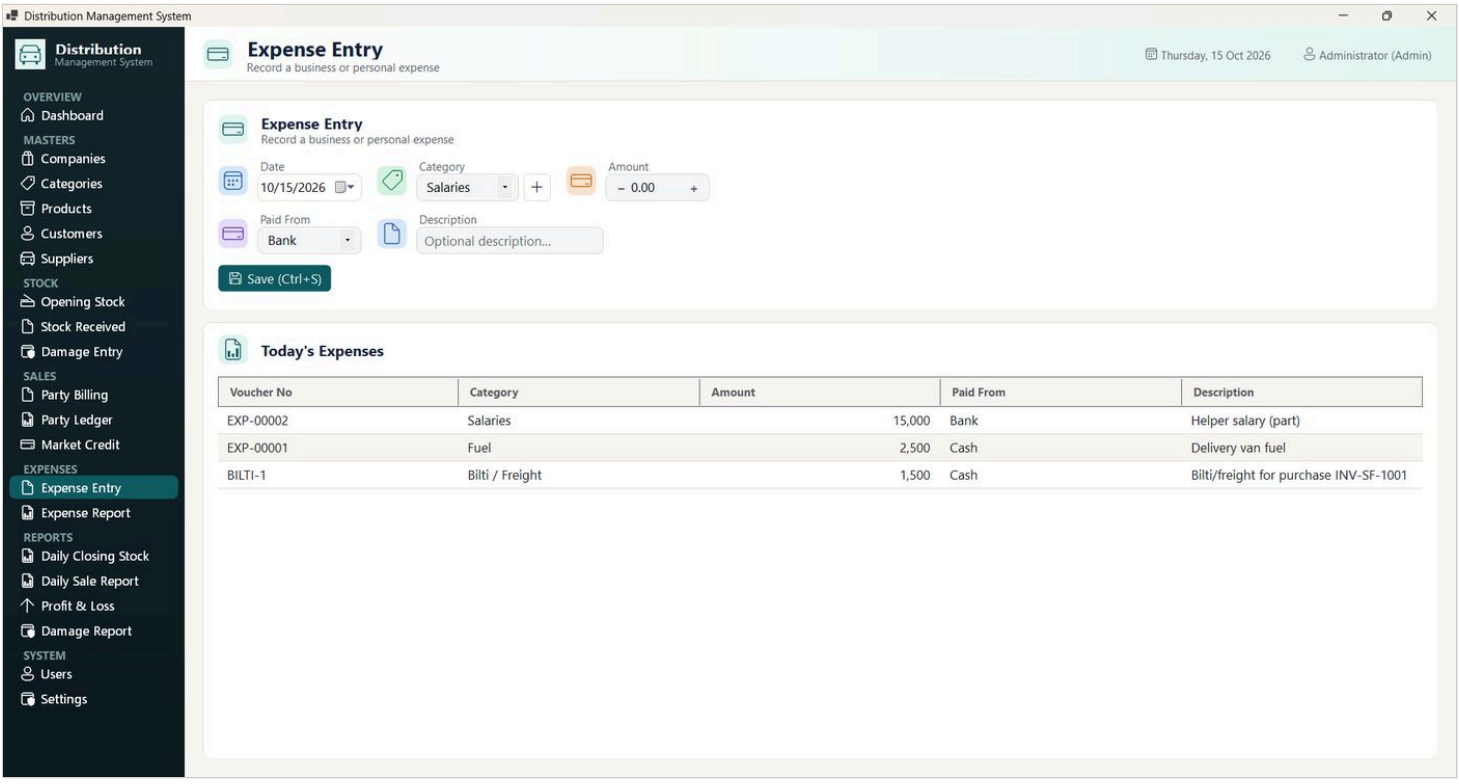


Figure 84: Expense Entry with three expenses today. BILTI-1 was created automatically from a purchase.

Form fields

Field Name	Purpose	Required/Optional	How to Enter the Value	Validation/Restrictions
Date	Expense date	Required (pre-filled with today)	Calendar or type	—
Category	Type of expense	**Required**	Choose, or click **+** to add	The list is empty until you add a category (or until a purchase with bilti creates "Bilti / Freight").
Amount	Amount spent (Rs)	**Required**	Number	Greater than 0.
Paid From	Source of money	Required (pre-selected)	Choose **Cash** or **Bank**	Default Cash.
Description	Notes	Optional	Type	Up to 500 characters.

+ (next to Category): opens **New Expense Category** with the label **"Category name:"** (Figure 81). Type the name and click **OK**. Message: **"Category added."** Categories added here are always **business** expenses. See Profit & Loss about self (personal) expenses.

Save (Ctrl+S): saves the expense with an automatic voucher number (EXP-00001, EXP-00002, ...). Message **"Expense saved."** Amount and Description are cleared.

Today's Expenses: expenses dated today: **Voucher No**, **Category**, **Amount**, **Paid From**, **Description**.

Screen states

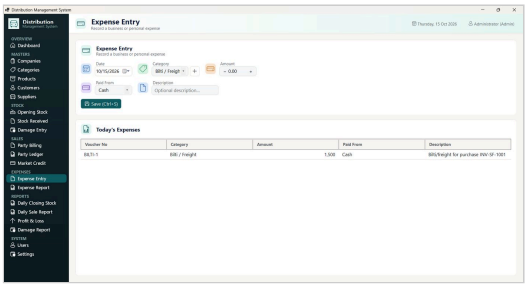
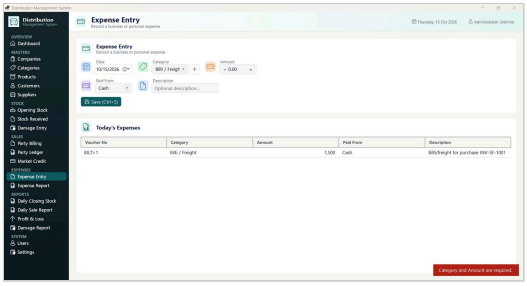
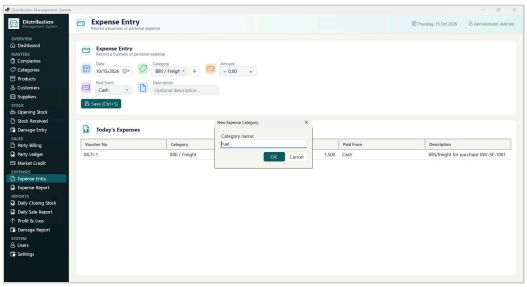
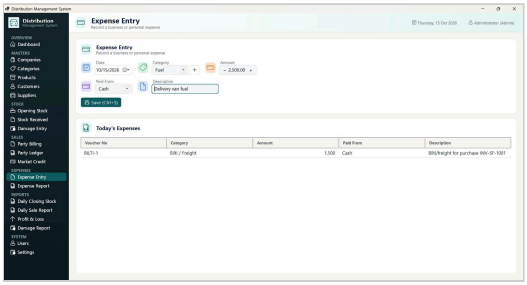
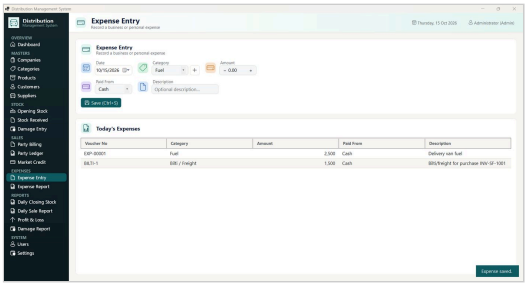
Figure	State
 **Figure 79**	Screen with only the automatic bilti expense listed.
 **Figure 80**	**"Category and Amount are required."** (also shown when Amount is 0).

Figure	State
 **Figure 81**	New Expense Category window.
 **Figure 82**	Form filled.
 **Figure 83**	**"Expense saved."**

Effects

- The expense appears in the Expense Report and in Profit & Loss (**Business Expenses**).
- Expenses cannot be edited or deleted from the application.

---

16. Expense Report

Overview

Screen title	Expense Report — *Category-wise expense breakdown*
Purpose	Lists expenses for a date range and shows this month's totals by category.

How to open it

Click **Expense Report** under **EXPENSES**.

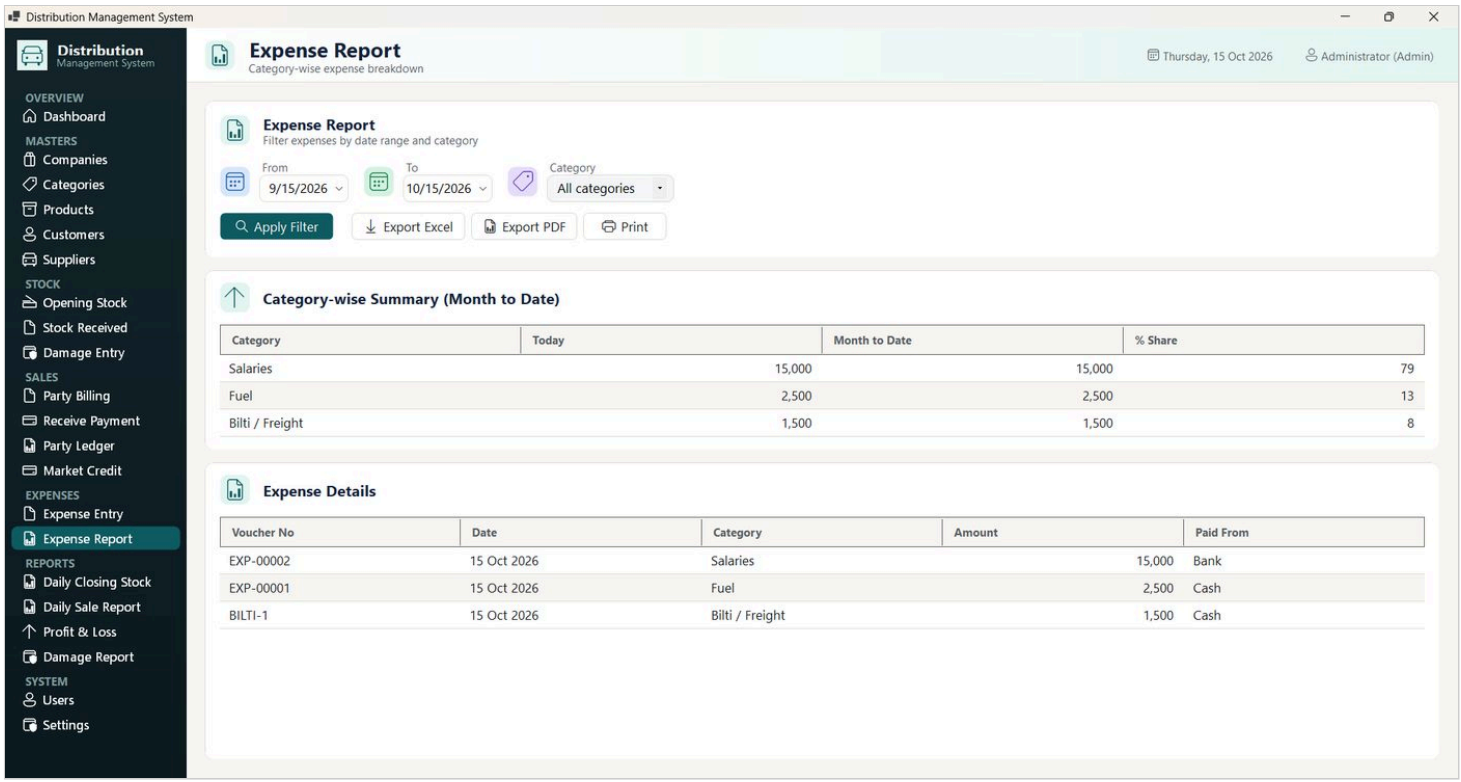


Figure 85: Expense Report

Controls

Control	Purpose
From	Start date (pre-filled with 30 days before today).
To	End date (today).
Category	**All categories** or one category.
Apply Filter	Reloads **both** the month-to-date summary and the **Expense Details** list for the chosen dates and category.
Export Excel, **Export PDF**, **Print**	Saves or prints the summary and the details together.

Sections

Section	Content
Category-wise Summary (Month to Date)	For each category: **Today**, **Month to Date** (from the 1st of the current month), **% Share** of the month's total. This section always covers the current month and **ignores the date and category filter**; the filter applies to Expense Details only.
Expense Details	**Voucher No**, **Date**, **Category**, **Amount**, **Paid From** for expenses matching the filter, newest first. Empty message: **"No expenses in this range — Try a wider date range or different category."**

> The month-to-date summary is recalculated when you open the screen and when you click **Apply Filter**.

---

17. Daily Closing Stock

Overview

Screen title	Daily Closing Stock — *Opening, received, sold and closing per product*
Purpose	Shows, for one day, each product's stock movement and closing quantity and value.

How to open it

Click **Daily Closing Stock** under **REPORTS**. It loads automatically for today.

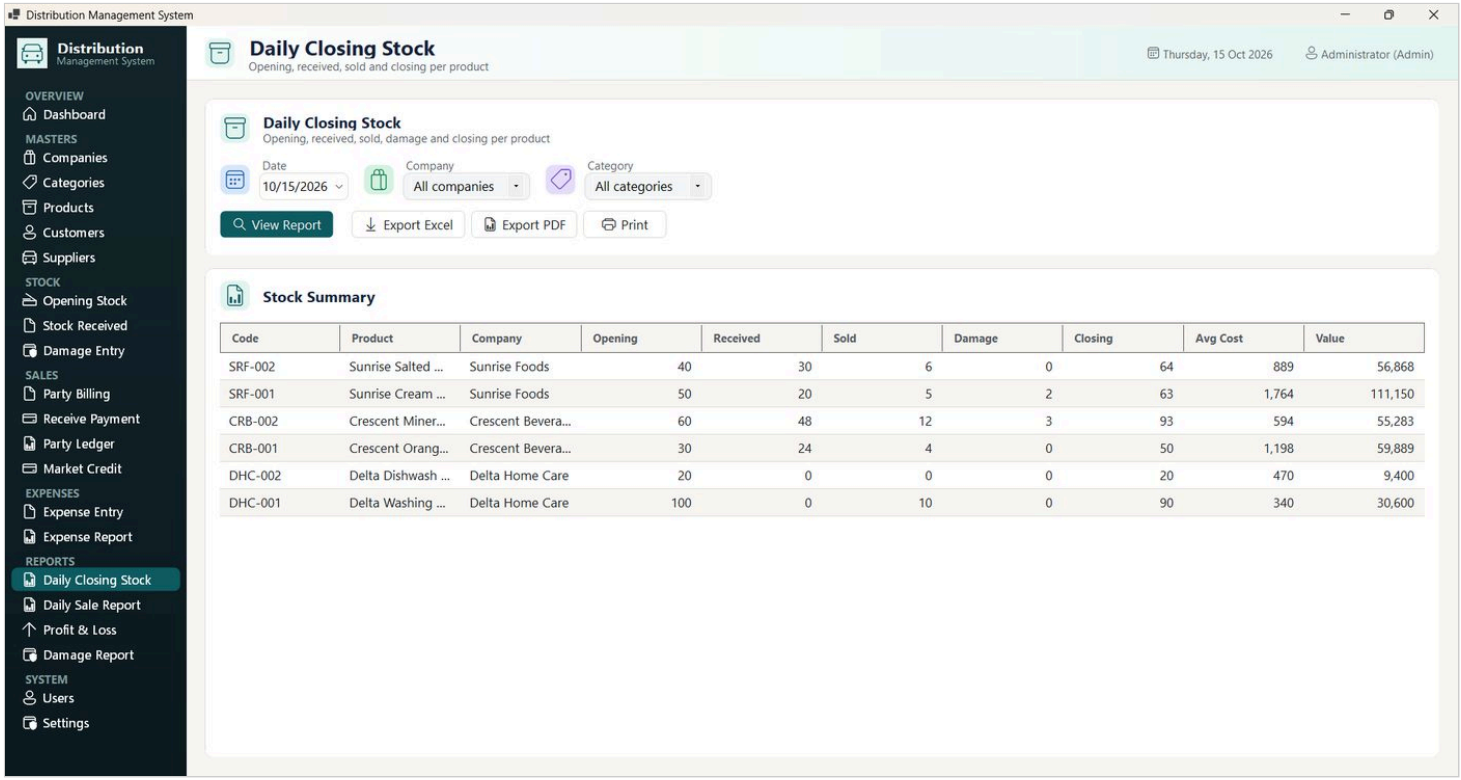


Figure 86: Daily Closing Stock for 15 Oct 2026

Controls

Control	Purpose
Date	The day to report on.
Company	**All companies** or one company.
Category	**All categories** or one category.
View Report	Recalculates using the chosen date and filters. Click it after changing anything.
Export Excel, **Export PDF**, **Print**	Saves or prints the stock summary, including a total of the **Value** column. The PDF is landscape so every column fits.

Columns

Column	Meaning
Code, Product, Company	Product details.
Opening	Stock at the start of the day (all movements dated before the day).
Received	Purchases **and** opening stock entries dated that day.
Sold	Quantity on bills dated that day.
Damage	Quantity on damage entries dated that day.
Closing	Opening + Received − Sold − Damage.
Avg Cost	The product's **current** average cost (even when you choose a past date).
Value	Closing × Avg Cost.

Empty message: **"No products to show — Add products under Masters > Products first."** Deleted products are not shown.

---

18. Daily Sale Report

Overview

Screen title	Daily Sale Report — *Bill-wise, product-wise and company-wise sales*
Purpose	Summarises one day's sales in three ways. Often called the DSR.

How to open it

Click **Daily Sale Report** under **REPORTS**. It loads automatically for today.

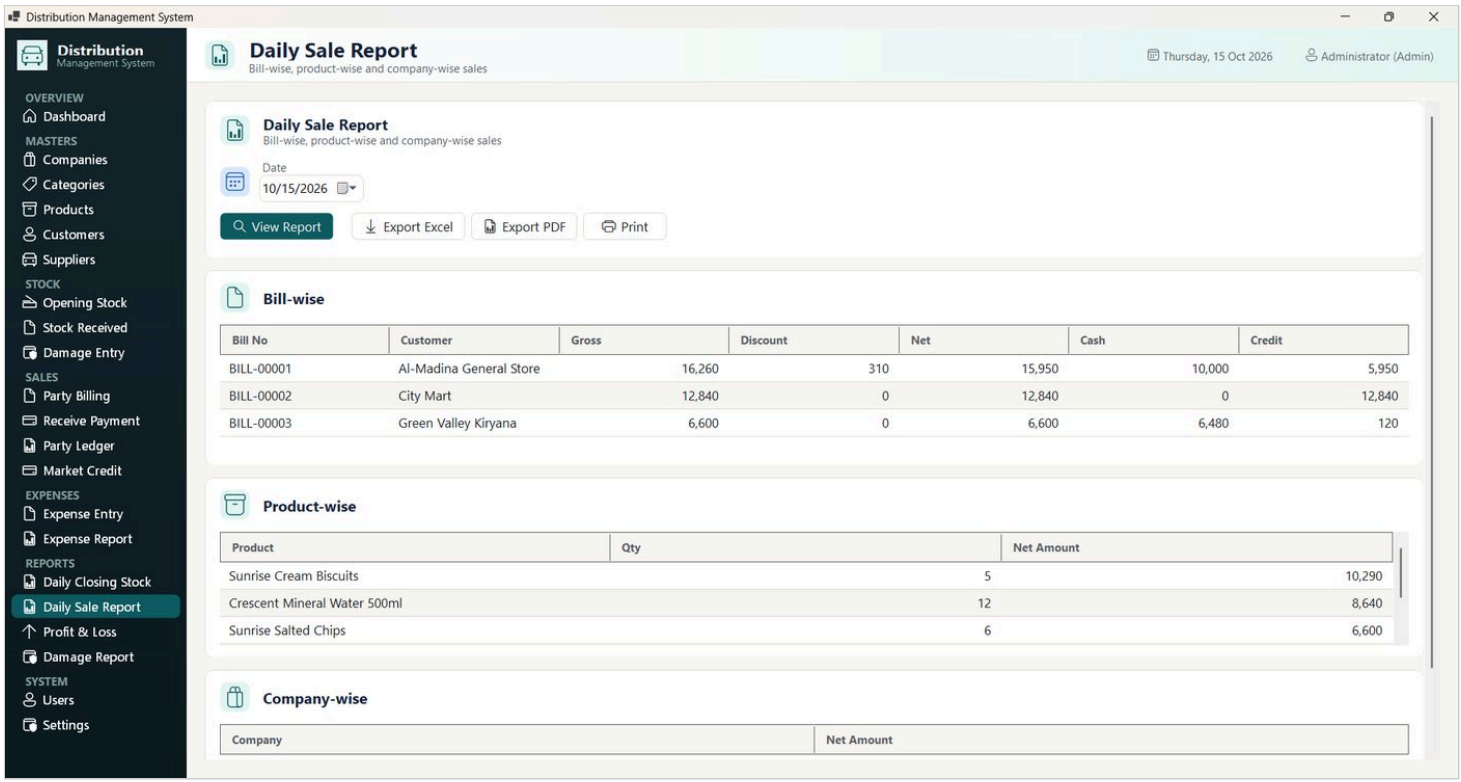


Figure 87: Daily Sale Report — bill-wise and product-wise sections

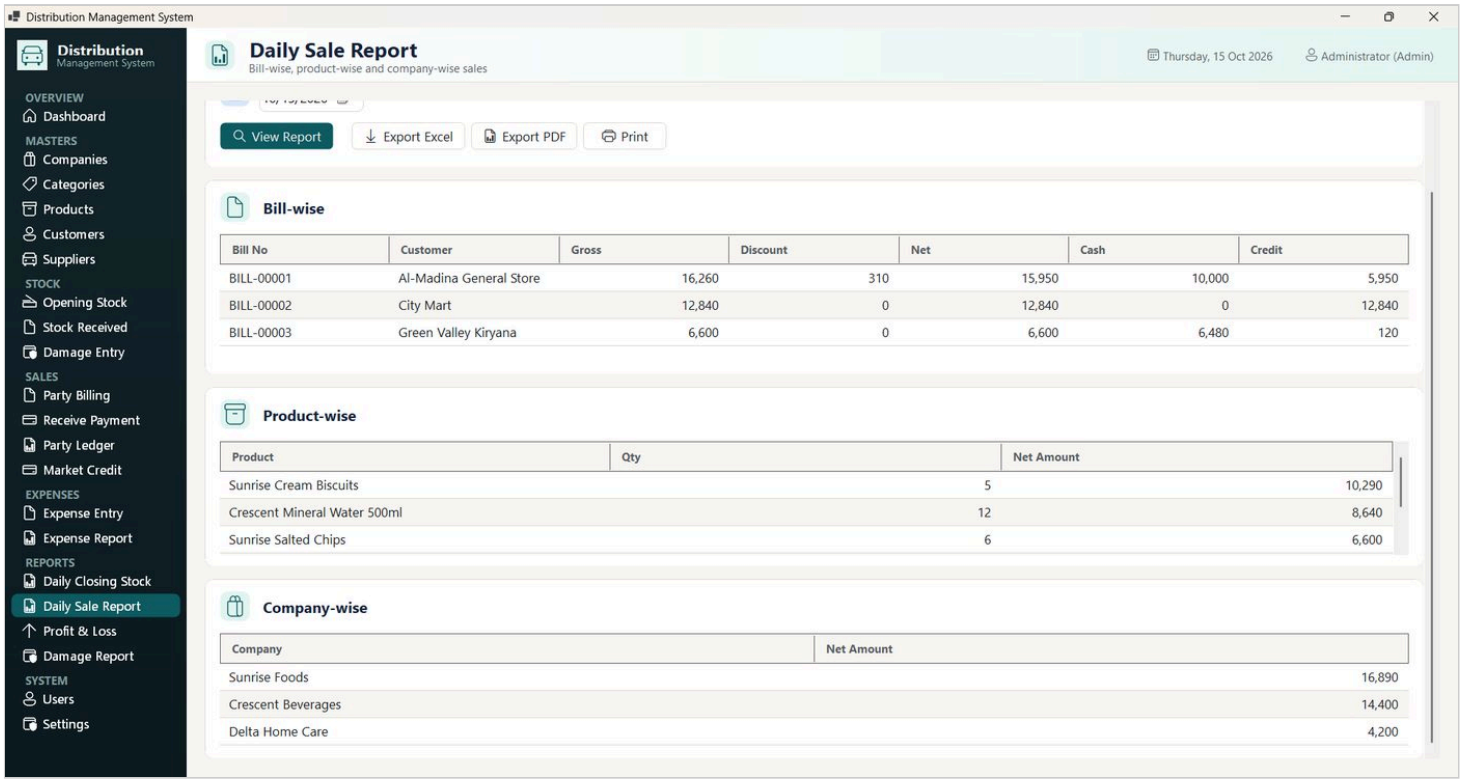


Figure 88: Daily Sale Report scrolled down to the company-wise section

Controls

Date (the day) and **View Report** (reload), plus **Export Excel**, **Export PDF** and **Print**. The export contains all three sections, each with its own total row.

Sections

Section	Columns	Notes
Bill-wise	Bill No, Customer, Gross, Discount, Net, Cash, Credit	**Discount** = line discounts + bill discount. **Credit** = Net − Cash (amount left on account).
Product-wise	Product, Qty, Net Amount	Net Amount is after **line** discounts only.
Company-wise	Company, Net Amount	After line discounts only.

> Product-wise and company-wise totals do not subtract bill-level discounts, so they can be slightly higher than the bill-wise **Net** total. When no sales exist for the date, the lists are simply empty.

---

19. Profit & Loss

Overview

Screen title	Profit & Loss — *Net sale, cost, expenses and net profit*
Purpose	Calculates profit for any date range.

How to open it

Click **Profit & Loss** under **REPORTS**. It loads automatically for today.

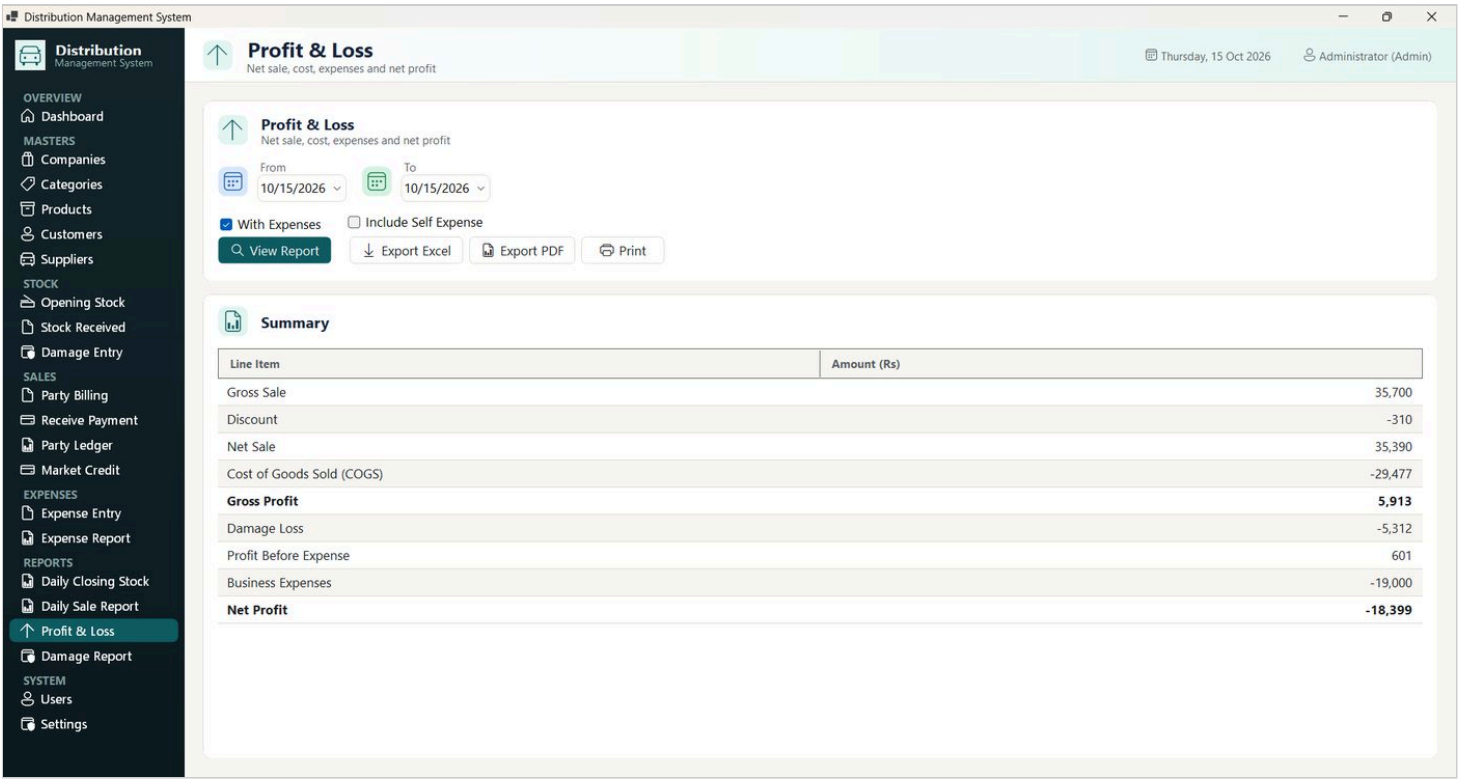


Figure 89: Profit & Loss for 15 Oct 2026 using the example data

Controls

Control	Purpose
From, **To**	Date range (both pre-filled with today).
With Expenses (ticked by default)	Includes business expenses and shows **Net Profit**.
Include Self Expense	Also subtracts personal (self) expenses. Available only when With Expenses is ticked.
View Report	Recalculates. **Ticking or unticking a box does nothing until you click View Report.**
Export Excel, **Export PDF**, **Print**	Saves or prints the summary exactly as shown, including the expense options you chose.

Lines

Line Item	Meaning
Gross Sale	Total of bill amounts before discounts.
Discount	Line discounts + bill discounts (shown as negative).
Net Sale	Gross Sale − Discount.
Cost of Goods Sold (COGS)	Quantity sold × average cost at the time of each sale (negative).
Gross Profit	Net Sale − COGS.
Damage Loss	Total loss from damage entries in the range (negative).
Profit Before Expense	Gross Profit − Damage Loss.
Business Expenses	All business expenses, including automatic bilti (shown with **With Expenses**).
Net Profit	Profit Before Expense − Business Expenses.
Self Expenses	Personal expenses (shown with **Include Self Expense**).
Net Profit (After Self Expense)	Net Profit − Self Expenses.

> **Self expenses:** categories created with the **+** button on Expense Entry are always business categories, so in normal use **Self Expenses** is 0. A self-expense category cannot be created from the application in this version.

---

20. Damage Report

Overview

Screen title	Damage Report — *Grouped loss summary for any date range*
Purpose	Totals damage by product, company, reason or month.

How to open it

Click **Damage Report** under **REPORTS**. It loads automatically for the last 12 months, grouped by product.

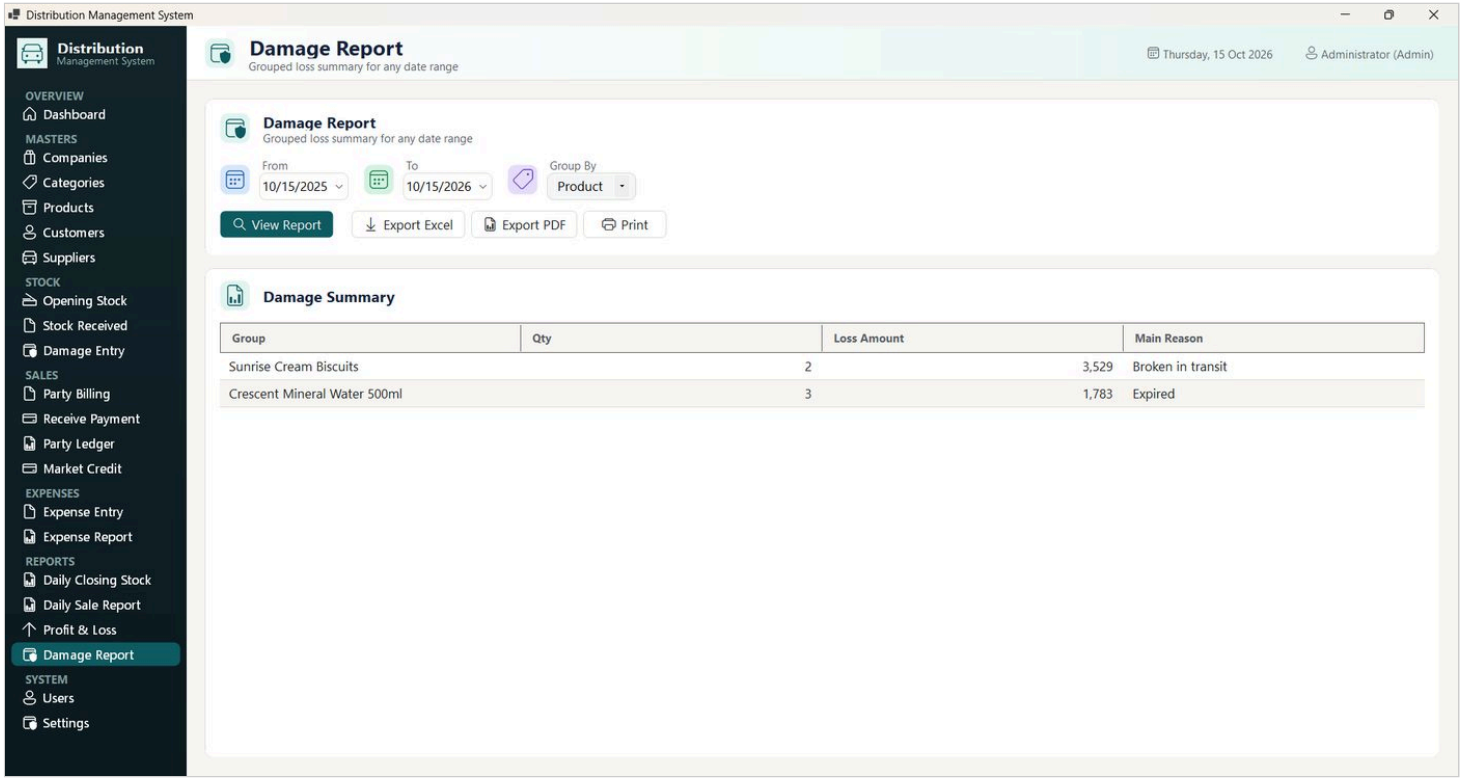


Figure 90: Damage Report grouped by product

Controls

Control	Purpose
From	Start date (pre-filled with one year ago).
To	End date (today).
Group By	**Product**, **Company**, **Reason** or **Month**.
View Report	Recalculates. Changing Group By has no effect until you click it.
Export Excel, **Export PDF**, **Print**	Saves or prints the grouped summary with totals. The grouping you chose is named in the heading.

Columns

Group (the product, company, reason or month), **Qty** (total quantity), **Loss Amount** (total loss), **Main Reason** (the reason with the largest loss in that group). Highest loss first. Empty message: **"No damage in this range — Try a wider date range."**

---

21. Users

Overview

Screen title	Users — *Manage staff logins and roles*
Purpose	Creates sign-in accounts, sets roles, resets passwords and activates or deactivates accounts.
Who can use it	**Admin only.** The **Users** menu item is hidden for other roles (Figure 105).

How to open it

Sign in as an Admin, then click **Users** under **SYSTEM**.

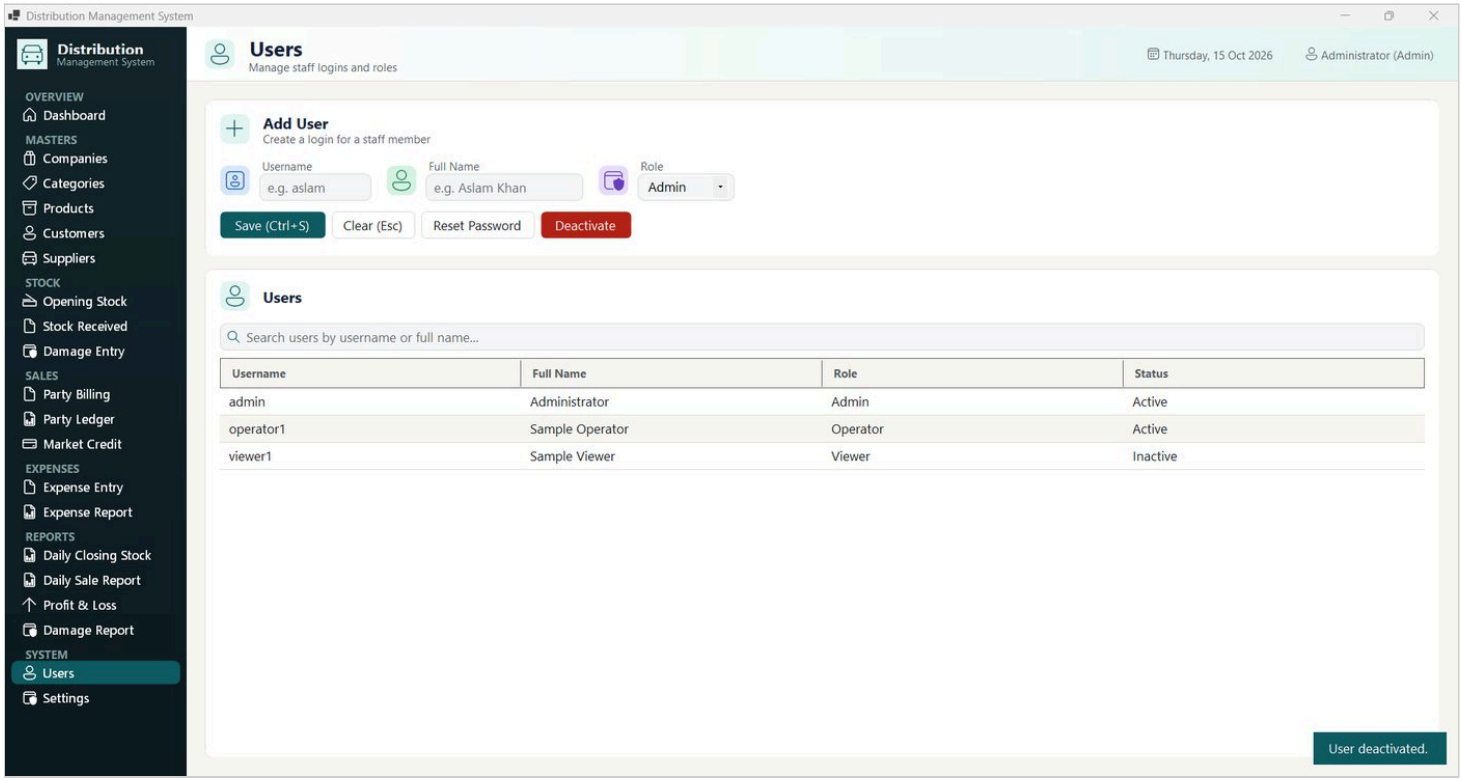


Figure 101: Users screen after deactivating *viewer1*

Controls

Control	Purpose and effect
Username	Sign-in name.
Full Name	Person's name, shown at the top-right after they sign in.
Role	**Admin**, **Operator** or **Viewer**. See roles.
Save (Ctrl+S)	For a new user: asks for a password, then creates the account.
Update (Ctrl+S)	For a loaded user: saves the changed username, full name or role.
Clear (Esc)	Empties the form.
Reset Password	(edit mode) Asks for a new password for the loaded user.
Deactivate / **Activate**	(edit mode) Blocks or re-allows sign-in for the loaded user. The label depends on the user's current status. **No confirmation is asked.**
Search box	Searches username or full name.

Control	Purpose and effect
Users list	**Username**, **Full Name**, **Role**, **Status** (Active/Inactive). Click a row to load it.

Form: Add User

Field Name	Purpose	Required/Optional	How to Enter the Value	Validation/Restrictions
Username	Sign-in name	**Required**	Type, for example `operator1`	Up to 50 characters. Must be unique: **"Username already exists."** Case-sensitive at sign-in.
Full Name	Display name	**Required**	Type	Up to 200 characters.
Role	Permission level	**Required**	Choose	**The default is Admin.** Change it before saving if the person should not be an administrator.
Password (asked in a separate window)	Initial password	**Required** for new users	Type in the **Set Password** window	No minimum length or complexity rule. **The password is shown as you type.** Leaving it blank (or clicking Cancel) cancels the creation.

Screen states

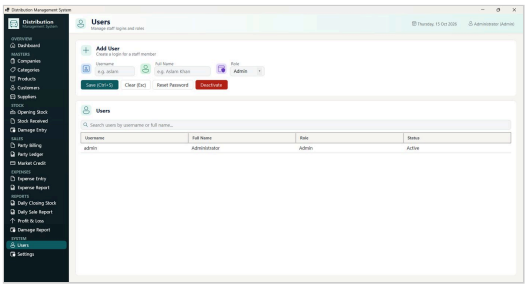
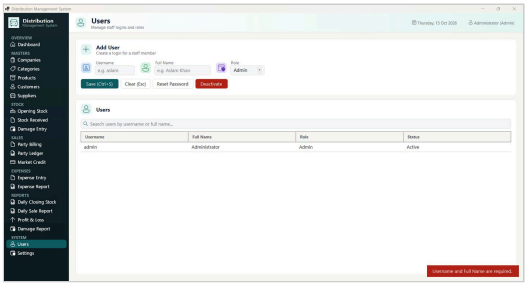
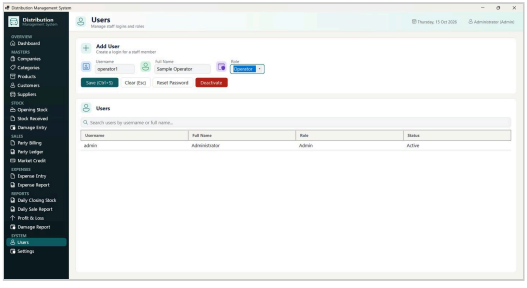
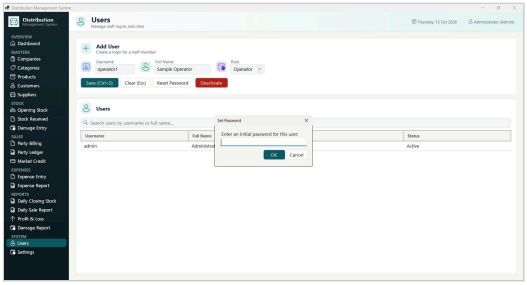
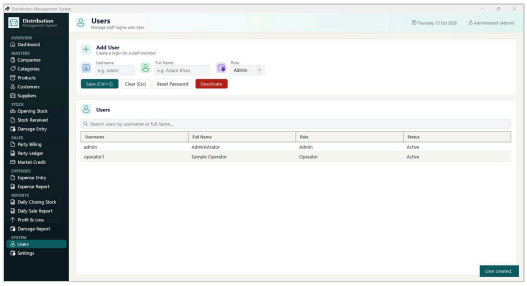
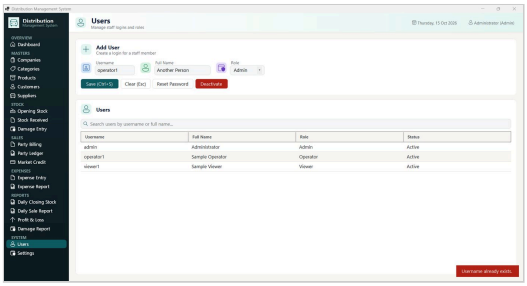
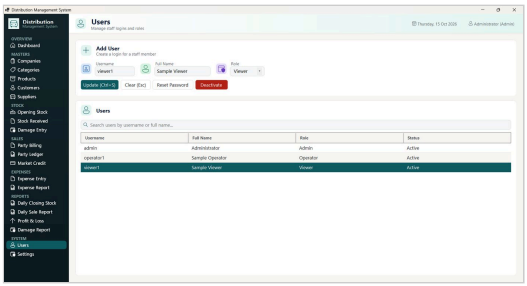
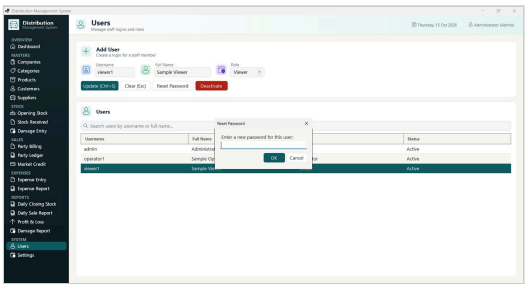
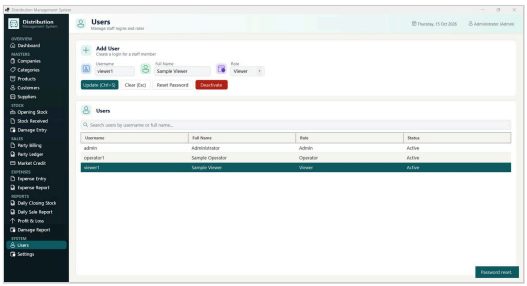
Figure	State
 **Figure 92**	Only the built-in administrator exists.
 **Figure 93**	**"Username and Full Name are required."**
 **Figure 94**	New Operator being entered.

Figure	State
 **Figure 95**	**Set Password** window: "Enter an initial password for this user:"
 **Figure 96**	**"User created."**
 **Figure 97**	**"Username already exists."**
 **Figure 98**	User loaded: Update, Reset Password and Deactivate are available.
 **Figure 99**	**Reset Password** window: "Enter a new password for this user:"
 **Figure 100**	**"Password reset."**

Other messages: "User updated.", "User activated.", "User deactivated."

Effects

Action	Effect
Create user	The person can sign in straight away with the username and password.
Change role	Takes effect the next time that user signs in.
Reset password	The old password stops working immediately. Tell the user the new one privately.
Deactivate	The user can no longer sign in ("Invalid username or password."). Someone already signed in is not signed out. Their past work is kept.
Activate	The user can sign in again.

> **Warnings** - Make sure at least one other **active Admin** exists before deactivating an admin or changing an admin's role. The application does **not** stop you from deactivating the last administrator, or yourself. Without an active admin, nobody can manage users. - Users cannot be deleted, only deactivated. - Users cannot change their own password; an Admin must use **Reset Password**.

---

22. Settings

Overview

Screen title	Settings — *Company info, invoicing and stock preferences*
Purpose	Stores your business details and provides database backup and restore.
Who can use it	All roles.

How to open it

Click **Settings** under **SYSTEM**.

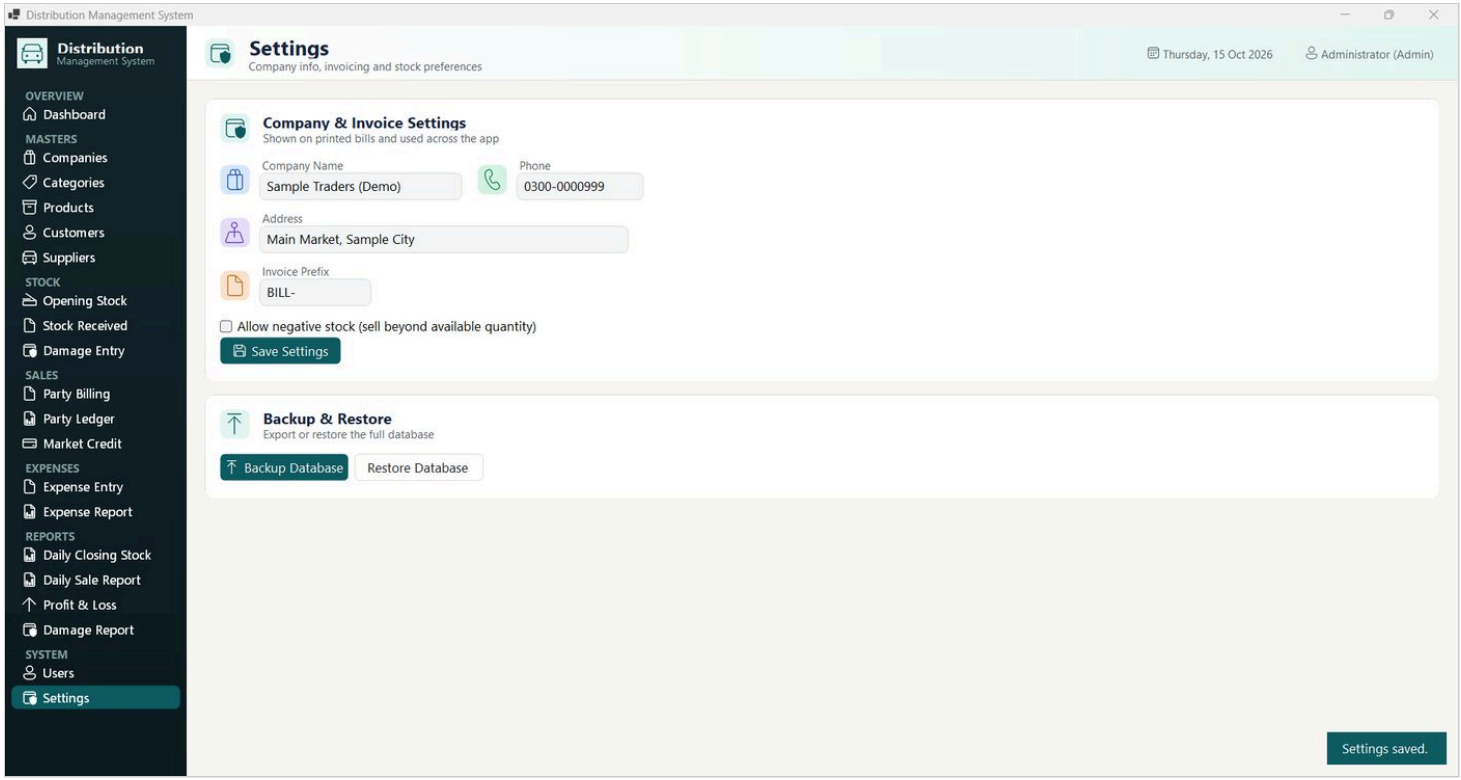
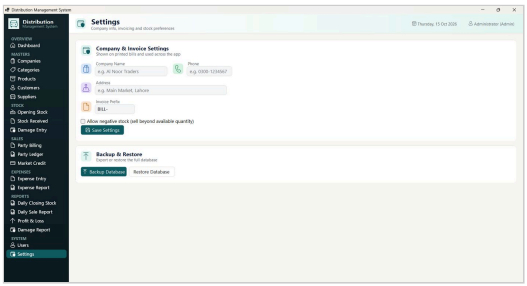
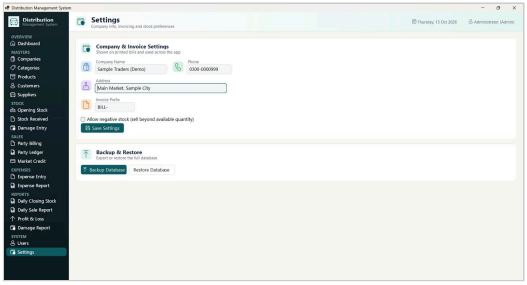


Figure 104: Settings after saving example company details

Figure	State
 **Figure 102**	Settings on a new installation: only **Invoice Prefix** is filled (BILL-).
 **Figure 103**	Example business details typed in before saving.

Company & Invoice Settings

Field Name	Purpose	Required/Optional	How to Enter the Value	Effect in this version
Company Name	Your business name	Optional	Type, for example `Al Noor Traders`	**Printed at the top of every exported and printed report.** If left empty, reports show "Distribution Management System".

Field Name	Purpose	Required/Optional	How to Enter the Value	Effect in this version
Phone	Business phone	Optional	Type	Printed under the business name on reports.
Address	Business address	Optional	Type	Printed under the business name on reports.
Invoice Prefix	Intended bill number prefix	Optional (default `BILL-`)	Type	Saved only. **Bills always use BILL-.**
Allow negative stock (sell beyond available quantity)	Intended to allow selling more than you hold	Optional checkbox	Tick or untick	Saved only. **Selling more than the stock is always refused.**

Save Settings stores the values. Message: **"Settings saved."**

Software Update

Control	What it does
Installed version: …	The version running on this computer.
Check for Updates	Looks for a newer version straight away. If one is found the Software Update window opens; otherwise a short message explains why not.

Backup & Restore

Button	What happens
Backup Database	A **Save As** window opens with a suggested name such as `distribution-20261015-153000.backup`. Choose a folder (ideally a USB drive or another computer) and click **Save**. On success: **"Backup created successfully."** On failure: **"Backup failed: …"** with the reason.
Restore Database	An **Open** window asks for a `.backup` file. After you pick one, the application asks **"Restoring will overwrite existing data. Continue?"** (window **Confirm restore**). **Yes** replaces the data, then shows **"Database restored. Please restart the application."** **No** cancels. Failure: **"Restore failed: …"**

> **Requirement:** Backup and Restore need the PostgreSQL client programs (`pg_dump` and `pg_restore`) installed on the computer and available to Windows. If they are missing, the message is **"Backup failed: An error occurred trying to start process 'pg_dump' … The system cannot find the file specified."** Ask your system administrator to install them.
>
> **Danger — Restore Database replaces all current data** with the contents of the backup file. Everything entered after that backup was made is lost. Any signed-in user, not only an Admin, can use this button. Make a fresh backup before restoring, and restart the application afterwards.
>
> Settings reload each time you open this screen, so values changed on another computer appear when you open it again.

22a. Notifications Window

Overview

Window title	Notifications
Purpose	Shows messages sent by your supplier: news, offers and notices, sometimes with a poster or video.
Who uses it	Everyone.

How to open it

Click the **bell** at the top-right of the main window, to the left of the date. The bell only appears once at least one message has arrived.

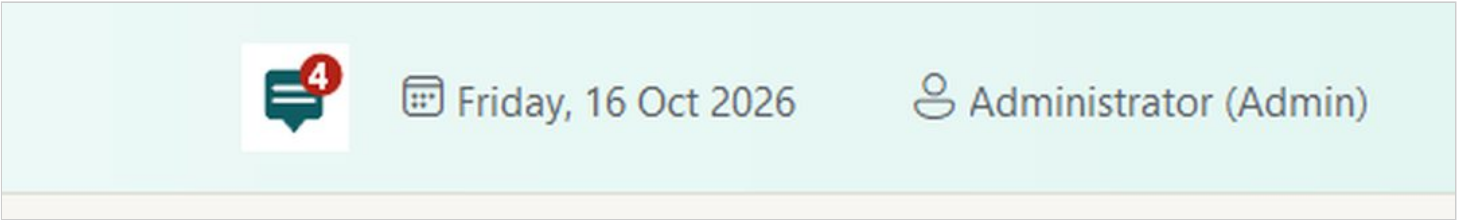


Figure 117: The bell showing four unread messages

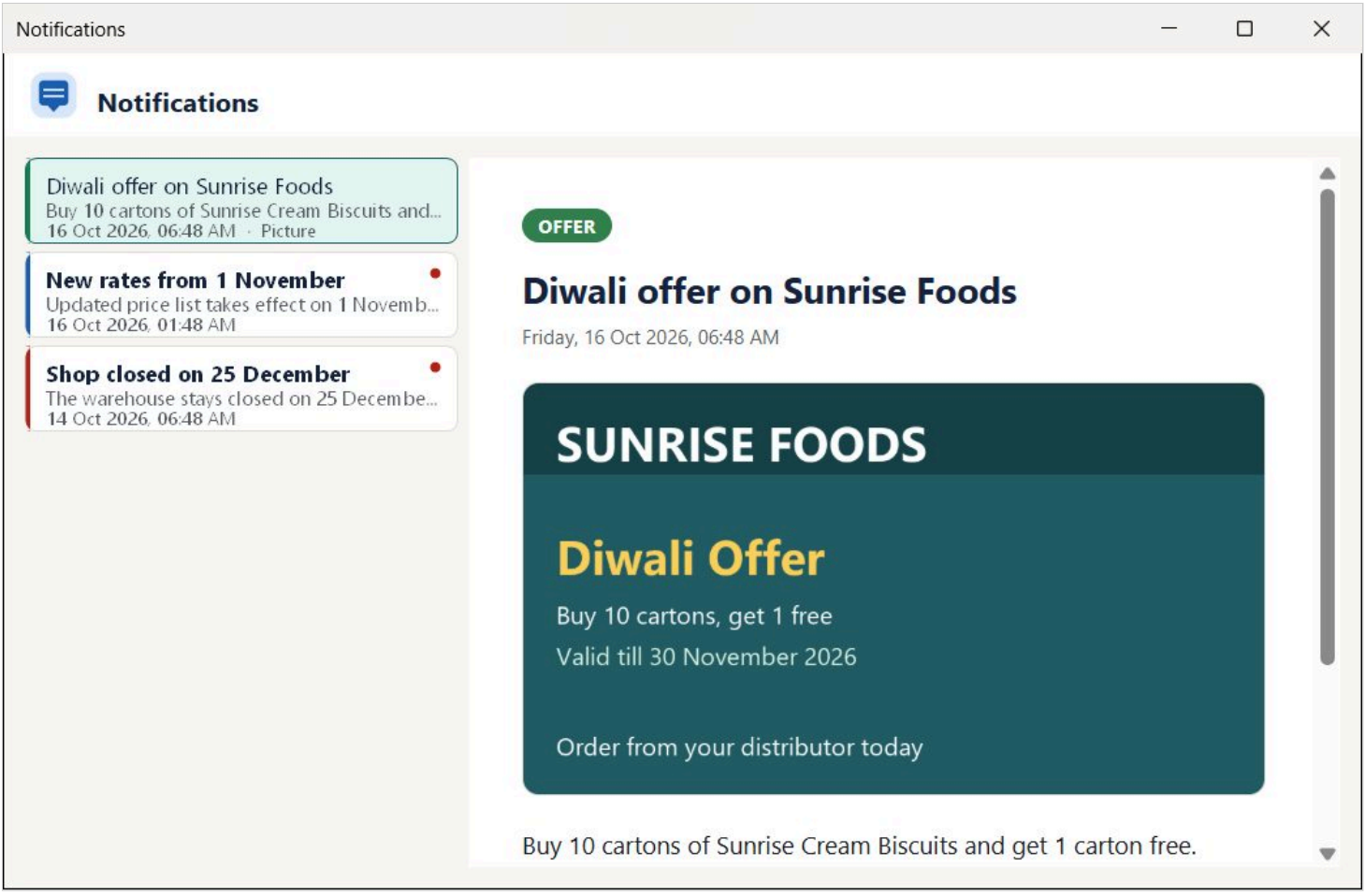


Figure 118: A message with a poster

Controls

Control	Purpose and effect
Bell (top bar)	Opens this window. The red number is how many messages you have not read.
Message list (left)	Every current message, newest first. A **red dot** means unread. The coloured stripe shows the kind.
Message panel (right)	The selected message: kind badge, title, date, poster or video, text, and any link button.
Mark all as read	Clears every red dot at once.
Link button, for example **See the offer**	Opens the address in your normal web browser, not inside this window.
X (close)	Closes the window.

Kinds of message

Stripe and badge	Kind	Meaning
Blue — **INFO**	Information	General news, for example a new price list.
Green — **OFFER**	Offer	Marketing or a promotion.
Red — **ALERT**	Alert	Something that needs your attention, for example a closure.

Video messages

A message can carry a video with normal play, pause, volume and full-screen controls.

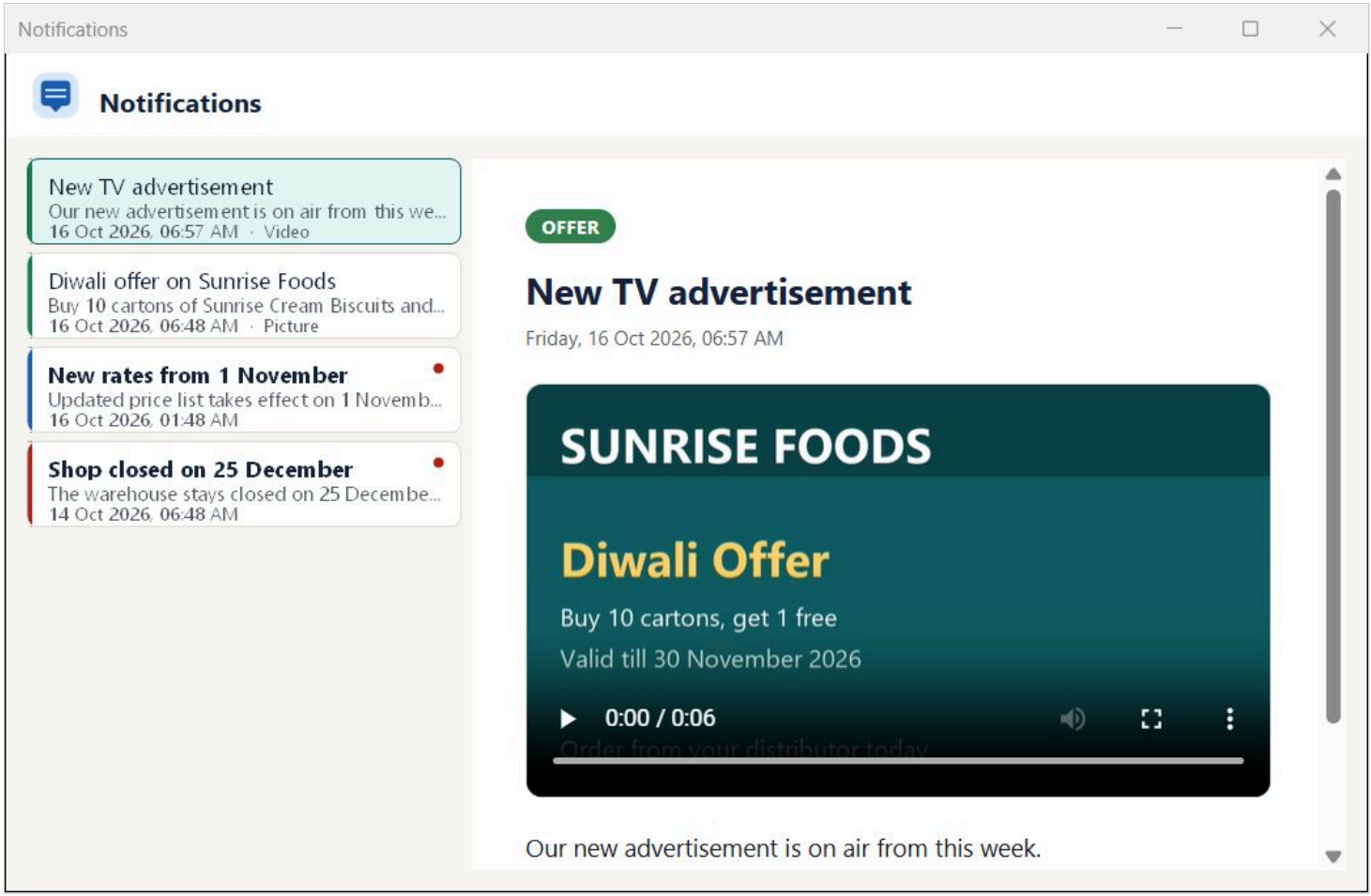


Figure 119: A message with a video

Effects of actions

Action	Effect
Open a message	It is marked as read on **this computer** and its red dot disappears. The bell number drops by one.
Mark all as read	Every message is marked read. The bell loses its number but stays visible.
Close the window	Nothing is sent anywhere. Read state stays on this PC.

Notes - Messages are read only. There is no way to reply; phone your supplier instead. - Read and unread is remembered per computer, so another PC in the same shop keeps its own. - Your supplier can remove a message or let it expire, after which it disappears from the list. - The application looks for new messages when it starts and about once an hour after that. - With no internet nothing new arrives, but everything already received stays readable.

If a picture or video does not appear and you see buttons such as **Open picture** or **Play video** instead, the **Microsoft Edge WebView2 Runtime** is missing on that PC. The text is still shown, and those buttons open the media in your usual programs. Ask your supplier or IT person to install the runtime.

22b. Software Update Window

Overview

Window title	Software Update
Purpose	Offers a newer version, downloads it, and installs it when you restart.
Who uses it	Everyone.

How it opens

- **By itself** a few seconds after you sign in, and about once an hour, when a newer version is available.
- **By hand** from **Settings** → **Software Update** → **Check for Updates**.

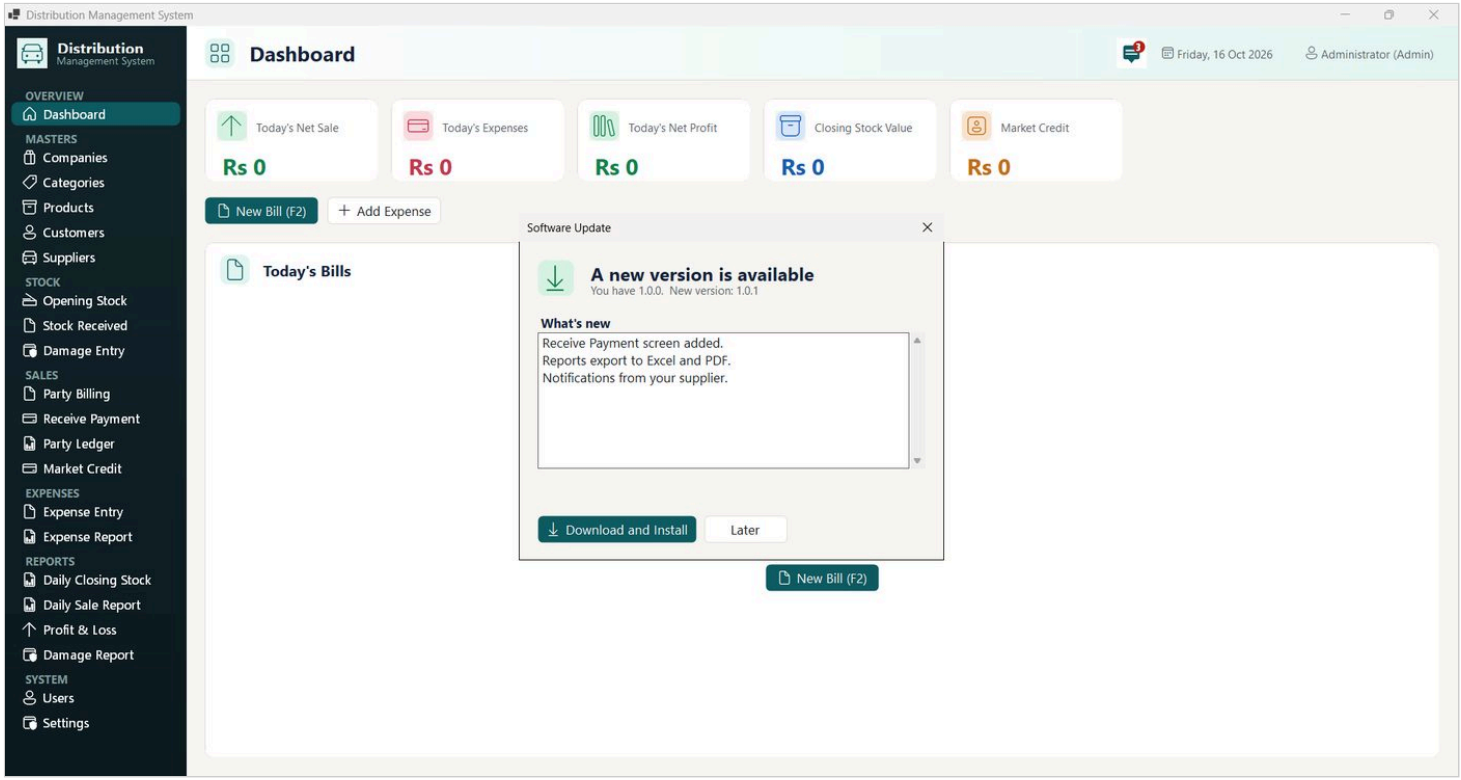


Figure 120: An update being offered

Controls

Control	Purpose and effect
Version line	The version you have now and the one available.
What's new	What your supplier changed in the new version.
Download and Install	Downloads the update, showing the progress. You can keep working while it downloads.
Later	Closes the window without downloading. You are offered it again at the next check.
Restart Now (after the download)	Asks for confirmation, then closes the application, installs, and opens the new version.
Restart Later	Keeps the downloaded update. It installs the next time you choose to restart.

What happens when you install

1. A question appears: "*The application will close and open again in the new version. Anything you have typed but not saved will be lost. Continue?*"
2. On **Yes**, the application closes, the update is applied, and the new version opens.
3. Sign in as usual.

> **Warning:** save or finish what you are typing before you restart. A half-entered bill is lost.

Your data is not affected. The database, the shop's settings and all your records stay exactly as they were. Only the program files change.

Checking by hand

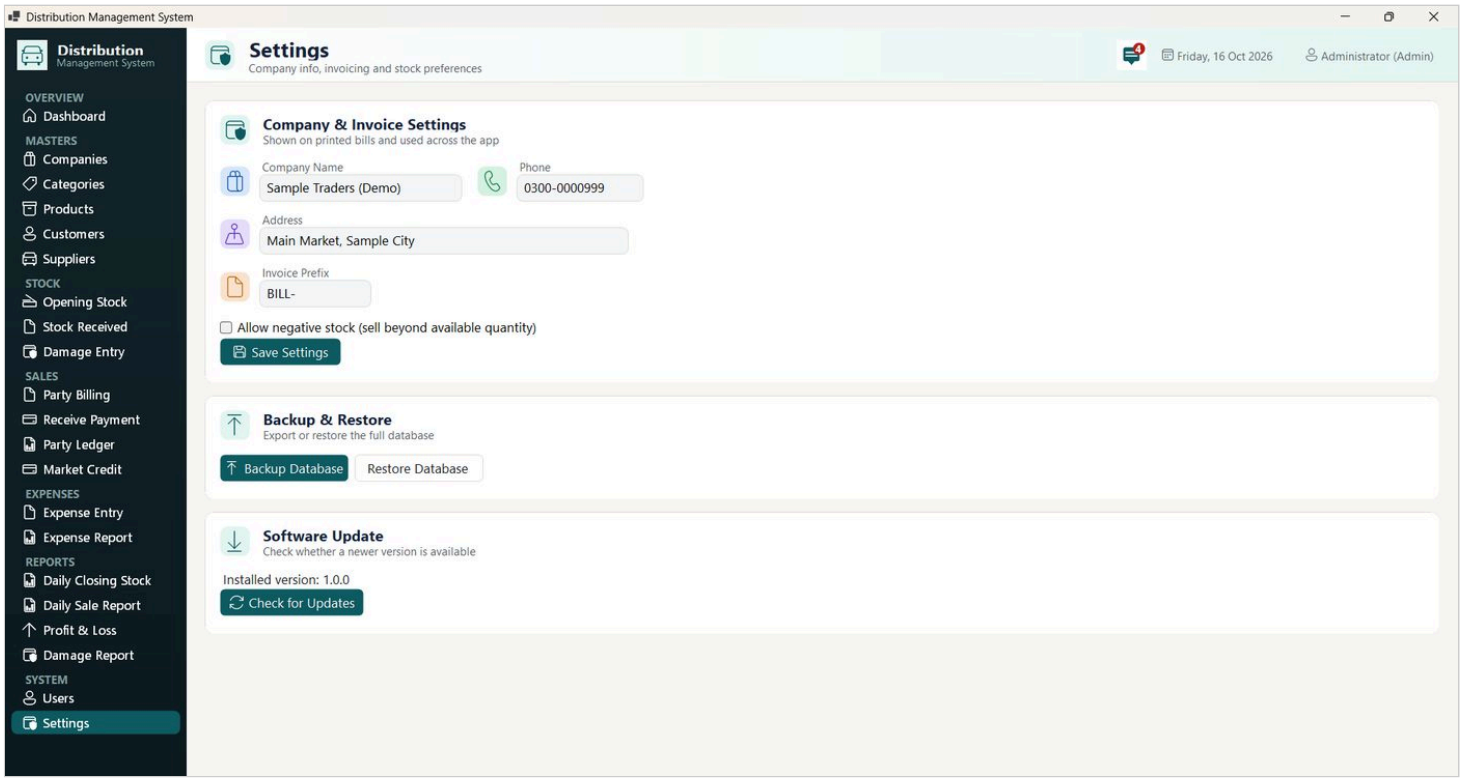
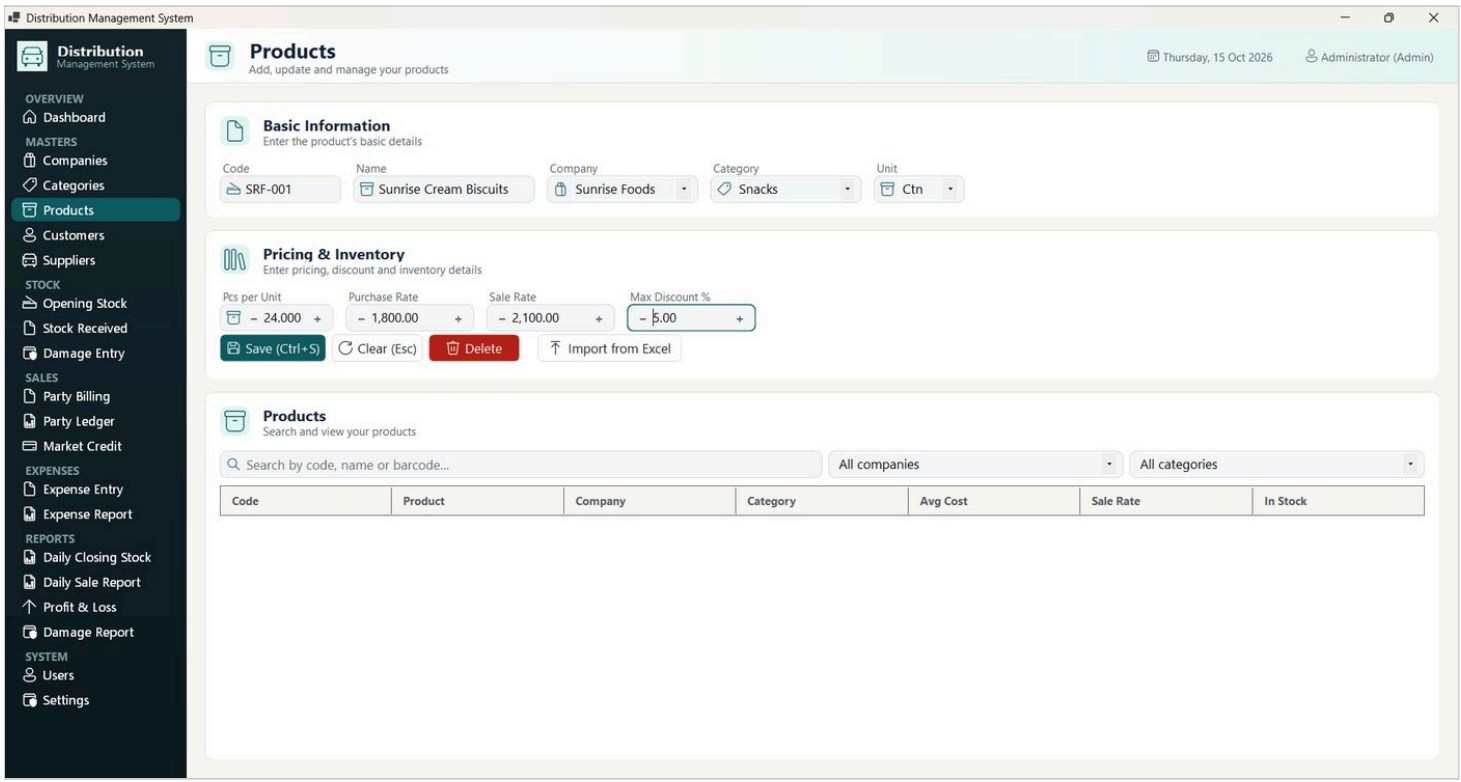


Figure 121: The Software Update card in Settings

Message	Meaning
"You already have the latest version (…)."	Nothing to do.
The update window opens	A newer version is ready to install.
"This copy was not installed by the setup program, so it cannot update itself."	The application is running from a copied folder. Ask your supplier for the installer.
"Updates are switched off for this computer."	Your supplier fixed this PC to one version on purpose.
"No update source is set up for this computer."	Not configured. Ask your supplier.
"The update check did not work: …"	Usually no internet. Try again later.

23. Common Controls Used on Many Screens

Number boxes (with − and +)



See the Pcs per Unit, Purchase Rate, Sale Rate and Max Discount % boxes in Figure 23.

Action	Result
Click inside and type a number	The number is accepted when you press **Enter**, press **Tab**, or click elsewhere.
Click **−** or **+**	Lowers or raises the value by 1.
Type a value above the maximum or below 0	It is changed to the nearest allowed value (for example, 150 in a percent box becomes 100).
Type letters or other invalid text	The box returns to its previous value.

Drop-down lists

Click the list (or the small arrow) and choose an item. In lists that show `CODE - Name`, you can type the first characters of the code to jump to it. These lists cannot be typed into freely.

Date boxes

Click the small calendar arrow to open a calendar, or click the day, month or year part and use the **Up**/**Down** arrow keys. The date format follows your Windows settings (for example 10/15/2026).

Lists (tables)

- Lists are read-only. You cannot type into them.

- On master screens (Companies, Categories, Products, Customers, Suppliers, Users), **clicking a row loads it into the form** for editing.
- Clicking a column heading sorts the list. **Avoid this on master screens.** See the warning in Companies.
- Amounts and quantities are displayed as whole numbers with thousands separators (for example 1,764). Values such as 2.5 are stored exactly but shown rounded.

Export and print buttons

Report screens (Daily Closing Stock, Daily Sale Report, Profit & Loss, Damage Report, Expense Report, Party Ledger and Market Credit) share three buttons:

Button	Effect
Export Excel	Saves an .xlsx file of what is on screen. Numbers are saved as numbers so Excel can total them.
Export PDF	Saves a PDF with your business heading, the chosen dates and filters, and page numbers.
Print	Opens a print preview; print from there.

After a successful export the application asks **"Open it now?"**. Messages you may see: **"There is nothing to export for the selected options."** (nothing to save), **"Click View Ledger first."** (Party Ledger only), or **"The file could not be saved..."** if the file is open in another program.

Pop-up messages ("toasts")

Short messages appear for about two seconds at the bottom-right of the window:

- **Green**: the action succeeded (for example "Company saved.").
- **Red**: the action was refused. The message explains why (for example "Name is required.").

If you miss a message, repeat the action or check the list to see whether the record was saved.

Confirmation windows

Delete and Restore actions ask for confirmation with **Yes** and **No**. **No** cancels without any change.

Small input windows (prompts)

Used for **New Area**, **New Damage Reason**, **New Expense Category**, **Set Password** and **Reset Password**. Type the value and click **OK** (or press **Enter**). Click **Cancel** (or press **Esc**) to close without saving. A blank entry is ignored.

Workflow Guides

Distribution Management System — step-by-step procedures

Each guide takes one complete business task from start to finish. Screen and button names match the application exactly. Figure numbers refer to the screenshots in `assets/screenshots/` and are explained in SCREEN_REFERENCE.md.

> **Example data.** All names, numbers and amounts in these guides are made up for illustration. Replace them with your own.
>
> **Two habits that prevent most problems** 1. **Watch the bottom-right corner after every click on Save.** A green message means it worked. A red message tells you what to fix. Messages disappear after about two seconds. 2. **Screens reload when you open them.** A customer, product or supplier you add on one screen is available on the others straight away. Only report results need a click on **View Report**, **View Ledger** or **Apply Filter**.

Contents

#	Workflow	Typical user
W1	First-time setup of the application	Administrator
W2	Sign in and close the application	Everyone
W3	Add a company	Admin / Operator
W4	Add a category	Admin / Operator
W5	Add a product	Admin / Operator
W6	Import products from Excel	Admin
W7	Add a customer (including a new area)	Admin / Operator
W8	Add a supplier	Admin / Operator
W9	Edit an existing master record	Admin / Operator
W10	Delete a master record	Admin
W11	Record opening stock	Administrator
W12	Receive stock from a supplier	Store keeper / Operator
W13	Record damaged or lost stock	Store keeper / Operator
W14	Create a sale bill	Salesperson / Operator
W15	Record a payment against a customer's balance	Operator / Recovery staff
W16	Check a customer's account	Operator / Owner
W17	See who owes money	Owner / Recovery staff
W18	Record an expense	Operator

#	Workflow	Typical user
W19	Review expenses	Owner
W20	End-of-day closing	Owner / Operator
W21	Calculate profit for a period	Owner
W22	Analyse damage	Owner
W23	Create a staff login	Administrator
W24	Reset a forgotten password	Administrator
W25	Deactivate or reactivate a staff login	Administrator
W26	Update company settings	Administrator
W27	Back up the database	Administrator
W28	Restore the database from a backup	Administrator
W29	Export or print a report	Owner / Operator
W30	Read a notification from your supplier	Everyone
W31	Install a software update	Everyone

W1. First-time setup of the application

Purpose: Prepare a new installation so that daily work can start.

Prerequisites: - The application has been installed and connected to its database by your system administrator. - You have the initial administrator sign-in details (see USER_MANUAL.md, Section 4).

Order matters. Some records depend on others:

```
Companies ─┬─> Products ──> Opening Stock ──> Stock Received / Party Billing / Damage Entry
Categories ┘
Companies ──> Suppliers ──> Stock Received
Areas ──────> Customers ──> Party Billing
```

Steps:

1. Sign in as the administrator (W2).
2. **Change the administrator password immediately** (W24; select the user **admin**).
3. Create a separate login for each staff member (W23).
4. Enter your business details in **Settings** (W26).
5. Add all **Companies** (W3).
6. Add all **Categories** (W4).
7. Add all **Products** one by one (W5) or from Excel (W6).
8. Add **Customers** with their opening balances (W7).
9. Add **Suppliers** (W8).
10. Record **Opening Stock** for every product you hold (W11).
11. Make a first **backup** (W27).

Expected result: All master lists are complete, Products shows correct **In Stock** quantities, and Customers shows correct balances.

W2. Sign in and close the application

Purpose: Start and finish a work session.

Steps — sign in:

1. Start the application. The **Sign in — Distribution Management System** window appears (Figure 1).
2. Click in **Username** and type your username (upper and lower case matter).
3. Press **Tab** or click in **Password**, and type your password. To check what you typed, click the eye icon.
4. Press **Enter** or click **Login (Enter)**.
5. The main window opens on the **Dashboard**. Your name and role appear at the top-right (Figure 3).

Steps — close or switch user:

1. Finish and save any work in progress. Unsaved forms are lost when the application closes.
2. Click the **X** at the top-right of the main window. The application closes.
3. To work as another user, start the application again and sign in with the other account.

Failure and recovery:

Problem	What to do
"Invalid username or password." (Figure 2)	Check Caps Lock and the spelling of the username. Use the eye icon to check the password. If it still fails, your account may be deactivated or the password may have been changed; ask an administrator.
An "Error" window appears before the Sign-in window, or the application closes immediately	The application cannot reach its database. Contact your system administrator. See TROUBLESHOOTING.md.

W3. Add a company

Purpose: Register a manufacturer or brand.

Prerequisites: None.

Steps:

1. In the side menu, under **MASTERS**, click **Companies**. The Companies screen opens (Figure 4).
2. Make sure the button reads **Save (Ctrl+S)**. If it reads **Update (Ctrl+S)**, click **Clear (Esc)** first. Otherwise you would be changing an existing company.
3. In **Short Code**, type a short unique code, for example `SRF`.
4. In **Name**, type the full name, for example `Sunrise Foods`.
5. Optionally type the **Contact Person** (for example `Bilal Ahmed`) and **Phone** (for example `0300-0000001`). See Figure 6.
6. Click **Save (Ctrl+S)**.

7. Check that the green message **"Company saved."** appears, the form empties and the company appears in the list (Figure 7).

Expected result: The company is listed on Companies and can be chosen straight away on Products and Suppliers.

Failure and recovery:

Message	Cause	Fix
"Code and Name are required." (Figure 5)	Short Code or Name is empty.	Fill both and click Save again.
Error window "An unexpected error occurred: 23505: duplicate key value violates unique constraint "IX_Companies_Code"..." (Figure 13)	That Short Code is already used, possibly by a deleted company.	Click **OK**, change the Short Code, and click Save again.

W4. Add a category

Steps:

1. Click **Categories** under **MASTERS** (Figure 16).
2. If the button reads **Update (Ctrl+S)**, click **Clear (Esc)**.
3. Type a **Name**, for example `Beverages`, and optionally a **Description**, for example `Soft drinks, juices and water` (Figure 18).
4. Click **Save (Ctrl+S)**.
5. Check for **"Category saved."** and the new row in the list (Figure 19).

Failure: "Name is required." (Figure 17): type a name and save again. The application does not stop duplicate category names, so check the list first.

W5. Add a product

Purpose: Register an item that you buy and sell.

Prerequisites: The product's company and category exist.

Steps:

1. Click **Products** under **MASTERS** (Figure 21).
2. If the button reads **Update (Ctrl+S)**, click **Clear (Esc)**.
3. **Basic Information** card:
4. **Code**: type a unique code, for example `SRF-001`.
5. **Name**: for example `Sunrise Cream Biscuits`.
6. **Company**: open the list and choose `Sunrise Foods`.
7. **Category**: choose `Snacks`.
8. **Unit**: choose `Ctn`.
9. **Pricing & Inventory** card (click in a box, type the number, then press **Tab**):
10. **Pcs per Unit**: `24`.

11. **Purchase Rate**: `1800`.
12. **Sale Rate**: `2100`.
13. **Max Discount %**: `5`.
14. Check the form (Figure 23), then click **Save (Ctrl+S)**.
15. Check for **"Product saved."** and the product in the list. **In Stock** shows 0 and **Avg Cost** equals the Purchase Rate (Figure 24).

Expected result: The product can be used straight away on Opening Stock, Stock Received, Damage Entry and Party Billing — just open the screen.

Common mistakes: - Leaving **Sale Rate** at 0: on Party Billing the Rate would be 0 and the line would be refused ("Qty and Rate must be greater than zero."). - Leaving **Max Discount %** at 0: Operators then cannot give any discount on this product. - **Pcs per Unit** shows 0.00 the first time the screen opens. Enter the real value.

Failure: "Code, Name, Company, Category and Unit are required." (Figure 22). A duplicate code shows a technical error window like Figure 13: click **OK** and change the code.

W6. Import products from Excel

Purpose: Create or update many products at once.

Prerequisites: All companies and categories named in the file exist.

Steps:

1. Prepare an Excel (.xlsx) file. In row 1 type these headings: `Code`, `Name`, `Company`, `Category`, `Unit`, `PcsPerUnit`, `PurchaseRate`, `SaleRate`, and optionally `MaxDiscountPct` and `Barcode`. Example:

Code	Name	Company	Category	Unit	PcsPerUnit	PurchaseRate	SaleRate	MaxDiscountPct	Barcode
DHC-002	Delta Dishwash Bar	Delta Home Care	Household	Box	24	480	576	5	8900000000017
SRF-002	Sunrise Salted Chips	Sunrise Foods	Snacks	Box	12	900	1100	3	

2. Save and **close** the file in Excel.
3. Open **Products** and click **Import from Excel**.
4. In the **Import Products** window, go to the folder, select the file and click **Open** (Figure 29).
5. Read the result: - Green message, for example "Imported: 2, Updated: 0, Errors: 0": all rows were accepted. - A window titled "Imported: 1, Updated: 1, Errors: 2" (Figure 30) lists each rejected row. Note the row numbers and click **OK**.
6. Check the Products list (Figure 31).
7. Correct the rejected rows in Excel and import the file again. Rows already imported will simply be **updated**, not duplicated.

What happens to existing products: a row whose **Code** matches an existing product replaces that product's name, company, category, unit, pcs per unit, rates, max discount and barcode. A missing `MaxDiscountPct` column sets 0, and a

missing or blank `Barcode` removes the barcode.

Failure and recovery: see the import message table in SCREEN_REFERENCE.md.

W7. Add a customer (including a new area)

Purpose: Register a shop or party you sell to.

Steps:

1. Click **Customers** under **MASTERS** (Figure 34).
2. If the button reads **Update (Ctrl+S)**, click **Clear (Esc)**.
3. If the customer's area is not in the **Area / Route** list:
4. Click the **+** button next to **Area / Route**.
5. In the **New Area** window, type the name, for example `Main Bazaar Route` (Figure 35).
6. Click **OK**. The message **"Area added."** appears (Figure 36).
7. Fill in the form (Figure 38): - **Code**: `C-001` - **Shop Name**: `Al-Madina General Store` - **Owner**: `Kamran Shah` (optional) - **Phone**: `0300-0000101` (optional) - **Area / Route**: choose `Main Bazaar Route` - **Address**: `Shop 12, Main Bazaar` (optional) - **Opening Balance**: `5000`, the amount the customer already owed you. Leave 0 for a new customer. - **Default Discount %**: optional, for your reference only.
8. Click **Save (Ctrl+S)**.
9. Check for **"Customer saved."** (Figure 39). The list shows the customer with **Balance** equal to the opening balance (Figure 40).

Expected result: The customer can be selected straight away on Party Billing, Receive Payment and Party Ledger.

Failure: "Code, Shop Name and Area are required." (Figure 37). A duplicate code shows a technical error window: click **OK** and change the code.

W8. Add a supplier

Steps:

1. Click **Suppliers** under **MASTERS** (Figure 43).
2. If the button reads **Update (Ctrl+S)**, click **Clear (Esc)**.
3. Fill in **Code** (`S-001`), **Name** (`Sunrise Distribution Co.`), **Company** (choose `Sunrise Foods`), and optionally **Contact Person**, **Phone**, **Address** and **Opening Balance** (amount you owed the supplier) (Figure 45).
4. Click **Save (Ctrl+S)** and check for **"Supplier saved."** (Figure 46).

Note: Payable Balance in the list only ever shows the opening balance. Purchases do not change it. New suppliers appear on Stock Received as soon as you open that screen.

Failure: "Code, Name and Company are required." (Figure 44).

W9. Edit an existing master record

Applies to Companies, Categories, Products, Customers and Suppliers.

Steps:

1. Open the screen.
2. Find the record. Type part of its name or code in the search box to shorten the list.
3. Click the record's row. Its details load into the form and the button changes to **Update (Ctrl+S)** (Figures 9, 20, 26, 41, 48).
4. **Check that the form shows the record you clicked** (code and name). If you sorted the list by clicking a column heading, a different record may load (Figure 108). In that case click **Clear (Esc)**, type a letter in the search box and delete it to reset the order, then click the row again.
5. Change the fields you need.
6. Click **Update (Ctrl+S)**.
7. Check for the "... updated." message (for example "Company updated.", Figure 10) and the changed values in the list.

Alternative: to abandon your changes, click **Clear (Esc)**. Nothing is saved.

Effects to remember: - Changing a product's **Sale Rate** affects future bills only. - Changing a customer's **Opening Balance** changes their balance everywhere (ledger, market credit, previous balance on bills). - Changing **Purchase Rate** does not change a product's **Avg Cost**.

W10. Delete a master record

> **Deletion cannot be undone from the application.** Deleted records disappear from lists, and their codes cannot be reused.

Steps:

1. Open the screen and click the record's row. Confirm that the form shows the correct record.
2. Click **Delete**.
3. The **Confirm delete** window asks, for example, "Delete this company?" (Figure 11).
4. Click **Yes** to delete, or **No** to cancel.
5. Check for the "... deleted." message (Figure 12) and that the row is gone.

When deletion is refused:

Screen	Refused when	Message
Companies	The company still has products, or suppliers	"This company has active products linked to it and cannot be deleted. Deactivate or reassign those products first." (Figure 33) / "This company has active suppliers linked to it and cannot be deleted. Deactivate or reassign those suppliers first."
Categories	The category still has products	"This category has active products linked to it and cannot be deleted. Deactivate or reassign those products first." (Figure 32)

To delete such a company or category, first change or delete the linked products or suppliers. (There is no "Deactivate" button in this version, despite the wording of the message.)

Not checked by the application (be careful): - Products can be deleted while they still have stock. The stock then disappears from Daily Closing Stock. - Customers can be deleted while they still owe money. The balance then disappears from Market Credit.

W11. Record opening stock

Purpose: Enter the goods you already hold when you start using the application.

Prerequisites: Products exist. Ideally count physical stock first.

Steps:

1. Click **Opening Stock** under **STOCK** (Figure 49).
2. **As On Date**: set the date of your stock count. Choose a date **before** your first real transaction so that reports show it as opening stock.
3. **Product**: choose the first product, for example `SRF-001 - Sunrise Cream Biscuits`.
4. **Qty**: type the counted quantity, for example `50`.
5. **Cost Rate**: type the cost per unit, for example `1750` (Figure 51).
6. Click **Save (Ctrl+S)**.
7. Check for **"Opening stock saved."** and the new row in **Recent Opening Stock Entries** (Figure 52).
8. Qty and Cost Rate are cleared. Date and product stay. Choose the next product and repeat steps 4–7.
9. When finished, review the list (Figure 53).

Verify: Open **Products**. **In Stock** and **Avg Cost** show the new values (Figure 55).

> **Warning:** Each save **adds** stock. Saving the same product twice doubles its opening stock, and entries cannot be deleted. If that happens, see TROUBLESHOOTING.md.

Failure: "Quantity must be greater than zero." (Figure 50); "Select a product." (no product chosen).

W12. Receive stock from a supplier

Purpose: Record a delivery, add it to stock and record freight.

Prerequisites: The supplier and all products on the invoice exist.

Steps:

1. Click **Stock Received** under **STOCK** (Figure 56).
2. Fill the header:
3. **Supplier**: choose `S-001 - Sunrise Distribution Co.`
4. **Invoice No**: type the supplier's invoice number, `INV-SF-1001`.
5. **Date**: leave as today, or set the delivery date.
6. **Vehicle No**: optional, for example `ABC-123`.
7. **Bilti Charges**: freight paid, for example `1500` (leave 0 if none).

8. Add the first item:
9. **Product**: `SRF-001 - Sunrise Cream Biscuits`.
10. **Qty**: `20`.
11. **Rate**: `1800`.
12. Click **Add Line**. The line appears in the list and **Total** updates. Qty and Rate are cleared.
13. Repeat step 3 for every item on the invoice (Figure 59), for example `SRF-002`, Qty `30`, Rate `900`.
14. Compare the lines and **Total: Rs 63,000** with the paper invoice (Figure 60).
15. Click **Save Purchase (Ctrl+S)**.
16. Check for **"Purchase saved and stock updated."** The purchase appears under **Today's Purchases** (Figure 61).

Expected result: - Stock of each product increases (Products → In Stock; Daily Closing Stock → Received). - Average cost is recalculated (Products → Avg Cost). - The bilti of Rs 1,500 is recorded automatically as expense **BILTI-1**, category **Bilti / Freight** (Expense Entry → Today's Expenses, Figure 84).

Alternative paths: - **Wrong line before saving:** click **Clear (Esc)**. This clears all lines, the invoice number, vehicle and bilti. Re-enter them. - **Several deliveries:** after saving, the form is ready for the next invoice. Supplier and Date stay selected.

Failure and recovery:

Message	Fix
"Select a product."	Choose a product before **Add Line**.
"Qty and Rate must be greater than zero." (Figure 57)	Enter both before **Add Line**.
"Supplier and Invoice No are required." (Figure 58)	Type the invoice number.
"Add at least one item line."	Add at least one line before saving.
Saved the same invoice twice	The application does not detect duplicate invoice numbers, and purchases cannot be deleted. Record the extra quantity as damage with a clear remark (see TROUBLESHOOTING.md), and inform your administrator.

W13. Record damaged or lost stock

Steps:

1. Click **Damage Entry** under **STOCK** (Figure 63).
2. If the **Reason** list is empty or lacks the reason you need, click **+** next to **Reason**, type it (for example `Broken in transit`), and click **OK** (Figure 64). Check for "Reason added."
3. Fill in the form (Figure 66): - **Date**: when the damage was found. - **Product**: `SRF-001 - Sunrise Cream Biscuits`. - **Qty**: `2`. - **Reason**: `Broken in transit`. - **Found At**: `In Transit` (or `Godown`, or `Returned by Party`). - **Remarks**: optional, for example `Two cartons crushed during unloading`.
4. Click **Save (Ctrl+S)**.
5. Check for **"Damage entry saved."** (Figure 67) and the new row in **Damage Register** with its Ref No and **Loss Amount** (Figure 68).

Expected result: Stock decreases by the quantity. The loss (Qty × average cost) appears in the Damage Report and in Profit & Loss as **Damage Loss**.

Failure: "Insufficient stock for '...'. Available: ..., requested: ...." (Figure 65): you cannot record more damage than the stock held. Check the quantity. "Product, Reason and Found At are required." / "Quantity must be greater than zero.": complete the form.

W14. Create a sale bill

Purpose: Sell goods to a customer, collect cash if any, and update stock and the customer's account.

Prerequisites: The customer exists and the products have stock.

Steps:

1. Click **Party Billing** under **SALES**, or click **New Bill (F2)** on the Dashboard (Figure 69).
2. **Customer**: choose `C-001 - Al-Madina General Store`. Read **Previous Balance** (for example Rs 5,000) and tell the customer if necessary.
3. **Date**: leave as today unless you are entering an older bill.
4. Add the first item:
5. **Product**: `SRF-001 - Sunrise Cream Biscuits`. **Rate** fills in automatically with the sale rate, `2,100.00` (Figure 71).
6. **Qty**: `5`.
7. **Rate**: change it only if you agreed a different price.
8. **Discount %**: `2` (optional).
9. Click **Add Line**. The line shows **Net Amount** 10,290.
10. Repeat step 4 for each product, for example `CRB-001`, Qty `4`, Discount `0`.
11. **Bill Discount**: optional extra discount in rupees, for example `100`.
12. **Cash Received**: the money the customer pays now, for example `10000`. **Whatever you do not enter here is added to the customer's balance as credit**, so if the customer is paying in full, type the full Net Bill. Leave 0 only for a fully credit sale. - **Received In**: choose **Cash** or **Bank** for that money.
13. Check the line **Net Bill: Rs 15,950 | New Balance: Rs 10,950** (Figure 72).
14. Click **Save Bill (Ctrl+S)**.
15. Check the green message. It gives the bill number and how much went on credit, for example **"Bill BILL-00004 saved. Rs 5,950 on credit — new balance Rs 16,900."** A fully paid bill shows **"... saved. Fully paid."** (Figure 73). Note the bill number.
16. The lines clear and **Previous Balance** now shows the customer's new balance. Scroll down to see the bill under **Today's Bills** (Figure 75).

Expected result:

What changed	Where to check
Stock decreased	Products → In Stock, Daily Closing Stock → Sold
Customer balance increased by the net bill and decreased by the cash	Customers, Party Ledger, Market Credit
Sale recorded	Daily Sale Report, Profit & Loss
Cash recorded as a receipt (RCPT-...)	Party Ledger

Alternative paths: - **Cash sale:** enter the full Net Bill as **Cash Received**. The New Balance stays equal to the Previous Balance. - **Customer pays more than the bill:** enter the full amount. The extra reduces the old balance. - **Customer pays after delivery:** save the bill with the cash you actually received, then record the rest later on **Receive Payment** (W15). - **Wrong line added:** click **Clear (Esc)** and add the lines again. (Clear keeps the customer and date.)

Failure and recovery:

Message	Cause	Fix
"Select a customer."	No customer chosen	Choose a customer.
"Select a product." / "Qty and Rate must be greater than zero."	Line incomplete	Choose a product and enter Qty and Rate above 0.
"Add at least one item." (Figure 70)	No lines	Add lines before saving.
"Insufficient stock for '...'. Available: ..., requested: ...." (Figure 74)	Not enough stock	The bill is not saved and the lines remain. Click **Clear (Esc)**, re-add the lines with a smaller quantity, and save. Check whether a purchase still needs to be entered.
"Discount ...% exceeds max allowed ...% for ...." (Figure 106)	Operator or Viewer gave more than the product's Max Discount %	Reduce the discount (Clear and re-add), or ask an Admin to create the bill.
Customer is missing from the list	The customer was not saved, or you are looking at the wrong code	Check the Customers screen, then open Party Billing again — it reloads its list each time.

> **Before you hand goods over:** a saved bill cannot be edited or cancelled, and individual bills cannot be printed. Check every line before clicking **Save Bill**.

W15. Record a payment against a customer's balance

Purpose: Record money a customer pays towards what they already owe, without creating a bill.

Prerequisites: The customer exists and has an outstanding balance.

Steps:

1. Click **Receive Payment** under **SALES** (Figure 109).
2. **Customer**: choose the customer, for example `C-002 - City Mart`. Read **Current Balance** and tell the customer what is outstanding.
3. **Date**: leave as today, or set the date the money was received.
4. **Amount Received**: type the amount, for example `5000`.
5. **Received In**: choose **Cash** or **Bank**.
6. **Remarks**: optional, for example `Recovery against old balance` (Figure 111).
7. Click **Save Receipt (Ctrl+S)**.
8. Check the green message, which gives the receipt number and the new balance, for example **"Receipt RCPT-00003 saved. New balance: Rs 7,840"** (Figure 112).

9. The payment appears at the top of **Recent Receipts** with **Against Bill** showing **—**, meaning it was not tied to a bill (Figure 113).

Expected result:

What changed	Where to check
The customer's balance went down by the amount	**Current Balance** on this screen; Customers → **Balance**
A receipt was recorded	Recent Receipts; Party Ledger as a **Receipt** in the **Credit** column
Market Credit shows less outstanding and a new Last Payment date	Market Credit

Alternative paths:

- **Customer pays while buying:** enter the money in **Cash Received** on the bill instead (W14). Do not record it twice.
- **Customer pays more than they owe:** the balance becomes negative, which means you hold an advance for them.

Failure and recovery:

Message	Cause	Fix
"Select a customer."	No customer chosen	Choose a customer from the list.
"Amount must be greater than zero." (Figure 110)	Amount is 0	Type the amount received.
Wrong amount or customer saved	Receipts cannot be edited or deleted	Inform your administrator. Do not try to "fix" it with a second receipt without recording why.

> **Check before saving.** A saved receipt cannot be changed or removed.

W16. Check a customer's account

Steps:

1. Click **Party Ledger** under **SALES** (Figure 76).
2. **Customer**: choose the customer.
3. **From** and **To**: set the period (default: the last month).
4. Click **View Ledger**.
5. Read the result (Figure 77): - The first row (**Opening**) is what the customer owed before the From date. - **Sale** rows (Debit) are bills, **Receipt** rows (Credit) are cash received. - The last **Running Balance** is what the customer owed on the To date.

Verify: for an up-to-today period, the last running balance equals the customer's **Balance** on the Customers screen.

To give the customer a statement: click **Export PDF** or **Print** (W29). You must click **View Ledger** first, otherwise the message "Click View Ledger first." appears.

W17. See who owes money

Steps:

1. Click **Market Credit** under **SALES**. The figures are recalculated each time you open the screen (click **Refresh** to recalculate without leaving it).
2. Read the total at the top and the list of customers with outstanding balances, largest first (Figure 78). **Last Payment** shows when money was last received from each.
3. To take the list on the road, click **Export PDF** or **Print** (W29).
4. For details on one customer, use **Party Ledger** (W16). To record a recovery, use **Receive Payment** (W15).

If the list is empty: "No outstanding credit — All customers are settled." means no customer owes money.

W18. Record an expense

Steps:

1. Click **Expense Entry** under **EXPENSES**, or **Add Expense** on the Dashboard (Figure 79).
2. **Date**: the date the money was spent.
3. **Category**: choose one. If it is missing, click **+**, type the name (for example `Fuel`) and click **OK** (Figure 81).
4. **Amount**: for example `2500`.
5. **Paid From**: `Cash` or `Bank`.
6. **Description**: optional, for example `Delivery van fuel` (Figure 82).
7. Click **Save (Ctrl+S)**.
8. Check for **"Expense saved."** and the new voucher (EXP-...) in **Today's Expenses** (Figures 83 and 84).

Notes: - Freight entered as **Bilti Charges** on Stock Received is already recorded as an expense. Do not enter it again. - Expenses cannot be edited or deleted. Check the amount before saving.

Failure: "Category and Amount are required." (Figure 80): choose a category and enter an amount above 0.

W19. Review expenses

Steps:

1. Click **Expense Report** under **EXPENSES** (Figure 85).
2. Read **Category-wise Summary (Month to Date)** for this month's totals by category.
3. To list individual expenses, set **From**, **To** and optionally **Category**, then click **Apply Filter**.
4. Read **Expense Details**. If you see "No expenses in this range", widen the dates or choose **All categories**.

> **Apply Filter** also refreshes the month-to-date summary. To save or print the report, use **Export Excel**, **Export PDF** or **Print** (W29).

W20. End-of-day closing

Purpose: Check the day's sales, stock and expenses before closing.

Steps:

1. **Daily Sale Report** (REPORTS): check the date is today and click **View Report**. Review the bill-wise totals: **Net** is the day's sales, **Cash** is cash collected on bills, **Credit** is the amount added to customer accounts (Figure 87). Scroll down for product-wise and company-wise sales (Figure 88). Click **Export PDF** or **Print** to keep a copy.
2. **Expense Entry** → **Today's Expenses**: confirm all of today's expenses are entered.
3. **Daily Closing Stock** (REPORTS): click **View Report**. Compare **Closing** quantities with a physical count of key items (Figure 86). Investigate differences and record damage if needed (W13).
4. **Profit & Loss** (REPORTS): From and To = today, click **View Report** for the day's profit (Figure 89).
5. **Receive Payment**: check that all recoveries collected during the day are entered (W15).
6. **Market Credit**: review outstanding balances (Figure 78).
7. Make a **backup** (W27).

Expected result: cash in hand ≈ opening cash + **Cash** on the Daily Sale Report + cash receipts recorded on Receive Payment − cash expenses for the day. Any difference should be investigated.

W21. Calculate profit for a period

Steps:

1. Click **Profit & Loss** under **REPORTS**.
2. Set **From** (for example the 1st of the month) and **To** (for example today).
3. Leave **With Expenses** ticked for net profit after business expenses. Tick **Include Self Expense** to also subtract personal expenses.
4. Click **View Report** (required after any change).
5. Read **Gross Profit**, **Profit Before Expense** and **Net Profit** (Figure 89).
6. To keep a copy, click **Export Excel**, **Export PDF** or **Print** (W29).

Understanding the example (Figure 89): Net Sale 35,390 − COGS 29,477 = Gross Profit 5,913. Minus Damage Loss 5,312 = Profit Before Expense 601. Minus Business Expenses 19,000 = Net Profit **−18,399** (a loss for the day, mostly because of the salary payment).

W22. Analyse damage

Steps:

1. Click **Damage Report** under **REPORTS**.
2. Set **From**, **To** and **Group By** (**Product**, **Company**, **Reason** or **Month**).
3. Click **View Report**.
4. Review **Qty**, **Loss Amount** and **Main Reason** (Figure 90). The largest losses are listed first.
5. To keep a copy, use **Export Excel**, **Export PDF** or **Print** (W29).

W23. Create a staff login

Prerequisites: You are signed in as an **Admin**.

Steps:

1. Click **Users** under **SYSTEM** (Figure 92).
2. If the button reads **Update (Ctrl+S)**, click **Clear (Esc)**.
3. **Username**: for example `operator1`. **Full Name**: for example `Sample Operator`.
4. **Role**: choose carefully. **The default is Admin.** For normal staff choose **Operator** (Figure 94).
5. Click **Save (Ctrl+S)**.
6. The **Set Password** window opens (Figure 95). Type an initial password and click **OK**. - The password is visible while you type, so make sure nobody is watching. - There are no password rules. Choose at least 8 characters with letters and numbers.
7. Check for **"User created."** and the new row with Status **Active** (Figure 96).
8. Tell the user their username and password privately.

Failure: "Username and Full Name are required." (Figure 93); "Username already exists." (Figure 97): choose a different username. Clicking **Cancel** in the Set Password window, or leaving it blank, creates no user.

W24. Reset a forgotten password

Also use this to change the built-in administrator's password after installation, and to change your own password.

Steps:

1. Sign in as an Admin and open **Users**.
2. Click the user's row. Confirm the **Username** in the form (Figure 98).
3. Click **Reset Password**.
4. In the **Reset Password** window, type the new password and click **OK** (Figure 99).
5. Check for **"Password reset."** (Figure 100).
6. Give the new password to the user privately. The old password no longer works.

W25. Deactivate or reactivate a staff login

Steps:

1. Open **Users** (Admin only) and click the user's row.
2. Check the username in the form.
3. Click **Deactivate** (for an active user) or **Activate** (for an inactive user). **There is no confirmation.**
4. Check for **"User deactivated."** or **"User activated."** and the **Status** column (Figure 101).

Effect: a deactivated user gets "Invalid username or password." at sign-in. Their past bills and entries remain.

> Do **not** deactivate your own account or the last active Admin. The application allows it, but then nobody may be

> able to manage users.

W26. Update company settings

Steps:

1. Click **Settings** under **SYSTEM** (Figure 102).
2. Enter **Company Name**, **Phone** and **Address** (Figure 103).
3. Click **Save Settings** and check for **"Settings saved."** (Figure 104).

> In this version these values are stored for future use only. **Invoice Prefix** and **Allow negative stock** have no effect: bills always start with BILL- and selling beyond stock is always refused.

W27. Back up the database

Prerequisites: The PostgreSQL client tools are installed on the computer (ask your system administrator).

Steps:

1. Click **Settings** under **SYSTEM**.
2. In **Backup & Restore**, click **Backup Database**.
3. In the **Save As** window, choose a safe location, preferably a USB drive or network folder. Keep the suggested file name (it contains the date and time) and click **Save**.
4. Wait. Check for **"Backup created successfully."**
5. Check that the `.backup` file exists in the chosen folder and is not empty.

Recommended routine: back up at the end of every working day and keep copies on at least two different devices.

Failure: "Backup failed: ...". If the message mentions `pg_dump` and "cannot find the file specified", the tools are missing. Contact your system administrator.

W28. Restore the database from a backup

> **Danger:** Restoring **replaces all current data** with the backup. Everything entered after the backup was made is lost. This procedure was **not executed** during the preparation of this manual. Perform it only with your system administrator.

Steps:

1. Make sure no one else is using the application.
2. Make a fresh backup of the current data (W27) in case you need to go back.

3. Open **Settings** and click **Restore Database**.
4. Select the `.backup` file and click **Open**.
5. Read the question **"Restoring will overwrite existing data. Continue?"** (window **Confirm restore**). Click **Yes** to proceed, or **No** to cancel.
6. Wait for **"Database restored. Please restart the application."**
7. Close the application and start it again.
8. Check a few known records (latest bill numbers, customer balances) to confirm the restore.

Failure: "Restore failed: ...". Note the message and contact your system administrator before trying again.

W29. Export or print a report

Purpose: Save a report as an Excel or PDF file, or print it on paper.

Applies to: Daily Closing Stock, Daily Sale Report, Profit & Loss, Damage Report, Expense Report, Party Ledger and Market Credit.

Prerequisites: For Party Ledger, click **View Ledger** first. For printing, a printer must be installed on the computer.

Steps:

1. Open the report from the side menu.
2. Set the date, date range and any filters you need.
3. Click **View Report** (or **View Ledger** / **Apply Filter**) and check that the screen shows what you want. **The export contains exactly what is on screen.**
4. Click one of: - **Export Excel** — an .xlsx file you can open in Excel and work with. - **Export PDF** — a PDF for sending or filing. - **Print** — opens a print preview.
5. **For an export:** choose the folder, keep or change the suggested file name (it already contains today's date), and click **Save** (Figure 114).
6. When the file is saved the application asks **"Open it now?"** (Figure 115). Click **Yes** to check it, or **No** to carry on working.
7. **For printing:** check the preview (Figure 116), then click the printer icon at the top-left of the preview window, choose your printer and click **Print**. Click **Close** to leave the preview without printing.

Expected result: The file appears in the folder you chose, or the report prints. Exported reports carry your business name, address and phone from **Settings** at the top, the dates and filters you chose, and page numbers.

Alternative paths:

- **Sharing by email or WhatsApp:** use **Export PDF** and attach the file.
- **Doing your own calculations:** use **Export Excel**. Amounts are saved as real numbers, so Excel can sort and total them.

Failure and recovery:

Message	Cause	Fix
"There is nothing to export for the selected options."	The report is empty	Widen the date range or clear the filters, click View Report, and try again.

Message	Cause	Fix
"Click View Ledger first."	Party Ledger has not been run	Choose a customer and click **View Ledger**.
"The file could not be saved. If it is open in another program, close it and try again."	The file is open in Excel or a PDF reader	Close the file, or save under a different name.
"No printer is installed on this computer."	No printer available	Use **Export PDF** and print from another computer.
"Export failed: ..."	Something else went wrong	Note the message, try a different folder (for example Documents), and tell your administrator if it continues.

W30. Read a notification from your supplier

Purpose: See the news, offers and notices your supplier sends to every shop.

Prerequisites: The computer has been online at some point since the message was sent.

Steps:

1. Look at the top-right of the window, left of the date. When your supplier has sent something, a **bell** appears with a red number (Figure 117).
2. Click the **bell**. The **Notifications** window opens (Figure 118).
3. The list on the left shows every current message, newest first. A **red dot** marks one you have not read.
4. Click a message. It opens on the right and is marked as read.
5. Read the text. A poster appears above it; a video has play and volume controls (Figure 119).
6. If there is a button such as **See the offer**, clicking it opens that page in your web browser.
7. Use **Mark all as read** to clear every red dot at once.
8. Close with the **X**.

Expected result: The bell's number drops as you read messages, and disappears when none are unread. The bell itself stays while messages exist.

Notes: - You cannot reply. Phone your supplier. - Read and unread is remembered on this computer only. - New messages arrive when you start the application and about once an hour afterwards.

Failure and recovery:

Problem	What to do
No bell at all	Nothing has been sent, or this PC has no internet. Check with your supplier.
A message says only "Open picture" / "Play video" with buttons	The Microsoft Edge WebView2 Runtime is missing. The buttons still work. Ask for it to be installed.
A message disappeared	Your supplier removed it, or it reached its expiry date.

W31. Install a software update

Purpose: Move to the newer version your supplier has released.

Prerequisites: The application was installed with the setup program, and the PC has internet.

Steps:

1. A window appears by itself: **"A new version is available"** (Figure 120). You can also open it from **Settings** → **Software Update** → **Check for Updates**.
2. Read **What's new**.
3. **Finish or save whatever you are typing.** Installing closes the application.
4. Click **Download and Install**. A progress bar runs. You may keep working while it downloads.
5. When it says **Ready to install**, click **Restart Now**.
6. Confirm **Yes** to the question about closing.
7. The application closes, installs, and opens again. Sign in as usual.
8. Check the new version under **Settings** → **Software Update**.

Expected result: The installed version is the new one. Your database, customers, bills and settings are exactly as before.

Alternative paths: - **Not now:** click **Later**. You are offered it again at the next check. - **Download now, restart later:** after the download click **Restart Later**. It installs the next time you choose to restart.

Failure and recovery:

Message	Cause	Fix
"Download failed: ..."	Connection dropped	Click **Try Again**. If it keeps failing, check the internet.
"This copy was not installed by the setup program, so it cannot update itself."	Running from a copied folder	Ask your supplier for the installer and install properly.
"The update check did not work: ..."	No internet, usually	Try later.
After restarting, the application asks to be set up again	The computer's settings file was lost	Call your supplier: the database details must be entered again in `C:\ProgramData\DistributionManagementSystem\appsettings.json`.

Troubleshooting

Distribution Management System — problems, messages and fixes

Use this guide when something does not work as expected. Messages are quoted exactly as the application shows them. Figure numbers refer to SCREEN_REFERENCE.md and `assets/screenshots/`.

Items marked **(not tested)** were identified by examining the application but were not reproduced during testing. Treat them as potential issues that need confirmation.

Contents

1. Sign-in and start-up
2. Information looks out of date
3. The wrong record opens after clicking a row
4. Messages when saving forms
5. Stock quantities are wrong
6. Billing and customer balance problems
7. Reports and dashboard
8. Excel import problems
9. Users and passwords 9a. Notifications and updates
10. Backup and restore
11. Unexpected error window
12. Buttons and keyboard
13. Mistakes that cannot be undone
14. Information to give your administrator

---

1. Sign-in and start-up

Problem or Message	Possible Cause	Recommended Action	How to Verify the Fix
"Invalid username or password." (Figure 2)	Wrong username or password. Caps Lock is on. Username typed with different capital letters (usernames are case-sensitive).	Check Caps Lock. Retype the username exactly. Click the eye icon to see the password you typed.	The main window opens.
Same message, but the details are certainly correct	The account was **deactivated** or the password was **reset** by an administrator.	Ask an Admin to check your account on the **Users** screen and to **Activate** it or **Reset Password**.	You can sign in.
Pressing **Enter** in the Username box does nothing	Enter only works in the Password box.	Press **Tab** to go to Password, then press **Enter**, or click **Login (Enter)**.	Sign-in proceeds.

Problem or Message	Possible Cause	Recommended Action	How to Verify the Fix
An **Error** window appears when the application starts, or the application closes without showing the Sign-in window (not tested)	The application cannot reach its database (database server stopped, network problem, or wrong connection settings).	Contact your system administrator. Give them the time of the problem. Technical details are written to the `logs` folder inside the application folder.	The Sign-in window appears normally.
Nobody can sign in as an administrator	The only Admin account was deactivated, or its password is lost.	This cannot be fixed from inside the application. Contact your system administrator.	An Admin can sign in again.

---

2. Information looks out of date

How refreshing works: every screen reloads its lists and drop-downs each time you open it from the side menu, and again after you save on that screen. A record added on one screen is therefore available on the others straight away, without restarting the application.

Report results are the exception. They depend on the dates and filters you choose, so they are only recalculated when you ask for them.

Problem	Recommended Action	How to Verify
A report still shows old figures after new bills, expenses or stock	Click **View Report**, **View Ledger** or **Apply Filter** on that screen.	The figures change.
In Stock, **Avg Cost** or **Balance** look wrong on Products, Customers or Suppliers	Click another screen and open this one again. If it still looks wrong, type a letter in the search box and delete it.	The figures match the latest transactions.
A new company, category, product, customer, supplier, area, damage reason or expense category is missing from a drop-down	Open the screen again (click another menu item, then this one).	The item appears in the list.
The item is still missing after reopening the screen	It was probably not saved. Open the screen where you added it and check the list.	The record is in its own list.
The selection in a drop-down changed by itself	The record you had chosen was deleted, so the first item was selected instead.	Check the selection before saving.
Another user's entries are missing from a "Today's…" list	These lists reload when you open the screen and after you save. Open the screen again.	The other user's entries appear.
Entries made just after midnight appear under the previous day's "Today's…" list, or are missing (not tested)	The "Today's" lists use the world standard time (UTC) date. In Pakistan (UTC+5), entries made between 12:00 midnight and 5:00 AM may be grouped with the previous day.	Use **Daily Sale Report** or **Expense Report** with an explicit date instead.

---

3. The wrong record opens after clicking a row

Verified behaviour: on the Companies screen, the list was sorted by clicking the **Company** heading. Clicking the row **SRF – Sunrise Foods** then loaded **CRB – Crescent Beverages** into the form (Figures 107 and 108). Saving or deleting at that point would change the wrong company.

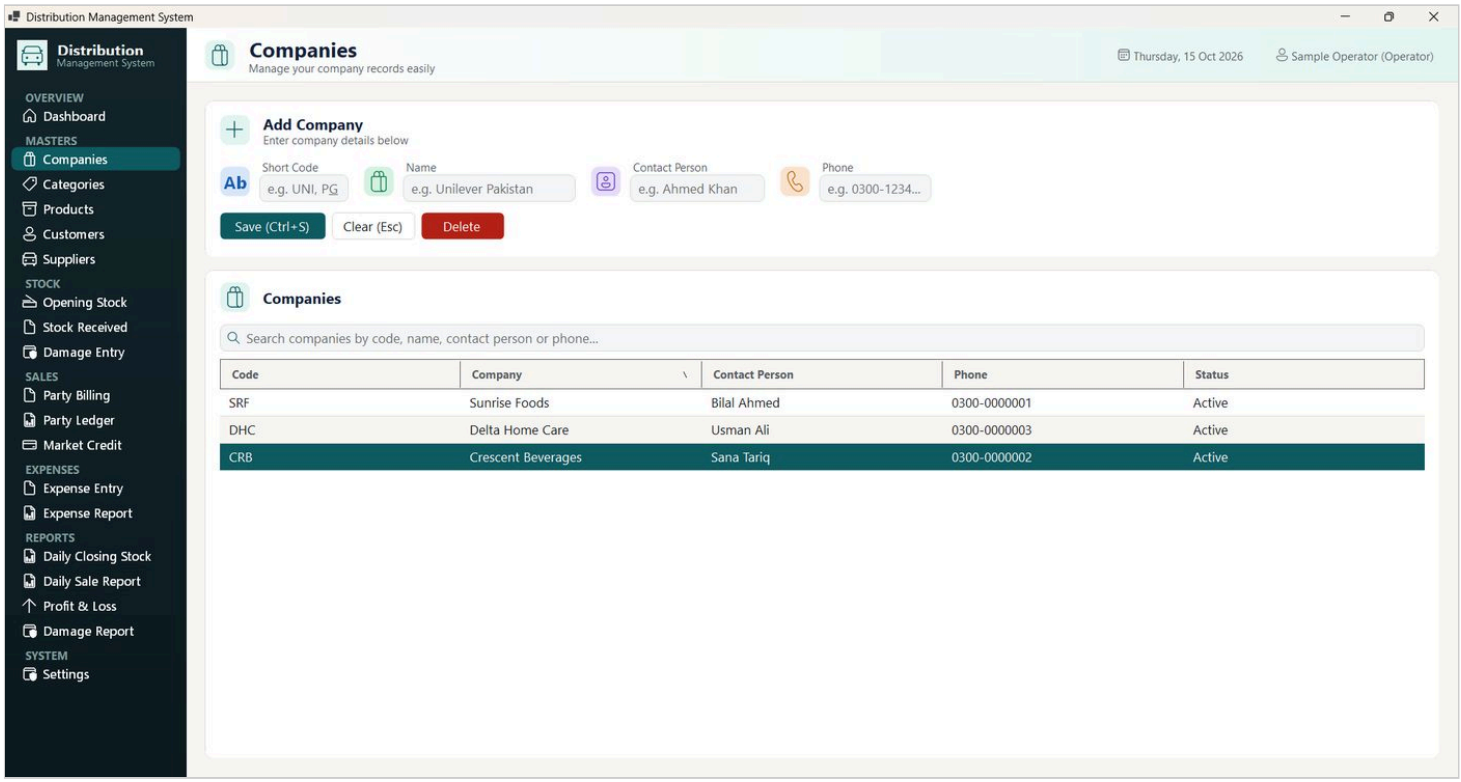


Figure 107: The Companies list after clicking the Company heading twice (sorted Z to A)

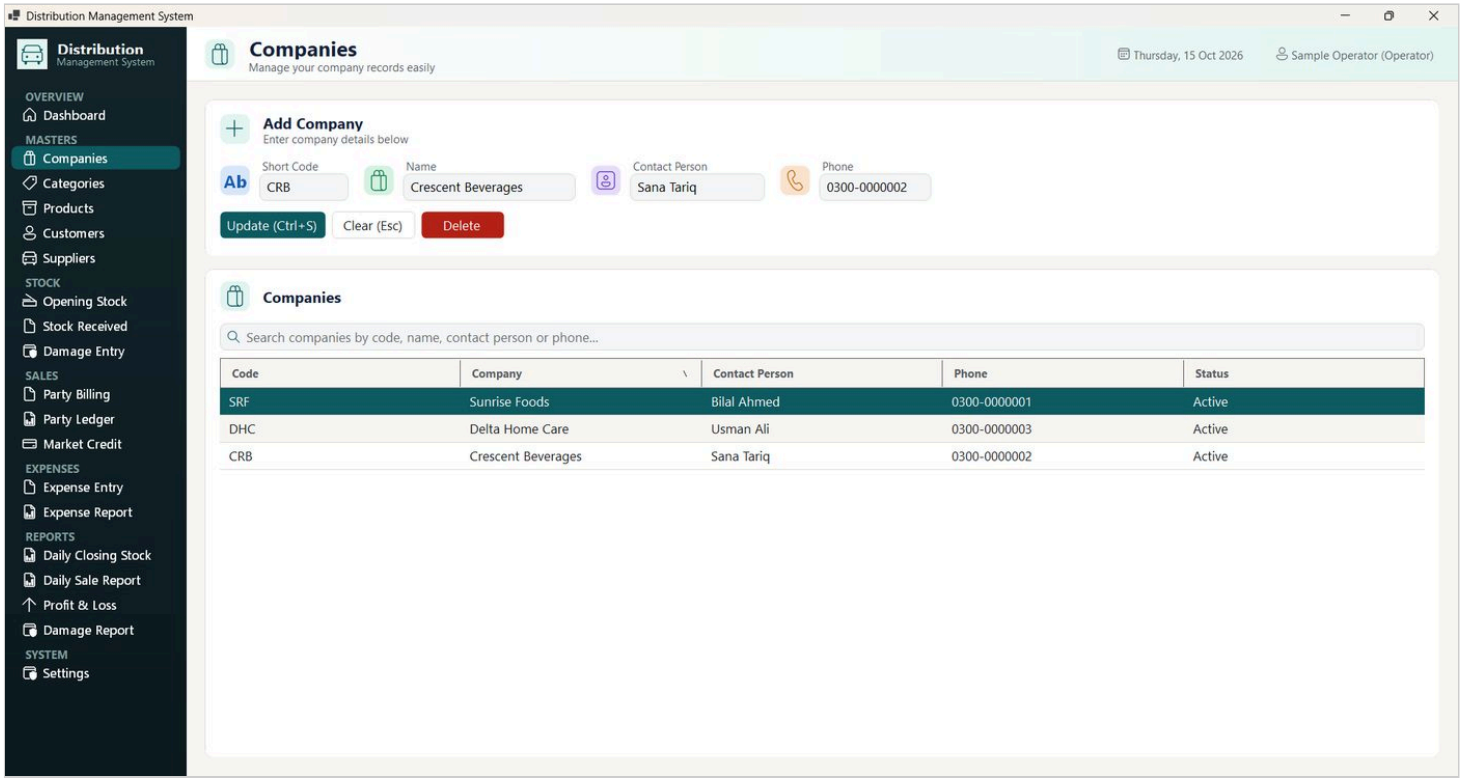


Figure 108: The SRF – Sunrise Foods row was clicked, but the form shows CRB – Crescent Beverages

This can happen on any master screen: Companies, Categories, Products, Customers, Suppliers and Users.

Problem or Message	Possible Cause	Recommended Action	How to Verify the Fix
The form shows a different record from the row you clicked	The list was sorted by clicking a column heading.	Click **Clear (Esc)**. Type a letter in the search box and delete it (this restores the normal order). Click the row again. **Do not click column headings** on these screens.	The code and name in the form match the row you clicked.
You already clicked **Update** or **Delete** on the wrong record	As above.	**Update:** open the affected record and correct its values. **Delete:** it cannot be restored from the application; inform your administrator.	The record shows the correct values.

> **Good practice:** before every **Update** or **Delete**, read the code and name shown in the form.

---

4. Messages when saving forms

Red messages appear at the bottom-right for about two seconds.

Problem or Message	Screen	Possible Cause	Recommended Action
"Code and Name are required."	Companies	Short Code or Name empty	Fill both fields.
"Name is required."	Categories	Name empty	Type a name.
"Code, Name, Company, Category and Unit are required."	Products	A required field empty, or no companies/categories exist	Fill all five. If the drop-downs are empty, add companies and categories first, then open Products again.
"Code, Shop Name and Area are required."	Customers	A required field is empty, or no area exists	Add an area with the **+** button.
"Code, Name and Company are required."	Suppliers	A required field empty	Fill them.
"Select a product."	Opening Stock, Stock Received, Party Billing	No product chosen or no products exist	Choose a product; add products first if the list is empty.
"Quantity must be greater than zero."	Opening Stock, Damage Entry	Qty is 0	Enter a quantity.
"Qty and Rate must be greater than zero."	Stock Received, Party Billing	Qty or Rate is 0 when clicking **Add Line**	Enter both. On Party Billing, a 0 rate usually means the product's **Sale Rate** is 0. Set it on Products.
"Supplier and Invoice No are required."	Stock Received	Invoice No empty	Type the supplier invoice number.
"Add at least one item line."	Stock Received	No lines added	Click **Add Line** for each item first.
"Add at least one item."	Party Billing	No lines added	Add lines first.
"Select a customer."	Party Billing	No customer chosen or none exist	Add customers first.

Problem or Message	Screen	Possible Cause	Recommended Action
"Product, Reason and Found At are required."	Damage Entry	Reason list empty	Click **+** next to Reason and add one.
"Category and Amount are required."	Expense Entry	No category, or Amount is 0	Choose or add a category; enter an amount above 0.
"Username and Full Name are required."	Users	Field empty	Fill both.
"Username already exists."	Users	Username taken	Choose another username.
Error window "An unexpected error occurred: 23505: duplicate key value violates unique constraint "IX_..._Code"" (Figure 13)	Companies, Products, Customers, Suppliers	The code is already used, **including by a deleted record**	Click **OK**. Change the code (for example add `-2`). Codes of deleted records cannot be reused.
A long text is refused with an "unexpected error" window (not tested)	Text longer than the allowed length (for example a name over 200 characters)	Click **OK** and shorten the text.	—
No message at all, nothing saved	The message appeared while you looked away	Check the list. If the record is missing, save again and watch the bottom-right corner.	—

---

5. Stock quantities are wrong

Problem or Message	Possible Cause	Recommended Action	How to Verify the Fix
In Stock shows 0 or an old number	Screen not refreshed (see Section 2)	Type and delete a letter in the search box.	Correct quantity shown.
"Insufficient stock for '...'. Available: ..., requested: ...." (Figures 65, 74)	You are selling or writing off more than the recorded stock	Check the quantity. If goods really arrived, record the delivery on **Stock Received** first. **Allow negative stock** in Settings has no effect in this version.	The bill or damage entry saves.
Opening stock entered twice for a product	Each Opening Stock save **adds** stock, and entries cannot be deleted	Record the extra quantity on **Damage Entry** with a remark such as "Correction – duplicate opening stock", and inform your administrator. (This also records a loss in reports, so note it for your accountant.)	Products → In Stock matches the physical count.
A purchase was saved twice	Duplicate invoice numbers are not blocked, and purchases cannot be deleted	As above: record the extra quantity as damage with a clear remark, and inform your administrator. The bilti expense of the duplicate also needs attention.	In Stock matches the count.
Stock disappeared from Daily Closing Stock	The product was deleted	Deleted products cannot be restored from the application. Contact your administrator.	—

Problem or Message	Possible Cause	Recommended Action	How to Verify the Fix
Quantities with decimals look rounded (for example 2.5 shown as 3)	Lists show whole numbers	The exact value is stored. Open the record to see it, where possible.	—

---

6. Billing and customer balance problems

Problem or Message	Possible Cause	Recommended Action	How to Verify the Fix
"Discount X% exceeds max allowed Y% for ...." (Figure 106)	Operator or Viewer exceeded the product's **Max Discount %**	Reduce the discount (Clear and re-add the lines), or ask an Admin. An Admin can raise the product's Max Discount % on Products.	The bill saves.
Rate shows 0.00 when a product is chosen	The product's Sale Rate is 0	Type the rate for this bill, or set the Sale Rate on Products and open Party Billing again.	Rate fills in correctly.
A wrong line was added	There is no way to remove one line	Click **Clear (Esc)** and add all lines again.	Lines are correct.
A saved bill is wrong	Bills cannot be edited or cancelled	Inform your administrator. To correct the customer's account, adjust carefully with a manager. There is no return or credit-note screen in this version.	—
Need to print a bill	Printing an individual bill is not available	Note the bill number. The **Daily Sale Report** lists every bill and can be printed or exported (W29).	—
The customer's **Default Discount %** was not applied	It is stored for reference only	Enter the discount on each line.	—
A customer paid without buying	—	Use **SALES** → **Receive Payment** (W15).	The balance drops and a receipt appears in the ledger.
The whole bill went on credit	**Cash Received** was left at 0, so nothing was treated as paid	Type the money collected into **Cash Received** before saving. For an already-saved bill, record the payment on **Receive Payment**.	The message after saving says "Fully paid", or the balance drops after the receipt.
A receipt was saved with the wrong amount or customer	Receipts cannot be edited or deleted	Inform your administrator before entering anything else.	—
Previous Balance looks wrong	A bill or receipt was saved on another screen after this one was opened	Open Party Billing again; it reloads the balances. Compare with Party Ledger.	Matches the ledger's last running balance.
A customer who owes money is missing from Market Credit	The customer was deleted, or their balance is zero or negative	Click **Refresh** on Market Credit. Deleted customers are never shown.	Customer appears.

Problem or Message	Possible Cause	Recommended Action	How to Verify the Fix
Bill numbers do not use my Invoice Prefix	The prefix setting is not used in this version	No action. Bills are always numbered BILL-00001, BILL-00002, …	—

---

7. Reports and dashboard

Problem or Message	Possible Cause	Recommended Action
Dashboard always shows **Rs 0** and "No bills found for today" (Figure 91)	The dashboard figures are not connected to data in this version	Use the reports listed in SCREEN_REFERENCE.md, Dashboard.
Pressing **F2** does not open a new bill	Keyboard shortcut not active	Click **New Bill (F2)** or **Party Billing**.
Export or print buttons are missing on a screen	Only report screens have them (Daily Closing Stock, Daily Sale Report, Profit & Loss, Damage Report, Expense Report, Party Ledger, Market Credit)	Masters and entry screens cannot be exported. Use the matching report.
"There is nothing to export for the selected options."	The report is empty for those dates or filters	Widen the dates, clear the filters, click **View Report**, then export.
"Click View Ledger first."	Party Ledger has not been run	Choose a customer and dates, click **View Ledger**, then export.
The exported file will not save	The file is open in Excel or a PDF reader	Close it, or save under another name.
"No printer is installed on this computer."	No printer available	Use **Export PDF** instead and print elsewhere.
The exported report shows "Distribution Management System" instead of my business name	**Company Name** is empty in Settings	Enter your business details in **Settings** → **Save Settings** (W26), then export again.
Profit & Loss does not change after ticking a checkbox	Checkboxes apply only when the report is recalculated	Click **View Report**.
Self Expenses is always 0	Expense categories created in the application are always business categories	No action possible in this version.
Expense Report summary did not include a new expense	The summary refreshes when the screen opens and on **Apply Filter**	Click **Apply Filter**.
Damage Report does not change after choosing a different **Group By**	Recalculation needed	Click **View Report**.
Daily Sale Report product-wise and company-wise totals are higher than the bill-wise Net	Bill-level discounts are only subtracted in the bill-wise section	Expected behaviour. Use the bill-wise Net for daily sales.
Daily Closing Stock **Value** for a past date differs from what it showed that day	**Avg Cost** is always today's average cost	Expected behaviour.

Problem or Message	Possible Cause	Recommended Action
Opening stock appears under **Received** instead of **Opening**	The opening stock **As On Date** is the same as the report date	Report on a later date, or use an earlier As On Date when entering opening stock.
Supplier **Payable Balance** never changes	It shows only the opening balance; purchases and payments are not tracked	Keep supplier accounts separately.
Report shows nothing	No data for the chosen dates, or filters too narrow	Widen the dates; choose **All companies** / **All categories**; click View Report.

---

8. Excel import problems

Problem or Message	Possible Cause	Recommended Action	How to Verify the Fix
"Row 1: Missing required column(s): ..."	A heading is missing or misspelled	Correct row 1. Required: Code, Name, Company, Category, Unit, PcsPerUnit, PurchaseRate, SaleRate.	Import runs with rows processed.
"Row N: Unknown company '...'. Add it under Masters > Companies first." (Figure 30)	Company name in the file does not match	Fix the spelling in the file, or add the company under Masters → Companies.	Row imports.
"Row N: Unknown category '...'. Add it under Masters > Categories first."	Category not found	As above.	Row imports.
"Row N: Unit must be one of: Ctn, Box, Pcs, Bag." (Figure 30)	Invalid unit (for example "Crate")	Use one of the four units.	Row imports.
"Row N: PcsPerUnit, PurchaseRate and SaleRate must be numeric."	Text or symbols in a number cell	Enter plain numbers (no "Rs").	Row imports.
"Row N: Code and Name are required."	Blank code or name	Fill them.	Row imports.
"Import failed: ..."	File open in Excel, not a real .xlsx file, or damaged	Close Excel and try again. Save as **Excel Workbook (.xlsx)**.	Result message appears.
Barcodes or max discounts disappeared after import	The file had no Barcode or MaxDiscountPct column, or blank cells	Add the columns with values and import again.	Values return.
Only some rows were imported	Rows with errors are skipped; other rows **are** saved	Fix the listed rows and import again. Existing codes are updated, not duplicated.	All rows present.

---

9. Users and passwords

Problem	Possible Cause	Recommended Action
The **Users** menu item is missing	You are not an Admin (Figure 105)	Ask an Admin.
A user forgot their password	—	Admin: WORKFLOW_GUIDES.md, W24.
A user wants to change their own password	No self-service password change	Ask an Admin to use **Reset Password**.
A new user unexpectedly has full access	The **Role** drop-down defaults to **Admin**	Admin: open the user, change **Role** to Operator or Viewer, click **Update**. The change applies at the next sign-in.
A Viewer can create bills and change data	The Viewer role is not read-only in this version (not tested; see USER_MANUAL.md, Section 14)	Give the Viewer role only to trusted staff.
Role change did not apply	The user is still signed in	Ask them to close the application and sign in again.
Passwords are visible while typing in Set Password / Reset Password	The input window does not hide characters	Make sure no one is watching the screen.

9a. Notifications and updates

Problem or Message	Possible Cause	Recommended Action	How to Verify the Fix
No bell appears at the top	Nothing has been sent yet, this PC is offline, or notifications are switched off for it	Check the internet connection. Ask your supplier whether anything was sent.	The bell appears with a number.
A message shows buttons such as "Open picture" instead of the poster or video	The Microsoft Edge WebView2 Runtime is not installed on this PC	Ask your supplier or IT person to install the free **Microsoft Edge WebView2 Runtime**. The buttons work in the meantime.	The poster and video appear inside the window.
The video will not play	The file is not MP4, or the PC cannot reach it	Tell your supplier. They can send it again as MP4.	The video plays.
A message vanished	Your supplier removed it, or it expired	Nothing to do.	—
The bell number does not go down	The message was not opened, only hovered	Click the message in the list, or use **Mark all as read**.	The red dots clear.

Problem or Message	Possible Cause	Recommended Action	How to Verify the Fix
"You already have the latest version" but your supplier says there is a new one	The new version has not finished publishing, or this PC is offline	Wait a few minutes and check again.	The update window appears.
"This copy was not installed by the setup program, so it cannot update itself."	The application is running from a copied folder, not an installed copy	Ask your supplier for `Setup.exe` and install it properly.	**Check for Updates** offers the update.
"Updates are switched off for this computer."	Set on purpose for this site	Ask your supplier if it should be changed.	—
"Download failed: ..."	The connection dropped during the download	Click **Try Again**.	The download finishes.
After an update the application asks to be set up again	The file `C:\ProgramData\DistributionManagementSystem\appsettings.json` was deleted	Your supplier must enter the database details again in that file.	The application starts normally.
Windows warns "Windows protected your PC" when running the installer	The installer is not code-signed	Click **More info** → **Run anyway**, but only for a file you received from your supplier.	The installer runs.

---

10. Backup and restore

Problem or Message	Possible Cause	Recommended Action	How to Verify the Fix
"Backup failed: An error occurred trying to start process 'pg_dump' ... The system cannot find the file specified." (verified)	PostgreSQL client tools are not installed or not available to Windows	System administrator: install the PostgreSQL client tools and add their folder to the Windows PATH, then restart the application.	"Backup created successfully."

Problem or Message	Possible Cause	Recommended Action	How to Verify the Fix
"Backup failed: pg_dump failed: …" (not tested)	Database connection or permission problem, or the target folder is not writable	Try another folder (for example Documents). If it persists, contact the system administrator with the message text.	Backup succeeds.
"Restore failed: …" (not tested)	Missing tools, wrong or damaged file	Do not retry repeatedly. Contact the system administrator.	—
After "Database restored. Please restart the application." the data looks strange	The application was not restarted	Close and restart the application.	Data reflects the backup.

---

11. Unexpected error window

Window title: Error. **Message:** "An unexpected error occurred:" followed by technical text. Button: **OK**.

What to do	Details
1. Read and note the message	Write down the first line (for example "23505: duplicate key value…").
2. Click **OK**	The application normally keeps running.
3. Check whether your last action was saved	Look in the relevant list. In the duplicate-code case, nothing was saved.
4. Fix and retry, or report	Duplicate code: change the code. Other errors: report to your administrator with the time and what you were doing.

> Several Error windows may open one after another. Click **OK** on each.

---

12. Buttons and keyboard

Problem	Explanation	Recommended Action
Ctrl+S, **Esc** or **F2** do nothing	The shortcuts shown on button labels are not active in this version	Click the buttons with the mouse.
Delete, **Reset Password** or **Deactivate** looks clickable but nothing happens	These buttons work only after you click a row (edit mode). Disabled buttons look the same as enabled ones.	Click a row in the list first.
Typed number disappears	Invalid characters were typed	Type digits and a decimal point only. Press **Enter** or **Tab** to confirm.
Number changed by itself (for example 150 → 100)	The value was outside the allowed range	Enter a value within the range (for example 0–100 for percentages).
Cannot see the lower part of a screen	The screen is taller than the window	Scroll with the mouse wheel or the scroll bar on the right.

Problem	Explanation	Recommended Action
Search on Companies does not find a contact person or phone	Company search uses code and name only	Search by code or name.
A drop-down lost my selection when I came back to a screen	The screen reloaded its list and the record you had chosen no longer exists	Check the selection before saving.

---

13. Mistakes that cannot be undone

The following actions **cannot be edited, reversed or deleted** from inside the application. Double-check before saving:

Action	Consequence
Save Bill (Party Billing)	Bill, stock reduction and receipt are permanent.
Save Purchase (Stock Received)	Stock increase, cost change and bilti expense are permanent.
Save Opening Stock	Stock addition is permanent.
Save Damage Entry	Stock reduction and loss are permanent.
Save Expense	Expense is permanent.
Save Receipt (Receive Payment)	The payment and the reduced balance are permanent.
Delete a company, category, product, customer or supplier	Record is hidden permanently; its code cannot be reused.
Restore Database	All current data is replaced by the backup.
Restart Now (software update)	The application closes at once. Anything typed but not saved is lost. The update itself can only be undone by your supplier publishing a newer version.

If one of these was done by mistake, stop and inform your administrator before entering more data.

---

14. Information to give your administrator

When reporting a problem, include:

1. Your username and the time the problem happened.
2. The screen name (top of the window) and what you clicked.
3. The exact message text (or a photo of the screen).
4. Example data involved (bill number, product code, customer code).
5. Whether the problem happens every time.

The application writes technical details to daily files in the `logs` folder next to the application program. Your administrator can use them.

Documentation Coverage Checklist

Distribution Management System — User Manual v1.2 — 16 October 2026

This checklist records what the manual covers, how each item was verified, and what is still unverified or missing.

How the application was verified

Item	Detail
Application version	Built from the project source on branch `dev`, commit `45c2a99` plus the changes made on 15–16 Oct 2026: screen refresh-on-open, the Receive Payment screen, report export/print, automatic updates and supplier notifications.
Run environment	Windows 11, screen 1920 × 1080, PostgreSQL 18
Test data	A **separate, empty test area** of the database (schema `docs_manual`) filled only with made-up example data. The existing business data (schema `public`) was **not read or changed** by the application during testing.
Method	Every screen was opened in the real running application. Representative workflows were performed with example data, and the results were checked on related screens and reports. Screenshots were taken directly from the application windows.
Not performed	**Restore Database** (it overwrites data). A **successful** backup could not be made because the PostgreSQL client tools are not on this computer's PATH; the failure message was verified instead.

Verification labels used below:

- **Tested**: performed in the running application and the result observed.
- **Examined**: behaviour determined by examining the application's program logic, not exercised in the running application.

---

1. Screen coverage

#	Screen	Opened in app	Documented (SCREEN_REFERENCE)	Screenshots	Status
1	Sign-in window	✓	§1	01, 01a, 02	Complete
2	Main window / navigation	✓	§2	03, 03a	Complete
3	Dashboard	✓	§3	03, 91, 105	Complete
4	Companies	✓	§4	04–15, 33, 107, 108	Complete
5	Categories	✓	§5	16–20, 32	Complete
6	Products (incl. Import from Excel)	✓	§6	21–31, 54, 55	Complete

#	Screen	Opened in app	Documented (SCREEN_REFERENCE)	Screenshots	Status
7	Customers	✓	§7	34–42	Complete
8	Suppliers	✓	§8	43–48	Complete
9	Opening Stock	✓	§9	49–53	Complete
10	Stock Received	✓	§10	56–62, 60a	Complete
11	Damage Entry	✓	§11	63–68	Complete
12	Party Billing	✓	§12	69–75, 72a, 106	Complete
12a	Receive Payment	✓	§12a	109–113	Complete
13	Party Ledger	✓	§13	76, 77	Complete
14	Market Credit	✓	§14	78	Complete (empty state not captured)
15	Expense Entry	✓	§15	79–84	Complete
16	Expense Report	✓	§16	85	Complete (filtered and empty states not captured)
17	Daily Closing Stock	✓	§17	86	Complete (filtered state not captured)
18	Daily Sale Report	✓	§18	87, 88	Complete
19	Profit & Loss	✓	§19	89	Complete ("Include Self Expense" state not captured)
20	Damage Report	✓	§20	90	Complete (other Group By options not captured)
21	Users	✓	§21	92–101	Complete
22	Settings (incl. Backup & Restore and Software Update)	✓	§22	102–104, 121	Complete (backup/restore dialogs not captured; see §6)
22a	Notifications window	✓	§22a	117–119	Complete
22b	Software Update window	✓	§22b	120	Complete

Screens discovered: 25. Screens documented: 25.

The application also contains a "not built yet" placeholder screen that would appear for an unknown menu item. Every menu item opens a real screen, so users cannot reach it. It is not documented further.

Dialogs and pop-up windows

Dialog	Documented	Screenshot	Verification
Confirm delete (Yes/No)	SCREEN_REFERENCE §4; USER_MANUAL §15	11	Tested
Error — "An unexpected error occurred"	TROUBLESHOOTING §11	13	Tested

Dialog	Documented	Screenshot	Verification
New Area	SCREEN_REFERENCE §7	35	Tested
New Damage Reason	SCREEN_REFERENCE §11	64	Tested
New Expense Category	SCREEN_REFERENCE §15	81	Tested
Set Password	SCREEN_REFERENCE §21	95	Tested
Reset Password	SCREEN_REFERENCE §21	99	Tested
Import Products (file selection)	SCREEN_REFERENCE §6	29	Tested
Import result "Imported: X, Updated: Y, Errors: Z"	SCREEN_REFERENCE §6	30	Tested
Save As (Backup Database)	SCREEN_REFERENCE §22	—	Tested (screenshot withheld; see §6)
Open (Restore Database)	SCREEN_REFERENCE §22	—	Examined
Confirm restore	SCREEN_REFERENCE §22	—	Examined
Toast messages (green/red)	SCREEN_REFERENCE §23; USER_MANUAL §15	many	Tested
Export to Excel / Export to PDF (Save As)	USER_MANUAL §12; W29	114	Tested
Export complete — "Open it now?"	USER_MANUAL §12; W29	115	Tested
Print Preview	USER_MANUAL §12; W29	116	Tested (preview rendered; sending to a physical printer not tested)
Software Update ("A new version is available" / "Ready to install")	SCREEN_REFERENCE §22b; W31	120	Tested end to end on a real installation
Restart to install (confirmation)	SCREEN_REFERENCE §22b	—	Tested
Setup needed (first run on an unconfigured PC)	DISTRIBUTOR_GUIDE §3	—	Tested

---

2. Form coverage

Every form below has a field-by-field table (Field Name, Purpose, Required/Optional, How to Enter, Validation) in SCREEN_REFERENCE.md.

#	Form	Fields documented	Validation messages	Status
1	Sign-in	2 + show/hide	1	Tested
2	Add Company	4	3 (+ duplicate error)	Tested
3	Add Category	2	2	Tested
4	Products (Basic Information + Pricing & Inventory)	9	1 (+ duplicate error)	Tested

#	Form	Fields documented	Validation messages	Status
5	Products — Excel import file format	10 columns	7	Tested (5 of 7 messages observed)
6	Customer	8 (+ New Area)	1	Tested
7	Supplier	7	1	Tested
8	Opening Stock	4	2	Tested
9	Stock Received (header + item line)	5 + 3	4	Tested
10	Damage Entry	6 (+ New Damage Reason)	3	Tested
11	Party Billing (header + item line + totals)	2 + 4 + 2	6	Tested
12	Expense Entry	5 (+ New Expense Category)	1	Tested
12a	Receive Payment	5	2	Tested
12b	Notifications window (reading only, no input)	—	—	Tested
12c	Software Update window (no input)	—	—	Tested
13	Add User (+ Set/Reset Password)	3 + password	2	Tested
14	Settings — Company & Invoice Settings	5	—	Tested (save)
15	Party Ledger parameters	3	—	Tested
16	Expense Report filter	3	—	Partly tested (default range)
17	Daily Closing Stock parameters	3	—	Partly tested (today, all)
18	Daily Sale Report parameters	1	—	Tested (today)
19	Profit & Loss parameters	4	—	Partly tested (default options)
20	Damage Report parameters	3	—	Partly tested (group by Product)

Forms documented: 21 (14 data-entry forms, 1 import file format and 6 report-parameter forms), plus 5 small input windows.

---

3. Workflow coverage

All workflows are in WORKFLOW_GUIDES.md with prerequisites, numbered steps, expected result, alternatives and failure/recovery.

ID	Workflow	Verification
W1	First-time setup	Tested (whole sequence performed with example data)
W2	Sign in / close	Tested

ID	Workflow	Verification
W3	Add a company	Tested
W4	Add a category	Tested
W5	Add a product	Tested
W6	Import products from Excel	Tested
W7	Add a customer (incl. area)	Tested
W8	Add a supplier	Tested
W9	Edit a master record	Tested (Companies, Categories, Products, Customers, Suppliers, Users loaded; Companies updated)
W10	Delete a master record	Tested for Companies (success + blocked) and Categories (blocked); Examined for Products, Customers, Suppliers
W11	Record opening stock	Tested
W12	Receive stock	Tested (incl. bilti expense)
W13	Record damage	Tested (incl. insufficient stock)
W14	Create a sale bill	Tested (incl. cash, credit, insufficient stock, discount limit)
W15	Record a payment against a balance	Tested (Receive Payment screen; balance, ledger and Market Credit verified)
W16	Check a customer's account	Tested
W17	See who owes money	Tested
W18	Record an expense	Tested
W19	Review expenses	Partly tested
W20	End-of-day closing	Tested (each report opened)
W21	Profit for a period	Tested (single day)
W22	Analyse damage	Partly tested
W23	Create a staff login	Tested
W24	Reset a password	Tested
W25	Deactivate / reactivate a login	Deactivate tested, sign-in refusal tested; Activate examined
W26	Update company settings	Tested
W27	Back up the database	Failure path tested; success path not possible on this computer
W28	Restore the database	**Not performed** (destructive)
W29	Export or print a report	Tested (Excel and PDF files produced and opened; print preview rendered)
W30	Read a notification	Tested (text, poster and video messages, unread counts, mark all as read)
W31	Install a software update	Tested end to end: offered, downloaded, installed, restarted into the new version, site settings preserved

Workflows documented: 31.

---

4. Action-effect coverage

Action	Effect documented	Cross-screen effect verified
Save company/category	Available in drop-downs on other screens when reopened	Yes
Delete company/category with products	Refused, with message	Yes
Save product	Avg Cost = purchase rate; appears in other screens	Yes
Excel import (insert/update/errors)	Partial save; overwrites	Yes
Opening stock	Stock up; Avg Cost recalculated	Yes (Products after refresh, Daily Closing Stock)
Purchase	Stock up; Avg Cost; automatic bilti expense	Yes (Expense Entry, Expense Report, Profit & Loss)
Damage	Stock down; loss = qty × avg cost	Yes (Damage Register, Daily Closing Stock, Profit & Loss, Damage Report)
Bill	Stock down; balance; receipt; reports	Yes (Party Ledger, Market Credit, Daily Sale Report, Profit & Loss, Daily Closing Stock)
Expense	Reports	Yes
Deactivate user	Sign-in refused	Yes
Role (Operator)	Users menu hidden; discount limit	Yes
Settings save	Stored; business name/address/phone appear on exported and printed reports	Yes (seen in the exported PDF and Excel heading)
Receive Payment save	Balance down; receipt in ledger; Market Credit updated	Yes
Bill with partial cash	Message states the amount left on credit	Yes
Navigate away and back	Screen reloads lists and drop-downs	Yes (new customer appeared in Party Billing without restarting)
Export Excel / PDF	File written with the on-screen data and totals	Yes (files opened and contents checked)
Broadcast published	Bell appears with an unread count; message shows text, poster and video	Yes (against a local test feed)
Open a message	Marked read on this PC; bell count drops	Yes
New version published	Update offered, downloaded, installed on restart	Yes (against a local test feed)
Update installed	Site settings in ProgramData survive; program files replaced	Yes

---

5. Unverified behaviour (requires verification)

#	Behaviour stated in the manual	Where	Why unverified
1	Viewer role has the same access as Operator (not read-only)	USER_MANUAL §14; TROUBLESHOOTING §9	Examined only; no Viewer sign-in was performed
2	Restore Database dialogs, confirmation and result	SCREEN_REFERENCE §22; W28	Not executed (destructive)
3	Successful backup ("Backup created successfully.")	SCREEN_REFERENCE §22; W27	PostgreSQL client tools missing on test computer
4	"Today's" lists use the UTC date (entries between midnight and 5 AM Pakistan time)	TROUBLESHOOTING §2	Examined only
4a	Sending a report to a physical printer	USER_MANUAL §12; W29	Print preview was verified; no test print was made on paper
4b	Behaviour when a drop-down selection was deleted by another user while a screen was open	SCREEN_REFERENCE §2	Examined only
5	Adding the same product on two lines of one bill may bypass the stock check	SCREEN_REFERENCE §12	Examined only
6	Text longer than allowed causes an unexpected error	TROUBLESHOOTING §4	Not tested
7	Error window or closure when the database cannot be reached at start-up	TROUBLESHOOTING §1	Not tested
8	"Import failed: …" when the Excel file is open or invalid	SCREEN_REFERENCE §6	Not tested
9	Activate (re-enable) a user; Update a user's role	SCREEN_REFERENCE §21	Examined only
10	Deleting a product with stock, or a customer with a balance, is allowed	SCREEN_REFERENCE §6, §7; W10	Examined only
11	Company deletion blocked by linked suppliers (second message)	W10	Examined only (products case tested)
12	Invoice Prefix and Allow negative stock have no effect	SCREEN_REFERENCE §22	Examined (bill numbering and stock refusal observed with default settings only)
13	Self Expenses always 0 / "Include Self Expense" output	SCREEN_REFERENCE §19	Examined only
14	A separate procedure for stand-alone customer payments may exist in your organisation	W15	Business procedure, not software
15	Report filters other than defaults (company/category filters, Group By Company/Reason/Month, Expense Report category filter)	SCREEN_REFERENCE §16–20	Examined only
16	Receipt larger than the balance (creating an advance)	SCREEN_REFERENCE §12a	Examined only

#	Behaviour stated in the manual	Where	Why unverified
17	Publishing a notification or an update **to GitHub**	DISTRIBUTOR_GUIDE §4, §5	The Publisher app and `release.ps1` were built and their screens tested, but no upload was made: the GitHub account signed in on this PC has read-only access to the repository. The whole customer-side path was tested against a local feed instead.
18	Behaviour of the notification window without the WebView2 runtime	SCREEN_REFERENCE §22a	Examined only; the runtime is present on this PC
19	Delta (part) updates over the internet	DISTRIBUTOR_GUIDE §4	A delta package was produced and the update applied from a local folder; not tested over GitHub
20	SmartScreen warning on an unsigned installer	DISTRIBUTOR_GUIDE §9	Expected behaviour, not reproduced

---

6. Screenshots

Item	Count
Actual application screenshots	**120** (files `01-…` to `121-…`)
Annotated copies with numbered markers	**6** (`01a`, `03a`, `09a`, `25a`, `60a`, `72a`)
Total image files	**126**, in `assets/screenshots/`

Screenshots of every screen affected by the 15 Oct 2026 changes were retaken: Party Billing (69–75), Party Ledger (76–77), Market Credit (78), Expense Report (85), Daily Closing Stock (86), Daily Sale Report (87–88), Profit & Loss (89), Damage Report (90), plus the new Receive Payment screen (109–113) and the export/print windows (114–116). The obsolete "stale stock" figure was removed, because screens now refresh on their own.

All screenshots come from the real running application. No mock-ups or generated illustrations are used. The annotated copies only add numbered red circles on top of the real screenshots.

Screenshots still to be captured manually

Screenshot	How to capture
Sign-in window with the password shown (eye icon clicked)	Type a sample password, click the eye icon, capture the window.
Viewer user's main window	Activate a Viewer account, sign in as it, capture the main window.
Backup Database: Save As window and "Backup created successfully."	On a computer with PostgreSQL client tools on PATH, click Backup Database and capture both. Choose a neutral folder so personal file names are not visible.
Backup failure message	Captured during testing but **withheld**, because it showed an internal temporary folder path. The exact text is quoted in TROUBLESHOOTING §10. Recapture on a production installation if needed.
Restore Database: Open window, "Confirm restore" and "Database restored…"	Only on a **test copy** of the database. Never on live data.

Screenshot	How to capture
Market Credit empty state ("No outstanding credit")	Capture on a database where no customer owes money.
Expense Report with a category filter applied; empty "No expenses in this range"	Choose a category and dates, click Apply Filter.
Daily Closing Stock with company/category filters	Choose a company, click View Report.
Profit & Loss with "Include Self Expense" ticked	Tick and click View Report.
Damage Report grouped by Company, Reason and Month	Change Group By, click View Report.
Start-up error when the database is unavailable	Ask the system administrator to reproduce it in a test environment.
"Import failed" error	Open the Excel file in Excel, then import it.

---

7. Final coverage review

Check	Result
Every discovered screen documented	✓ 25 / 25
Every data-entry form documented field by field	✓ 14 / 14 (+ import format, report parameter forms and input windows)
Every visible button and control explained	✓
Every meaningful workflow has start-to-finish steps	✓ 31 workflows
Action effects and cross-screen relationships described	✓
Screenshots for every major screen and form	✓ (see §6 for remaining optional states)
Internal image links resolve	✓ Checked automatically: all image references point to existing files
Menu and button names match the application	✓ Taken from the running application
Unsupported behaviour not presented as fact	✓ Missing features are explicitly listed; unverified items labelled
No developer-only explanations in the end-user manual	✓ Technical wording limited to quoted error messages and administrator notes
No credentials or private data exposed	✓ Only made-up example data; the initial administrator password is deliberately not printed